Metered Commit Gates: Energy-to-Correct-Completion for Agentic Systems

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0. Overview

This paper joins two earlier studies into one systems paper. Part I is the commit gate. A proposal may not authorize itself. An irreversible act runs only behind a certificate, and every decision is written to a receipt. Part II is Mixture of Limits: use the cheapest gear that is sufficient. Its standard instance is a cascade. The cheapest sufficient gear runs first: Lookup, then Formula, then Solver, then Model. The cascade stops when the task completion predicate $C(z)$

holds, and it refuses with a receipt when the next gear would break the budget. Both parts rank by one quantity: the joules needed to reach a correct completion.

One board measurement anchors the gate fabric. On an AMD Kria KV260, the onboard INA260 read SOM-level A/B/A differences of 11,428 pJ per gate cycle (standard error 129 pJ, N = 4) for the WCA gate fabric, and 98.0 pJ per seed cycle (standard error 30.8 pJ, N = 4) for the seed fabric. The INA260 sits on `VCC_SOM`, which feeds the processing system, the programmable logic, DDR memory and the module regulators (KV260 device tree, `ina260@40`), so these are whole-module differences, not a core-rail or PL-only figure (Section I.3.7). The seed-fabric difference is about 1 mW at 5 V, near the part's 1.25 mA current resolution, and is reported as inconclusive until a PL-rail meter and at least 10 passes are run.

0.1 Contributions

1. A commit envelope: proposal, then certificate, then commit or refuse, then receipt. The certificate is conjunctive: look-up allow AND an energy predicate, optionally AND a control barrier function. Refusal reasons are typed. A Rust software reference implementation, Wise Computer Automation (WCA), runs it (Part I).
2. A typed provenance invariant. Output labeled `ModelGenerated` can never be promoted to `Deterministic` (Parts I and II).
3. A cascade with named refusals, and the exact condition under which cheapest first is optimal in expected joules (Part II, and Proposition 9 of the companion physics paper).
4. Energy to correct completion as the ranking, defined in Section 0.2.
5. Receipts as an instrument. Each receipt holds the prediction hash and its timestamp before the act, the outcome, the match, the joules by tier (measured, reported, estimated, never summed) and the refusal reason.

0.2 Energy to correct completion

Let $C(z)$ be the task completion predicate, with any deadline written into it. For a system S with policies π and an allowed failure rate δ,

$$J^*(S) = \min_{\pi} \ \mathbb{E}[J_\pi] \quad \text{subject to} \quad \Pr[C(z) = 1] \geq 1 - \delta.$$

Correctness and deadlines are constraints. Among systems that pass the gate, joules alone order them. Proposition 8 of the companion physics paper proves that this order is a total preorder and that it survives bounded meter error. MLPerf Power gates every power result behind an accuracy target. J^* has the same form.

0.3 Reading the two parts

Each part keeps its full original text. Sections are numbered I.n and II.n. Each part keeps its own reference list and its own reference numbers. A bracketed number in Part II refers to the Part II reference list.

Part I. The commit gate (Notational Intelligence)

I. Abstract

Agents propose actions. Irreversible work begins only when an action is allowed to run. This paper treats that permission step as a formal object. Linus Lee's notational intelligence is the observation that a change in symbols can make some thoughts cheap and others expressible. The claim here is narrower. For machines that can move matter or call an irreversible tool, the useful notation is a runtime law: a proposal may not authorize itself. The software reference, Wise Computer Automation (WCA), records the law as four objects under schema `wca.commit.v1`: a proposal, a certificate, a typed refuse reason, and a commit decision. The certificate used in the reference is conjunctive. A look-up table (LUT) allow bit must hold, and an energy predicate must hold. An optional control barrier function (CBF) may be added. Read-only calls may bypass the gate. Irreversible calls may not.

Energy numbers in this paper are products of operation counts and analytical energy constants (an OpCounter model). They are not board power. Field-programmable gate array (FPGA) behavior has three classes here. Icarus Verilog simulation checks the emitted register-transfer logic. An Alchitry Pt V2 runs the closed-loop gate and agrees with the

software on every decision. It has no meter, so its energy is unmetered. An AMD Kria KV260 runs the gate fabric under its onboard INA260 power monitor. Halting and running the same bitstream, interleaved A/B/A, gives a board-level metered difference of 11,428 pJ per gate cycle (standard error 129 pJ, N = 4) for eight parallel evaluations of LUT allow, energy predicate and barrier at 25 MHz. The smaller seed fabric gives 98.0 pJ per seed cycle (standard error 30.8 pJ, N = 4). These are `measured_j` at board level. They are not core-rail readings and not a closed-loop plant joule cost (Section 3.7). Stage B is available as a browser instrument at https://research.openie.dev/living/fpga-sim/. It compiles the same Rust gate to WebAssembly (WASM) and shows LUT state and commit traces through the WebGPU API. That instrument is an emulation. It is not a device-under-test (DUT) measurement and it is not Alchitry board power.

The measured software results are bounded. On a 16-step pendulum episode with seed 1, the reference commits 1 step and refuses 15. The analytical episode energy is 8.6795e-10 joule. On the reported Safe fixed-point port-Hamiltonian check, false allows against the continuous energy oracle `Vdot <= epsilon` are 0 on the stated grids, and the price is 79 false refuses in 209,261 decisions (Section I.4.3). That is the safety and liveness pair on that test set (Section I.4.10). A Model Context Protocol (MCP) demo refuses an irreversible tool call without invoking the executor. A toy comparison with an energy-set barrier and a discrete shield shows disagreement across safety definitions. None of these results is a claim of silicon energy leadership, of industrial control performance, or of a core-rail measurement.

I. Notation

Terms are defined at first scientific use below and collected here so later sections can use the short form.

Term	Definition in this paper
Open Interface Engineering (OpenIE)	The organization that maintains the software reference and this study.
Notational intelligence	Lee's claim that better notations can raise what a person or system can reliably do, beyond adding tools alone.
Commit gate	A runtime rule that either applies a proposed action or holds. The proposer does not get a second, informal channel.
Wise Computer Automation (WCA)	The software reference that implements commit gate at the boundary between a proposal and an irreversible effect.
Energy-First Architecture (EFA)	The design choice to put an energy predicate inside the permission record, not only in a later report.
Proposal	A candidate action `u`, state, and optional analytical energy hints. It cannot commit.
Certificate	The gate record: LUT allow, energy predicate, optional CBF predicate, reasons, and metrics.
Refuse reason	A typed code such as `lut_veto`, `energy_veto`, `cbf_veto`, `budget_exceeded`, or `policy`.
Commit decision	The envelope that sets plant action to `u` or to zero.
Look-up table (LUT)	A discrete map from a compact code to allow or refuse.
Ternary look-up matrix multiplier (TLMM)	The reference's cheap ternary table-lookup proposal path.
Control barrier function (CBF)	A certificate of set invariance when its inequality holds (Ames et al., 2019).
Model Context Protocol (MCP)	A tool-call transport. In this paper it is an adapter under test, not a plant certificate.
System One	Typed decision procedures (Laya / Jev class) that choose among known options in software. They are proposers.
Port-Hamiltonian	A structured energy model used here for a passivity-style check on toy plants.
Runtime verification (RV)	Checking a property on an executing trace. Related, not identical, to the commit record.
Device under test (DUT)	Hardware measured under a stated workload with a stated meter. No DUT result is reported.
Field-programmable gate array (FPGA)	Reconfigurable logic. This paper reports Verilog simulation, a programmed Alchitry Pt V2 with unmetered energy, and board-level KV260 meter readings (Section I.3.7).
WebAssembly (WASM)	A portable compilation target for the browser. The Stage B WASM FPGA emulator is shipped at https://research.openie.dev/living/fpga-sim/.
WebGPU	The browser GPU API named as the display and grid-evaluation path for that emulator.
Alchitry Pt V2	Vendor documentation identifies a Xilinx Artix-7 XC7A100T. FPGA programmed (SRAM-loaded) with the closed-loop commit gate; energy unmetered (Section I.3.7).
DiffLogic	Differentiable logic gate networks trained toward Boolean structure (Petersen et al., 2022).
Analytical energy estimate	`J = sum_op count_op * E_op` with named constants. Not board power.
Modeled	A quantity obtained from a stated formula or fitted structure.
Simulated	A quantity obtained by executing the software or Verilog model.
Board-measured	A quantity from a meter on a stated device and workload. None are reported.
Oracle-safe	Agreement with the continuous energy oracle `Vdot <= epsilon` on the stated plant.
Check-safe	The discrete Safe fixed-point / Q16.16 residual that approximates that oracle in the gate.
Set-safe	Set-invariance under a barrier or shield predicate (for example an energy-set CBF), which can disagree with oracle-safe.

I. Terms used here

This paper already distinguishes three safety predicates. Oracle-safe means the continuous `Vdot <= epsilon` oracle. Check-safe means the discrete Safe Q16.16 residual that tracks that oracle in the gate. Set-safe means set-invariance under a barrier or shield. NI-4 shows check-safe and set-safe can disagree. Software reference, evidence classes, and the board-result flag are on the shared glossary.

Analytical constants. `E_LUT_READ = 1e−12` J and the other OpCounter constants in Section 3.4 are engineering stand-ins for relative comparison inside this model. They are not calibrated board measurements. Do not read them as silicon joules. The zero-false-allows counts against the named oracle stay as reported.

Living figures. Commit stack: /living/ni/#ni-diag-02. Seed-1 runner: /living/ni/#ni-run-01. Safe false-allow=0: /living/ni/#ni-run-02. Stage B simulator: /living/fpga-sim/.

Scope of the argument. Section 2 places the commit record against notation research, information theory, scaling results, LUT networks, and control certificates. Section 3 defines the objects, the plants, the analytical energy model, and the unshipped browser instrument. Section 4 reports only quantities produced by the software reference or by a cited external source. Section 5 answers objections that have published form. Section 6 states what would falsify the claims and what was not measured.

I.1. Introduction

A language model can rank actions. Ranking is not permission. The failure mode that matters for a plant, a shell, a payment, or a destructive laboratory step is a commit: the action runs. Soft scores remain useful upstream. They are the wrong type at the irreversible branch, because a probability does not name which predicate failed, and it does not force the actuator command to zero.

Lee (2022) states a prior claim cleanly. Notation is not decoration. A notation that makes an operation executable changes which errors can be written down and which can be hidden. Iverson (1980) made the same point for array languages: notation is a tool of thought. Engelbart (1962) treated language, artifacts, methods, and training as one system. Kay (1972) and Victor (2013; 2012 talk) argued that representations should keep consequences near the idea being edited. Matuschak and Nielsen asked why tools for thought stall as products. That literature is about cognition and media. It does not, by itself, specify a record that a machine must obey before it moves.

The industrial center of recent artificial intelligence is scale. Kaplan et al. (2020) and Hoffmann et al. (2022) report loss scaling with parameters, data, and compute. Hooker (2021) argues that ideas spread when they fit available hardware and kernels. Epoch AI reports large declines in the price of a fixed inference performance (Epoch AI, 2025; Emberson and Roodman, 2026). Those results are about capability and cost of proposal. They do not define a commit predicate.

This paper's contribution is a software reference for that predicate, plus a report of what the reference actually does on toy plants. The contribution is compositional. Boolean LUT shields, energy certificates, ternary table lookup, and tool transports each exist in prior work. The reference wires them as one auditable decision: proposal, then certificate, then typed refuse or commit. The scan recorded in the project state-of-the-art note did not find a published product that ships that exact composition as one boundary. A scan is not a proof of absence. Private systems can exist. The claim is the existence and behavior of this reference, not a global first.

Three measurement statements constrain every later number. First, joules computed by the OpCounter are analytical estimates. Second, Verilog results are simulation. Third, the only board joules are the KV260 board-level differences of Section 3.7, filed as `measured_j` with the meter named. The board-result flag is true for those KV260 runs alone. The Pt V2 stays unmetered. Those sentences replace any badge-style labeling. A reader should be able to tell modeled, simulated, and board-measured apart from the method clause attached to the number.

Figure 1 draws the commit gate.

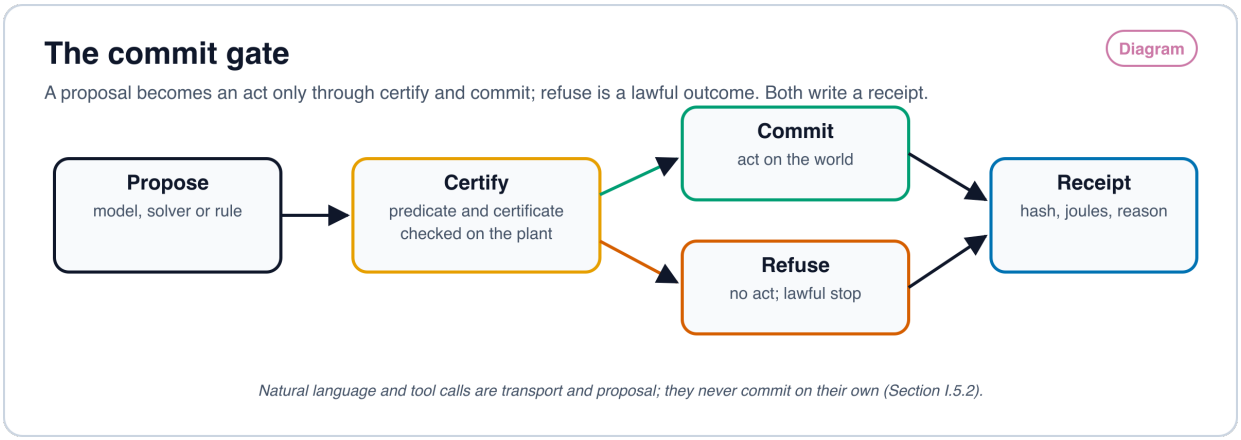


Figure 1. The commit gate. Diagram of propose, certify, commit or refuse, and receipt, as defined in Section I.3. A PNG copy is provided.

I. Companion papers

This study is the Commit law in the research catalog triad.

Role	Study	Owns
Navigation	Mixture of Limits	Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model; VoI / grammar / energy / certificate / settle-refuse floors.
Commit	This paper	propose → certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Notational Intelligence owns irreversible commit.
Task completion	Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound in AI Demand	Completeness predicate / budget stop on the same refuse taxonomy.
Energy budget	Metabolic Intelligence	Budget envelope and actuators that make floors bind at tag and campus scale.
A coding instance	The Reality Code Engine	Mixture of Limits applied to code: gears run cheapest first, a resolver is paid once per new case, and extraction keeps the least-joule fit among equivalent fits. Correctness is the gate; joules are the ranking. Its economics companion is The Promised Trillion Dollar AI-Coding Market.
Automation path	Spell Check is Global	An existence proof that some computer intelligence commoditizes to bundled zero price: spell check's marginal cost fell to about zero, and it complemented hardware and editors people already have. Access framing, not a census: the many (7B+), not the few who rent frontier datacenters (<500M).

Navigation chooses the gear. This paper records the irreversible branch. Satiation supplies the economic stop. Estimates remain estimates; package `measured_j` only when Metered. In Spell Check is Global a suggestion is a proposal until the writer commits it.

Shared thesis, stated once for every paper. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. The gate form defines what that means. Among runs that pass the task's completeness predicate $C(z)$ within the stated budget and deadline, systems are ranked by joules to completion, J^*. Correctness, deadlines and task size are the gate, not terms in the score. Parameters, tokens, benchmark scores and prices carry zero weight in the ranking (Agency, Section 1). Estimates are never `measured_j`. Prices and markets are economics. They are in the economics companions: Task Satiation, Spell Check is Global and The Promised Trillion Dollar AI-Coding Market.

I.2. Related work

I.2.1 Notation and tools for thought

Lee (2022) argues that inventing notations can matter more than inventing additional automated tools, because a notation changes the thoughts that are cheap. The interview record with The Gradient is consistent with that essay and is not an independent empirical result. Iverson (1980), Turing Award lecture, is the classical computer-science statement: notation is a tool of thought, and executability is part of the test. Engelbart (1962) locates intelligence in a human plus artifact system, not in a bare brain. Kay (1972) specifies a personal dynamic medium. Victor's "Media for Thinking the Unthinkable" and "Inventing on Principle" argue that creators need representations whose consequences are visible while the idea is still being formed. Matuschak and Nielsen, "How can we develop transformative tools for thought?", document adoption and institutional failure modes of such tools.

This paper uses that lineage for one limited inference. If a notation is executable, some failures become ordinary data rather than unrepresented accidents. A typed refuse reason is an instance. It does not support the strong Sapir-Whorf claim that language determines thought. The strong claim is rejected in Section 5. The weak claim, which is Iverson's, is that an executable notation changes the cost of operations and the representability of errors.

Chollet (2019) defines intelligence as skill-acquisition efficiency and grounds the definition in algorithmic information theory. That definition is about learning new skills, not about commit.

I.2.2 Information, description length, and physical cost

Shannon (1948) defines entropy and channel capacity. Shannon (1959) defines rate-distortion: how much description is required for a stated fidelity. Kolmogorov (1965) defines description length by program size. Solomonoff (1964) defines inductive inference by a mixture over programs. Chaitin (1977) develops program-size complexity. Cover and Thomas (2006) is the textbook spine. Jaynes (1957) uses maximum entropy as a rule for distributions under constraints. Brillouin (1956) connects information to physical negentropy in the Maxwell-demon line.

Cross-entropy training of a language model is an information-theoretic objective on a data distribution. Sutskever's 2023 Simons Institute talk, which is a talk and not a paper, discusses unsupervised learning as compression. That fact does not yield a Kolmogorov certificate for a particular string, and it does not yield a commit bit. The distinction is the one drawn in the project citation spine: statistical compression of a training measure is not the same object as a runtime allow set under a plant constraint.

Landauer (1961) proves a lower bound: logically irreversible erasure dissipates at least `kT ln 2` per bit in the ideal model. Bennett (1973) shows that logically reversible computation can avoid that erasure cost in the limit. Horowitz (2014) reports practical CMOS energy at picojoule scales for operations and memory movement, far above the Landauer bound, and treats energy rather than transistor count as the constraint. Mead (1990) is the neuromorphic argument for analog efficiency. Sandberg (2016) warns that a brain power near 20 watt does not bound the energy of an engineered system trained from scratch. A cortical partitioning preprint (arXiv:2102.06273) further warns against treating all of that biological power as comparable compute. This paper uses Landauer and Horowitz as bounds and practice tables. It does not claim that any model in the reference operates near `kT ln 2`.

I.2.3 Scale and hardware fit

Hestness et al. (2017), Kaplan et al. (2020), and Hoffmann et al. (2022) document empirical scaling of deep learning loss. Amodei and Hernandez (2018), an OpenAI blog post, describe rapid growth in training compute for landmark results. The page is a vendor essay. This paper does not depend on a specific doubling time from it. Sutton (2019) argues that general methods which use computation have beaten systems that encode the contents of human knowledge as fixed features. The essay is not an argument against every constraint. A commit predicate is a constraint on action, not a hand-built chess feature. Hooker (2021) explains why alternatives lose when the installed base of chips and libraries rewards dense matrix multiplication.

Inference price series, and what they do and do not imply, are economics. They are in the economics companion, Task Satiation, Section 8.1. This paper ranks by joules to correct completion and separates proposal cost from permission. A price is not a term in either.

I.2.4 LUT networks, ternary lookup, and differentiable logic

Umuroglu et al. (2020) map sparse low-bit networks to FPGA truth tables (LogicNets). Petersen et al. (2022) train networks of logic gates with differentiable relaxations (DiffLogic). Bacellar et al. (2024) train weightless networks of LUTs (differentiable weightless neural networks). Ma et al. (2024) study ternary-weight language models (BitNet b1.58). Wei et al. (2024) implement low-bit matrix multiplication by table lookup on CPUs (T-MAC). The TeLLMe line (arXiv:2504.16266) is a ternary LUT matrix-multiplication design aimed at FPGA execution. Those systems show that tables and gates are a real compute substrate. They do not, in the papers cited, attach a port-Hamiltonian energy veto and a typed commit envelope to a tool executor.

The reference uses DiffLogic as a thin allow table on toy features, and TLMM as a proposal path. That is a different job from using a logic network as the whole classifier, which is the usual DiffLogic evaluation (vision benchmarks, large gate counts). Section 6 records the capacity gap.

I.2.5 Certificates, shields, and runtime monitoring

Ames et al. (2019) survey control barrier functions as set-invariance certificates, typically enforced by a filter or a quadratic program. Alshiekh et al. (2018 preprint arXiv:1708.08611) introduce shields that replace unsafe actions with safe ones, minimally when possible. Dawson, Gao, and Fan (2022) survey learned Lyapunov and barrier certificates and the failure modes of treating a neural network as a certificate without a check. Manek and Kolter (2020) learn stable dynamics with a Lyapunov structure. Greydanus, Dzamba, and Yosinski (2019) learn Hamiltonian neural networks. Roth et al. (2025) study stable port-Hamiltonian neural networks. Yu, Zikelic, and Henzinger (2024) repair neural certificates using runtime monitors. Leung and Paré (arXiv:2512.24493) give Bayesian safety guarantees for port-Hamiltonian systems with learned energy functions. Their energy is the plant's physical Hamiltonian. It is not the energy of computation. The Safe path of this reference uses energy in that same physical sense. The joules of computation are a separate account (Section 3.4). Sanchez et al. (2018) survey runtime-verification taxonomies.

The gate is a Simplex. Sha's Simplex architecture runs an unverified high-performance controller beside a verified safety controller, and a decision module hands control to the safety controller before the plant leaves the region it can recover from (Sha 2001). "A proposal may not authorize itself" is that rule, carried from control loops to tool calls and actuators. Runtime assurance is its name in avionics and robotics. Three older results fix the rest of the shape. Saltzer and Schroeder named complete mediation: every access is checked against authority, every time (1975). A reference monitor is the mechanism that does the checking. Gray's two-phase commit separates prepare from commit, so no participant commits alone (1978). Necula's proof-carrying code ships a proof that the host checks before untrusted code runs (1997). The commit record here is a reference monitor in front of irreversible effects, with a Simplex switch to refusal and a certificate the host checks, as in proof-carrying code. What the reference adds to that lineage is one conjunct and one ledger: an energy predicate inside the certificate, and joules on the same record as the decision.

The reference does not replace that mathematics. The Safe path is a conservative fixed-point test of a known energy identity on a pendulum, `V = (1/2)(g theta^2 + omega^2)` with `Vdot = omega * u`. The CBF used in the toy bake-off is an energy-set inequality on the same `V`, not a claim to have solved the Ames quadratic program on a manipulator. Learned Lyapunov structure on a cart-pole is a second toy, reported in Section 4, and is not a region-of-attraction theorem for arbitrary plants.

I.2.6 World models, typed decisions, and tool transport

Ha and Schmidhuber (2018) and Hafner et al. (DreamerV3, arXiv:2301.04104) show that learned models can propose actions from imagined trajectories. LeCun's JEPA essays (Meta research blog) argue for predictive world models. LeCun et al. (2006) is the earlier energy-based learning tutorial. Prediction error is not identically zero in these systems. A predictor can sit upstream of a gate. It cannot replace the gate unless its predictions are perfect and the plant model is the plant. This paper does not compete with those systems on prediction benchmarks.

System One models return a typed answer and a probability for each allowed option in one forward pass, with no free-form text. TypeSafe AI named the category with its hosted Jev model (15 September 2026). Open models followed, among them Laya from Convai Innovations, an encoder with decision heads. They collapse generation cost when the option set is typed and known. Anthropic's Model Context Protocol announcement specifies discovery and transport for tools. Transport delivers a call. It does not evaluate `Vdot`. The reference's MCP adapter is a beachhead: irreversible

tools require a certificate before the executor runs. That is an engineering claim about this adapter, tested by the demo in Section 4, not a claim about every MCP server in production.

I.2.7 What the composition adds

Shields refuse unsafe actions but are not, in the cited papers, exported as the reference's four-field commit record with an analytical joule account. DiffLogic and LUT networks compute functions. They are not, in those papers, a veto in front of a separate proposer and a tool executor. Energy-aware barrier filters are continuous. The reference's allow bit is a table. The compositional claim is the wiring: LUT allow and energy predicate and optional barrier, recorded with a typed reason, applied before an irreversible effect, with analytical energy kept distinct from board power. Section 4 states which parts of that wiring were executed.

I.2.8 Certify / commit peers (2025 to 2026)

Peer systems now enforce a decision before an irreversible tool runs. That strengthens the commit-gate thesis; it does not duplicate this reference's record.

Shi et al., Progent (arXiv:2504.11703), check every tool call against symbolic least-privilege rules and use an SMT solver so privilege can only narrow without approval (monotonic confinement). Chen, Kang, and Li, ShieldAgent (ICML 2025; proceedings.mlr.press/v267/chen25ae.html), enforce verifiable safety-policy circuits over agent action trajectories before shielding. Yu, Žikelić, and Henzinger (AAAI 2025; [doi:10.1609/aaai.v39i25.34840](https://doi.org/10.1609/aaai.v39i25.34840)) repair neural certificates via runtime monitoring. A companion line verifies ReLU control-barrier certificates online over a lookahead region (arXiv:2507.11987).

What this paper owns. Those peers are policy, shield, or certificate-repair objects. This reference ships a four-field commit envelope (`proposal` → `certificate` → `commit|refuse` → receipt) with a conjunctive LUT allow bit and an energy predicate, typed refuse reasons, and analytical joules kept distinct from board power. Transport (MCP) remains proposal. Mixture of Limits chooses the gear on available fabric. Satiation supplies the economic stop. Metabolic Intelligence supplies the budget envelope. Board joules exist only for the KV260 runs in Section 3.7, at board level.

Runtime enforcement. The gate is a security automaton. Schneider showed that execution monitors enforce exactly the safety properties Schneider 2000, and Ligatti, Bauer and Walker extended the monitor to edit automata that suppress or insert actions Ligatti et al. 2005. Falcone set out when to enforce rather than verify Falcone 2010, and Bauer, Leucker and Schallhart gave runtime verdicts three values Bauer et al. 2011, which map onto allow, refuse and `settle_refuse`. What this paper adds to that line is the energy predicate in the certificate and the receipt. Agent guards of 2024 to 2026 have the same shape, a check between a proposed tool call and its effect: GuardAgent arXiv:2406.09187 and AgentSpec arXiv:2503.18666. PolicyGuide argues that a check on each action cannot steer a multi-step workflow arXiv:2608.19861; that is why Part II puts the stop on the task predicate $C(z)$ rather than on the single act. Multi-step irreversible work also needs compensation, which sagas supply Garcia-Molina and Salem 1987, and "a proposal may not authorize itself" is the reference-monitor principle that capability kernels such as seL4 enforce by proof Klein et al. 2009. The 0-false-allow scan of Section I.4 is a test over a grid, not a proof; Section I.6 states that limit, and it applies to every summary of the result.

Reference points for the board figure. An FPGA implementation of a function is expected to cost more energy than an ASIC; Kuon and Rose measured the dynamic power gap Kuon and Rose 2007, and Horowitz gives the CMOS energy per operation that frames such figures Horowitz 2014. A vendor power estimate for the same bitstream beside the SOM reading is part of the PL-rail protocol.

I.3. Definitions and methods

I.3.1 Objects

Fix a state `x` and a candidate action `u` in a set `U`. A proposal is a tuple

```
Proposal = (u, x, hints)
```

`hints` may include analytical energy quantities. A proposal has no interpretation as permission.

A certificate is a tuple

```
Certificate = (lut_allow, energy_ok, cbf_ok, reasons, metrics)
```

`lut_allow` and `energy_ok` are Booleans. `cbf_ok` is a Boolean when the selected compose mode requires it, and is absent otherwise. `reasons` is a list of refuse reasons. `metrics` includes the analytical energy account and the flag that board synthesis is not claimed.

Compose modes in the schema README are:

```
lut_and_energy        : commit <=> lut_allow AND energy_ok
lut_and_safe          : commit <=> lut_allow AND safe_energy_ok
lut_and_safe_and_cbf  : commit <=> lut_allow AND safe_energy_ok AND cbf_ok
```

Ablations `energy_only` and `lut_only` exist so a comparison can remove one conjunct. They are not the default for irreversible tools.

A commit decision is

```
if commit then plant_action = u else plant_action = 0
```

with the certificate attached. The executor for an irreversible tool is called only in the first branch.

Worked record. File `artifacts/schemas/wca.commit.v1/examples/commit_decision_refuse.json` stores a refuse in which `lut_allow` is true and `energy_ok` is false. The reason code is `energy_veto`. The fixed-point detail string is `Vdot_q=1461 > eps_q=13`. `plant_action` is `[0.0]`. The record sets the board-result flag to false. One true conjunct does not commit. That is the content of the conjunction, not a slogan.

I.3.2 Plants and oracles

The primary plant is a pendulum. Continuous reference quantities used by the Safe check are `g = 9.81`, `epsilon = 0.05`, `V = (1/2)(g theta^2 + omega^2)`, and `Vdot = omega * u`. `energy_ok` in the continuous oracle means `Vdot <= epsilon`.

The legacy discrete check is a Q8.8 fixed-point approximation, bit-matched to the Verilog module `wca_ph_energy.v` in simulation. The Safe check (`SafeFixedPointPHCertificate`) uses Q16.16 and an exact integer residual. The reported predicate is

```
energy_ok <=> 4*omega_q*u_q + 2*(abs(omega_q)+abs(u_q)) + 1
              <= floor(4*epsilon*S^2)
```

with the rounding argument given in `artifacts/RESULTS.md`: under round-to-nearest with error at most half a least significant bit, `Vdot` is bounded by `(prod + (1/2) abs + 1/4) / S^2`. The design goal is one-sided. If the Safe predicate allows, the continuous oracle allows. The converse is not required. Extra refuses are a measured cost, not a contradiction of the safety direction.

A second plant, cart-pole, is used only in the learned-Lyapunov simulation. State is `[x, xdot, theta, thetadot]`, with `g = 9.81`, cart mass 1.0, pole mass 0.1, length 0.5. `V` is a quadratic form `xi^T P xi / 2` with `P` positive definite by a Cholesky construction plus a multiple of the identity. The fit is stochastic gradient on a hinge of `Vdot + alpha V` under a linear policy, seed 42, 400 iterations, batch 32, `alpha = 0.15`, as recorded in `RESULTS.md`. The continuous gate is `Vdot <= 0.05`. The Safe discrete rule adds a Lipschitz margin times half a least significant bit. This is a simulation of one fitted quadratic on one box. It is not a proof for other plants.

I.3.3 LUT allow and proposal path

The allow LUT in the reported episodes is a DiffLogic export with mask `21887` on four features: absolute theta, absolute omega, absolute `u`, and an energy bit, unless a section says otherwise. TLMM is a grouped ternary table lookup used as a proposer. Iso-correctness means agreement with a naive ternary matrix product within absolute tolerance 1e-12, which `RESULTS.md` records as measured in software. Scale behavior is whatever `wca-tlmm-scale` writes under a stated analytical forward budget. The default budget discussed in results is 2e-10 joule per forward, analytical, not electrical.

I.3.4 Analytical energy model

`RESULTS.md` separates two facts. Operation counts are exact in the OpCounter. Joules are the counts times constants:

Constant	Value (joule)	Role
`E_LUT_READ`	1e-12	LUT read
`E_BRAM_WORD`	1e-11	BRAM word
`E_BITMASK_OP`	5e-14	bitmask operation
`E_ADD`	5e-13	add
`E_PACK`	2e-13	pack
`E_COMMIT_BASE`	2e-11	commit overhead
`E_REFUSE_OVERHEAD`	5e-12	refuse overhead

`J = sum count_op * E_op`. These constants are engineering stand-ins, not measurements. Structure counters such as shared BRAM hits are reported and are not charged unless they change a counted read. Changing a constant rescales every analytical joule in lockstep. That is why the numbers cannot be compared to a vendor's tokens per joule, to MLPerf Tiny energy, or to a rail measurement. They can be compared across modes inside the same model.

Utility in the internal tables is commit count. Commit count is not a task reward. A policy that commits more can score higher utility per joule while violating the energy oracle. Section 4 therefore does not treat utility per joule as a safety metric.

I.3.5 Tool adapter

`wca-mcp-gate` classifies tools. Read-only tools may execute without a commit record. Unknown tools are treated as irreversible. Irreversible tools require a certificate under the configured compose mode, default `lut_and_safe_and_cbf` in `artifacts/mcp_gate_demo.json`. On refuse, `executed` is false and `executor_calls` is 0. The demo executor records calls and does not perform host input or output. The method string in the demo file is `rust_mcp_commit_gate_v1`.

I.3.6 Simulation of Verilog

The repository emits Verilog and memory images for the allow LUT and the commit gate (`artifacts/fpga/`). `wca-rtl-verify` and Icarus Verilog check bit-exact behavior of those models against the software oracle. Icarus executes a simulation. It does not place, route, or measure a chip. Vivado reports enter only for the KV260 runs of Section 3.7, as utilization and timing closure. Vivado power estimates are not results.

I.3.7 Browser instrument and boards

The completeness path for replication has three stages. Stages A and B exist. Stage C has two boards: one for decision agreement and one for joules.

Stage A, present. Rust binaries in `wca-commit` run the episode, the Safe check, the tool demo, and the analytical joule account. Icarus simulates emitted Verilog on a workstation.

Stage B, shipped. The pure decision core (proposal in, certificate out, plant step, analytical joule update) compiles to `wasm32` (`crates/wca-fpga-sim`). A static page at https://research.openie.dev/living/fpga-sim/ loads the module. WebGPU holds the LUT words and a trace buffer of `(step, lut_allow, energy_ok, cbf_ok, decision)` for display. WebGPU timestamps are not joules. On seed-1 (16 steps, theta 1.5, omega 3.0) the WASM episode reports committed 1, refused 15, analytical joule 8.6795e-10, matching Stage A. The WASM module is an emulation of the same functions the Rust crate runs. It is not a cycle-accurate model of an Artix-7, not a switching-activity power model, and not a substitute for Icarus on the Verilog. Stage B does not claim an Alchitry Pt V2 DUT.

Stage C, board programmed; energy still unmetered. An Alchitry Pt V2 was detected and loaded (SRAM) with a closed-loop WCA commit-gate bitstream: on-fabric seed-1 pendulum plant dynamics, TLMM proposal, allow LUT, Safe Q16.16 port-Hamiltonian residual, and Ames-style energy-set control barrier function (CBF) residual. Fabric commit is `lut_allow ∧ energy_ok ∧ cbf_ok`. UART at 115200 8N1 agreed with the software composite golden on allow/refuse/commit (1 commit, 15 refuses, sole commit at step 6). On that seed-1 closed-loop episode the CBF conjunct did not change the allow/refuse trace versus LUT and Safe PH alone (the sole PH commit has u=0, so the

CBF Lie check holds). Closed-loop here means plant state evolves from gate commits and refuses on the fabric; it is not a streamed stimulus ROM of plant/proposal state. The Pt V2 has no onboard joule meter. No USB inline meter or shunt was attached. Vivado / post-PAR power estimates are not DUT readings. SparkFun's product page names FPGA XC7A100T-2FGG84I and lists 101,440 logic cells, 240 DSP48E1 slices, 4,860 Kb of block RAM, and 256 MB of DDR3L (https://www.sparkfun.com/alchitry-pt-v2.html); those remain vendor specifications. Builder metering methods: /living/fpga-sim/alchitry/#energy. Stage C, board metered. An AMD Kria KV260 carries an onboard INA260 power monitor (`ina260_u14`). Three rungs ran on 30 September 2026, each as interleaved A/B/A passes with $N = 4$, settle 15 s and sampling 25 s at about 4 Hz. Rung 1 compares a free-running seed fabric (439 LUTs) to the board's baseline bitstream. It gives watts only, with no operation count, so it gives no joules per operation. Rung 2 halts and runs one seed bitstream (975 LUTs) at about 100 MHz under an on-device operation counter. The difference is +0.0098 W (standard error 0.0031 W), which is 98.0 pJ per seed cycle (standard error 30.8 pJ). Rung 3 halts and runs the gate bitstream: eight lanes, each the conjunction of the allow LUT, the Safe Q16.16 energy residual and the barrier residual, in 6,370 LUTs and 128 DSP slices, timing closed at 25 MHz. The difference is +0.2857 W (standard error 0.0032 W). At 2.4999×10^7 gate cycles per second that is 11,428 pJ per gate cycle (standard error 129 pJ), about 1.43 nJ per lane decision. The A2 minus A1 drift was +0.0047 W (standard error 0.0040 W). The bitstream hashes and logs are in the `wca-kv260-meter` artifact of the reference.

What the meter can and cannot see. The INA260 specifies a maximum offset of 5 mA and a maximum system gain error of 0.15%, with a current step of 1.25 mA (TI INA260 datasheet). The offset is common to A and B on the same board and rail, so the halt-versus-run difference cancels it. Gain error scales the difference by at most 0.15%. The meter senses board power, so the difference includes clock tree and routing switched by the enable, not the gate logic alone. Rung 2's difference is about three standard errors from zero. Rung 3's is about ninety. The next protocol is fixed: read the core rail (VCCINT) through the module's regulator telemetry or a source-measure unit; at least 30 randomized interleaved A/B pairs; at least 10^9 gate evaluations per block; die temperature logged with an idle baseline before each block; gross and subtracted values both reported; the Vivado power estimate reported beside the reading with the discrepancy. Rung 3 is not a closed-loop plant joule cost, and the analytical constants of Section 3.4 are not calibrated by it.

The scientific reason for stage B is replication and inspection, not a new physical claim. A reader with a browser steps the same seed-1 episode and reads the same allow bit and reason codes that the crate prints. Agreement with stage A is the acceptance test for stage B, and it passes on seed 1. Agreement of decisions is the acceptance test for the Pt V2, and it passes on seed 1. A meter reading on a stated workload is the acceptance test for the KV260, and rungs 2 and 3 meet it at board level.

I.3.8 What is not a method of this paper

No human-subject study. No claim about linguistic relativity beyond the rejection in Section 5. No training-compute extrapolation. No identification of economic satiation, which is the companion paper. No optimization against Groq, Etched, or Taalas throughput. No world-model benchmark.

I.4. Results

All quantities in this section are simulated in the software reference unless a sentence cites an external paper. Analytical joules use Section 3.4. Only NI-9 is board-measured.

I.4.1 Claim NI-1. The commit record exists as a schema and a Rust type

Schemas `Proposal`, `Certificate`, `RefuseReason`, and `CommitDecision` are in `artifacts/schemas/wca.commit.v1/`. Rust types are in `crates/wca-commit/src/schema.rs`. Round-trip tests are `cargo test -p wca-commit`. This is an existence result about the reference, version `wca.commit.v1`. It is not a uniqueness theorem.

I.4.2 Claim NI-2. Seed-1 pendulum episode

Command, from `RESULTS.md`:

```
cargo run --release --bin wca-soc-loop -- \
  --steps 16 --init-theta 1.5 --init-omega 3.0 --seed 1
```

Reported outcome: committed = 1, refused = 15, analytical episode energy = 8.6795e-10 joule. The same committed and refused counts and the same analytical energy are reported for `--safe-ph` on that seed. `RESULTS.md` states that the single commit is step 6. Toolchain note in that file: Rust 1.98. Re-running the binary is the reproduction. The energy is not a measurement of a chip.

I.4.3 Claim NI-3. False allows of the Safe energy check

`wca-ph-tighten` compares discrete decisions to the continuous oracle `Vdot <= epsilon`. On a 21 cubed grid plus 200,000 near-threshold Monte Carlo samples (209,261 decisions):

Path	False allow	False refuse	Both allow	Both refuse
Legacy Q8.8	30836	105	104711	73609
Safe v1 (Q8.8 over-approximation)	0	42430	62386	104445
Safe v2 (Q16.16 residual)	0	79	104737	104445

`RESULTS.md` also states that a denser 41 cubed grid plus 50,000 Monte Carlo samples, checked in `cargo test`, asserts false allow equal to 0. Safe v2 cuts false refuses from 42,430 to 79 relative to Safe v1 while keeping false allows at 0. Legacy Q8.8 is not safe on this definition: it records 30,836 false allows. These counts are properties of the numerical test, not of a physical pendulum.

I.4.4 Claim NI-4. Toy barrier comparison, neither definition dominates

`wca-cbf-bakeoff` runs seeds 0 through 4, 40 steps, time step 0.05, action scale 2.5, shared demo TLMM and DiffLogic mask `21887`. The energy-set barrier uses `h = 18 - V` and allows when `h >= 0` and `omega * u <= kappa * h` with `kappa = 0.05`. The discrete shield allows a step that stays inside absolute theta at most 2 and absolute omega at most 4. Closed-loop means differ because trajectories diverge. The file reports per-episode means for commits and sums for violation counts. Selected rows:

Filter	Commit	Refuse	Analytical J	False allow vs PH	`h < 0`	`Vdot > epsilon`
`lut_and_safe_ph`	38	2.153e-09	0	4	0
`cbf_energy_set`	38	2.056e-09	3	0	3
`shield_discrete`	21	2.306e-09	90	38	90
`lut_only`	40	0	2.544e-09	194	220	194

On this plant and this oracle, `lut_and_safe_ph` has zero `Vdot` violations and four `h < 0` events. The energy-set barrier has zero `h < 0` events and three `Vdot` violations. The shield commits more and violates the energy oracle often. `lut_only` matches `always_allow` on violations in the reported table. Offline agreement on a shared always-allow stream of 200 steps gives 4 disagreements between `lut_and_safe_ph` and `cbf_energy_set`, and 70 against the shield.

Interpretation inside the test: passivity and set invariance are different predicates. The LUT-and-energy gate is not equivalent to an Ames filter, and it does not win every column. A full quadratic-program baseline on a richer plant is not in this table. That comparison remains open. The result that is available is the disagreement, which is evidence against collapsing the two certificates into one word.

I.4.5 Claim NI-5. Cart-pole Safe Lyapunov simulation

On the audit described in Section 3.2 (grid n = 7 plus 20,000 boundary samples inside the Lipschitz box, 26,487 decisions), Safe learned Lyapunov versus the continuous `Vdot` oracle records false allow 0, false refuse 3, both allow 15,925, both refuse 10,559. Closed-loop means over five seeds: `lut_and_safe_lyap` commits 11, refuses 28, analytical J 2.719e-09, and records zero false allows against that oracle. The level-set barrier on the same `V` commits 14 and records 15 energy-oracle violations. The discrete shield commits 29 and records 95. Same pattern as the pendulum: the Safe conjunct tracks its own oracle; a different certificate tracks a different one; permissiveness without the oracle is not safety.

This is one additional simulated plant. It does not establish the commit gate on industrial dynamics.

I.4.6 Claim NI-6. MCP demo

`artifacts/mcp_gate_demo.json` records four cases. The board-result flag in the file is false.

Case	Class	Executed	Executor calls	Commit
`read_only_bypass`	read-only	true	(no commit record)	absent
`irreversible_refuse`	irreversible	false	0	false
`irreversible_allow`	irreversible	true	1	true
`shell_exec_gated`	irreversible	true	(gated)	true

The refuse case lists `energy_veto` (`vdot` 6.0 against `eps` 0.05) and `cbf_veto`. Plant action on that case is `[0.0]`. The allow case uses compose `lut_and_safe_and_cbf` and plant action `[-0.02]`. The note in the file states that refuse never executes. This is a demo of the adapter, not a field study of computer-use agents.

I.4.7 Claim NI-7. TLMM under an analytical budget

`RESULTS.md` reports a demo 2 by 4, group 2 configuration near 4.24e-11 analytical joule, under the forward budget. The largest configurations that remain under the 2e-10 forward budget stop at 64 parameters. Widths 8 by 16 and above exceed that budget even after the optimizer. Iso-correctness against naive ternary arithmetic is a software comparison at tolerance 1e-12. These statements do not say that the design matches TeLLMe throughput or any board energy.

I.4.8 Claim NI-8. DiffLogic allow versus an energy teacher, toy only

On the hard multi-seed gate benchmark in `RESULTS.md`, after threshold calibration and denser labels, DiffLogic matches the energy teacher on refuse rate 50.0 plus or minus 15.9 percent, precision at threshold 0.890 plus or minus 0.067, and recall 0.802 plus or minus 0.076. A bitmask reference refuses more (71.0 plus or minus 14.9 percent) and recalls less (0.454 plus or minus 0.266). Before calibration, DiffLogic refuse rate was 57.5 plus or minus 14.1 percent with recall 0.724 plus or minus 0.163. The match is on this toy labeling setup. It is not an ImageNet or control-suite result. Internal utility per joule rises for the calibrated gate (3.570e9 versus 3.212e9 before) under the analytical model. As Section 3.4 states, that ratio uses commit count as utility.

I.4.9 Claim NI-9. Board-level joules of the gate fabric

Rung	Fabric	Clock	Difference (W)	Operation	Joules per operation	Label
1	Seed freerun vs board baseline	n/a	−0.8212 (SE 0.0024)	none	none	`measured_j`, watts only
2	Seed, halt vs run	about 100 MHz	+0.0098 (SE 0.0031)	one seed cycle	98.0 pJ (SE 30.8)	`measured_j`, INA260, SOM rail (`VCC_SOM`)
3	Gate, 8 lanes, halt vs run	25 MHz	+0.2857 (SE 0.0032)	one gate cycle, 8 decisions	11,428 pJ (SE 129)	`measured_j`, INA260, SOM rail (`VCC_SOM`)

N = 4 interleaved A/B/A passes per rung. Rung 1's negative sign means the seed bitstream draws less than the board's baseline bitstream. It does not mean the seed is free. Section 3.7 gives the limits of a board-level reading.

I.4.10 Safety and liveness

Zero false allows is safety. A gate that refuses everything is also safe, and useless. Liveness is the other axis: false refuses, and the share of tasks the gated agent completes. NI-3 reports both on the Safe grid. Safe v2 cuts false refuses from 42,430 to 79 at zero false allows. The seed-1 episode commits 1 step of 16, and that count alone does not say whether the plant reached its goal. The required report is a frontier per plant: task completion rate against false-allow rate, one point per compose mode of NI-4 (`lut_only`, `shield_discrete`, `cbf_energy_set`, `lut_and_safe_ph`), each point with its seeds and spread. On agent workloads the same frontier uses an attack suite for false allows and a benign task suite for completion. A gate is judged on the frontier, not on one axis.

I.4.11 What the scan supports

The state-of-the-art note dated with the September 2026 scans records no published system found that composes a learned Boolean allow LUT, a port-Hamiltonian or Lyapunov energy predicate, and a ternary LUT proposal as one commit boundary with bit-exact RTL simulation and an analytical joule account. Nearest neighbors are named there: shields, energy-aware barrier filters, logic networks as the whole model, and TLMM designs without an energy certificate. The scan supports a gap statement about the literature that was searched. It does not support a priority claim over unpublished work, and it does not support an energy-leadership claim.

I.5. Discussion

I.5.1 Scale does not answer the commit question

Kaplan, Hoffmann, Hooker, Sutton, and Epoch answer how proposal cost and loss behave. A larger proposer can still emit an action that fails `Vdot <= epsilon`. Putting that proposer behind the certificate uses scale where the evidence says scale works, and uses the predicate where scale is silent. The Bitter Lesson objects to frozen human features that block learning. It does not entail deleting a safety predicate. If a future result shows that an unconstrained policy meets the same false-allow test at lower analytical cost and equal task error, NI-3's engineering preference for the gate would be weakened on that plant. The logical distinction between proposal and permission would remain.

I.5.2 Natural language and MCP are transport and proposal

MCP solves discovery and call shape. System One solves some decisions without free-form generation. Neither object is `energy_ok`. The demo in NI-6 shows a refuse that does not call the executor. A production deployment could bypass the adapter. The claim is not that the protocol makes bypass impossible. The claim is that permission has to be a separate record if irreversible effects are to be auditable.

I.5.3 Strong linguistic determinism is not the claim

The strong hypothesis that language determines thought is not a premise. The operational statement is local. In this schema, a commit without a passing certificate is not a successful record. An untyped confidence string can be stored beside a success flag and still leave the reason unstated. The enum removes that particular ambiguity. It does not describe human cognition.

I.5.4 Formalism can be wasteful; this predicate is small

Requiring a proof of the whole agent at every step would dominate the budget. The reference formalizes one boundary. Read-only calls bypass. The Safe residual is a fixed-point inequality, not a general SMT query. NI-2's analytical episode energy is 8.6795e-10 joule under the stated constants, dominated by whatever the counters charge, and is still not a fraction of a generative model's board energy because that comparison was not measured. A split between proposal analytical joules and gate analytical joules on a real agent workload is not in the results. Until it is, the cost objection is open for large certificates and unanswered only for this toy gate.

I.5.5 A wrong model with a green light is a real failure

If `V` is not the plant's energy, `energy_ok` can be true while the plant is not safe. The mitigation present in the reference is a continuous twin on the toys, a separated reason code, and a refusal to treat a probability as a certificate. The mitigation not present is disturbance Input-to-State Stability, a verified region of attraction, or a Bayesian credibility budget of the kind Leung and Pare study. NI-4 is the evidence that two respectable certificates disagree. That disagreement is a reason to name the predicate, not a reason to trust either one outside its test.

I.5.6 Prior certificate theory is not duplicated here

Ames, Alshiekh, Dawson, and the runtime-monitoring papers already define filters and monitors. NI-1's addition is the product record and the composition with a LUT export and a tool executor in one reference. Where the toy barrier wins on set invariance, the paper says so (NI-4, NI-5). Composition is `cbf_ok` as another conjunct when that predicate is the one required. It is not a claim that the LUT computes the Ames quadratic program.

I.5.7 Predictors and specialized inference chips

World models reduce some prediction error and leave a residual. Specialized inference devices change the cost of proposals. Vendor throughput figures are vendor reports until an independent meter repeats them. The gate's job is the irreversible branch. If a device's only interface is a token stream, the commit record still has to live somewhere before actuators or irreversible tools run.

I.5.8 Analytical joules are not a costume for watts

The constants in Section 3.4 are chosen engineering numbers. They make counts comparable inside the repo. They are not calibrated to an Artix-7 rail. Selling them as board watts would be a false measurement report. The correct report is the one given: operation counts are computed; analytical joules are modeled; board joules come only from the KV260 meter and are filed apart. Stage B of Section 3.7 makes the same model inspectable in a browser at https://research.openie.dev/living/fpga-sim/. It does not change the measurement class. The KV260 rungs do, for the fabric they ran.

I.6. Limits and threats to validity

Internal validity. Seed-1 is one initial condition. The Safe grid is large but still a chosen box and a chosen epsilon. Monte Carlo samples near the threshold stress the boundary the designers chose to stress. A different epsilon or a different plant identity breaks the numerical claim until re-run. The CBF in the bake-off is an energy-set inequality implemented in the same crate, not an independently coded solver from an Ames reference implementation. Disagreement is informative. Absolute ranking against the literature's code is not established.

Construct validity. Commit count as utility does not measure task success. False allow is defined against a named oracle. A system can be oracle-safe and check-safe (zero false allows against `Vdot <= epsilon`) and still fail set-safe (`h >= 0`), which NI-4 shows. Readers who treat "safe" as one word will misread the table.

External validity. Both plants are toys. There is no manipulator, quadrotor, or human-in-the-loop trial. The MCP demo does not call a network. Verilog is simulated. The browser instrument is shipped as Stage B simulation. The Alchitry Pt V2 agrees on decisions and is unmetered. The KV260 reading is board level and open loop. Vendor logic-cell counts are not confirmed here.

Measurement validity. Analytical constants can be edited to any scale. Comparisons to Horowitz's picojoule tables, to Landauer's bound, or to vendor tokens per joule are not valid with these constants. The KV260 rungs are a board-level meter under a stated workload. A core-rail reading under the closed-loop episode is the missing measurement. Post-place-and-route tool power would be a third class, still not a meter, and it is not reported as a result.

Statistical reporting. Where `RESULTS.md` gives a mean and a standard deviation, this paper copies them. It does not add confidence intervals that were not computed. Multi-seed coverage is five seeds on the bake-offs and the hard gate benchmark's reported spreads. That is not a large-sample claim.

Claim hygiene. The following are not results: silicon joule leadership; operation near the Landauer bound; brain-equivalent power; a win over System One on latency; a win over world-model benchmarks; strong linguistic determinism; identification of "intelligence" with commit count.

Falsifiers. NI-2 is false if the stated command on the stated crate revision does not print those counts. NI-3 is false if the Safe v2 test reports a false allow on the stated grid. NI-6 is false if the refuse case in the demo file executes. NI-1 is false if the schema and the runtime diverge. A stage B emulator that disagrees with stage A on seed 1 fails its own acceptance test. A future meter that assigns board energy to the analytical number without a calibration study does not confirm the analytical model.

I.7. Conclusion

The paper defined a commit decision as a conjunctive certificate over a LUT allow bit and an energy predicate, with an optional barrier, and showed a software reference that emits the decision before an irreversible effect. On the reported pendulum tests, the Safe fixed-point rule has zero false allows against its continuous oracle `Vdot <= epsilon` on the stated test set, at the cost of 79 false refuses in 209,261 decisions. On the reported comparisons, that oracle is not the same as set invariance. Analytical episode energy for the seed-1 run is 8.6795e-10 joule under published

constants. Tool refuse in the MCP demo does not call the executor. Verilog checks are simulation. The browser WASM and WebGPU instrument is available at https://research.openie.dev/living/fpga-sim/ so that the same decision can be inspected without a board. It remains a simulation, not a DUT result. The Alchitry Pt V2 agrees with the software on every decision of seed 1 and stays unmetered. The KV260 meters the gate fabric at board level: 11,428 pJ per eight-lane gate cycle at 25 MHz. The reference is a measured software artifact and a board-metered fabric. The closed-loop chip joule is the next measurement.

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Local measurement record: `artifacts/RESULTS.md` in the `wca-lut-edge` software reference. KV260 meter record: `artifacts/stage-c/wca-kv260-meter/` (protocol, claim status, A/B/A logs and summaries). Schema examples: `artifacts/schemas/wca.commit.v1/examples/`. Demo: `artifacts/mcp_gate_demo.json`.

I. Appendix A. Reproducibility

Workstation path used to generate the cited logs: the `wca-lut-edge` tree, Rust 1.98 as recorded in `RESULTS.md`. Day-to-day commands:

```
cargo test -p wca-commit
cargo run --release --bin wca-soc-loop -- \
  --steps 16 --init-theta 1.5 --init-omega 3.0 --seed 1
cargo run --release --bin wca-soc-loop -- \
  --steps 16 --init-theta 1.5 --init-omega 3.0 --seed 1 --safe-ph
cargo run --release --bin wca-ph-tighten -- --grid 21 --out artifacts/ph_tighten_report.json
cargo run --release --bin wca-cbf-bakeoff -- --out artifacts/cbf_bakeoff_report.json
cargo run --release --bin wca-lyap-plant -- --out artifacts/lyap_plant_report.json
cargo run --release --bin wca-mcp-gate -- --demo
cargo run --release --bin wca-tlmm-scale -- --out artifacts/tlmm_scale_report.json
```

Icarus Verilog was version 12.0 in the environment note in `RESULTS.md`. RTL checks are simulation. Do not read analytical joules as board power.

Repository flag, factual, not a result: FPGA board result claimed for the KV260 Stage C rungs 1 to 3 only (Section 3.7), at board level. Every other result in this paper is simulation or analytical.

I. Appendix B. Browser FPGA emulator: architecture to build

This appendix describes the Stage B emulator architecture. The shipped instrument lives at https://research.openie.dev/living/fpga-sim/. Seed-1 agreement numbers below are from the WASM run against the Stage A golden.

Modules.

1. `decision_core`. Pure functions already represented by the Rust certificate, plant step, and joule accumulator. No file system and no threads required. Target `wasm32-unknown-unknown`.
2. `lut_image`. The same memory image the Verilog path loads (`artifacts/fpga/wca_allow_lut.mem` and successors). The browser copy must hash-match the file used for the Icarus check.
3. `trace`. A fixed schema: step index, state, `u`, `lut_allow`, `energy_ok`, `cbf_ok`, reason codes, analytical joule increment, plant action. Identical field names to `wca.commit.v1` so a dump can be diffed against the crate's JSON.
4. `webgpu_view`. Device, queue, and a storage buffer for the LUT and the trace. A shader draws allow and refuse. A second dispatch may map the Safe residual across a grid. Buffers are for inspection. They are not a power model.
5. `workstation_oracle`. Icarus remains the RTL oracle. The browser does not replace it. Disagreement between WASM and the Rust binary fails the build. Disagreement between WASM and Icarus on the shared LUT image fails the build. Neither comparison mentions watts.

Acceptance tests, to be run when the target exists.

- Seed-1, 16 steps, init theta 1.5, omega 3.0: committed 1, refused 15, analytical joule 8.6795e-10, matching NI-2.
- Safe grid smoke: false allow 0 on a published subset of the 209,261-decision test, matching NI-3's direction.
- MCP refuse vector: executor call count 0, matching NI-6.
- A unit test that WebGPU buffer readback equals the WASM trace. If readback is unavailable, the page must show that the GPU path did not confirm the trace, and the CPU WASM trace remains the result.

Physical follow-on for board joules. Stage C already programmed a closed-loop commit-gate on the Alchitry Pt V2 with UART decision agreement; the board still has no onboard joule meter. A USB inline power meter or a shunt-plus-scope on the 5 V rail, on a stated workload, is what would support a board-measured joule. Vivado / post-PAR estimates are not that meter. Vendor logic-cell and memory figures stay vendor figures. See /living/fpga-sim/alchitry/#energy.

Out of scope for the emulator: training DiffLogic in the browser, claiming Artix-7 dynamic power from a shader, and flipping the board-result flag to true.

I. Appendix C. Relation to the companion studies

The research catalog triad is Navigation / Commit / task completion. This paper is Commit.

"Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound in AI Demand" uses the same commit record for a different predicate: stop when a stated work or care loop is complete. The shared sentence is compositional. Refuse if the chore is already complete, or if the physical predicate fails. This paper supplies the physical predicate and the measurement classes. It does not estimate a demand curve.

"Mixture of Limits" is the navigation rule: use the cheapest gear that is sufficient, with named floors that say when refuse is success. Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model is its standard instance. It does not replace the commit record defined here.

"Spell Check is Global" records the path. A spelling suggestion is a proposal. Acceptance is the commit. The study does not replace the commit record.

Part II. The cascade (Mixture of Limits)

II. Abstract

Mixture of Limits is a navigation rule for computer intelligence: there exist floors past which additional tokens, parameters, or joules do not purchase verifiable progress on a task coordinate. The rule rests on information theory and physics. Across human scientific history, compression into predictive formulas and invariants has repeatedly beaten excess enumeration of observations: from Kepler's laws over Tycho's tables, through Newton's closed forms, to Shannon's bit accounting and Landauer's thermodynamic floor on irreversible erasure. Mixture of Limits operationalizes that lineage for machines. Its standard instance is Lookup → Formula → Solver/settle → Model, with close owned as propose → certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Unstructured front doors (speech, pixels, free text) need a dual-phase

stack: Phase 1 is a bounded ultra-light quantized transducer that emits a typed AST or schema; Phase 2 is the Mixture of Limits cascade. Perception is a front gear, not a demotion of the last cascade stage for residual reasoning.

The industry default escalates Mixture-of-Experts (MoE) capacity *inside* a generative corridor. Mixture of Limits instead names floors *outside* generation: Value of Information (VoI), grammar coverage, Landauer/joule estimate, certificate, and settle-refuse. The industry race is a race to those plateau floors, not unbounded scale: once VoI is zero past the floor, optimize energy/compute on the plateau. Mixture of Limits demotes the neural net to a residual leaf. Software reference `mol prove` is constructive existence in software. Catalog and Landauer figures on receipts are estimates; package `measured_j` appears only when a labeled meter returns a reading.

II. Terms used here

Software reference has one meaning in this paper: the software reference path that implements the navigation rule and verifies it against its specification, without board synthesis or package metering. Receipts on that path label energy as estimate and leave `measured_j` unset until a named meter returns. Software reference is not a second, looser evidence class for live silicon. Periodic Stack, replay class, value of information, evidence classes, and the board-result flag are defined on the shared glossary.

Model leaf (one sentence). The model gear is a conditionally available residual: off by default (`allow_model=false`), opened only when cheaper gears miss, and never coercible to Deterministic (`ModelGenerated` cannot be rewritten as `Deterministic`).

Living figures for claims on this page. Cascade: /living/mol/#mol-diag-01. Named floors: /living/mol/#mol-diag-02. Commit or refuse then receipt: /living/mol/#mol-diag-03. MoE contrast: /living/mol/#mol-tab-01.

II. The law before the survey

Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model last. That order is one instance of the philosophy in Section II.2. Floors stop escalation when more bits stop buying outcomes: VoI, grammar, energy estimate, certificate, settle-refuse. Close is propose → certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Section 8 is a survey of plateau options under that law. It is not the law.

Each class of embodiment reaches a limit. A decision model stops at a typed probability. A bounded ask stops at a typed value or at not-sure. A statechart stops at a legal transition. An energy-based settle stops at a low-energy configuration. A visual editor stops at the chart a person can audit. None of them is the whole intelligence. The convergence is hybrid interplay: the chart is the door, the decision model may fill a proposal, the energy settle may score a configuration, and something outside the model still commits or refuses. Mixture of Limits is the navigation rule of that interplay. Refuse is success. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. Correctness is the gate, and among systems that pass it, joules alone order them. §8.5.1 places the public instances under that law. It does not replace the law.

II.1. Introduction: pursuit of limits toward AGI

The dominant construction for computer intelligence (CI) treats the neural net as the substrate and excess tokens as the growth variable. That construction diverges from the historical method that produced reliable science. When Brahe enumerated planetary positions, the tables were necessary but not the law. Kepler compressed years of positions into three predictive relations. Newton further compressed those relations into invariants and closed forms that travel across domains. The same pattern recurs wherever a grammar of nature is covered: a short formula outruns an infinite ledger of cases.

Information theory names the modern accounting of that pattern. Shannon (1948) prices bits under uncertainty as established results. Value of Information (VoI) prices whether another observation is worth its cost for a decision. Landauer (1961) prices irreversible bit erasure in joules at temperature T: $E_{\min} = k_B T \ln 2$ per bit erased in the ideal model. That Landauer quantity is a thermodynamic lower bound and, on Mixture of Limits receipts, a labeled estimate, not a wattmeter reading. Together they imply floors: past a point, more bits stop buying outcomes that matter for a stated benefit.

Thesis. Pursuit of limits is the path toward AGI-grade reliability. Excess-token and MoE scaling diverge from true VoI for a given benefit. Mixture of Limits is the executable navigation rule that binds those floors (VoI, grammar, Landauer/joules as estimate, certificate, settle-refuse) against industry Mixture-of-Experts. The industry race is a race to the plateau floors, not unbounded scale: once VoI is zero past a named floor, more parameters and tokens buy nothing verifiable on that coordinate. Only energy/compute optimization on the plateau remains. Addendum: Shannon, Landauer, Kolmogorov/Solomonoff/Chaitin, Howard (VoI), and formula-first science AI already state these floors as settled theory. The remaining bottleneck is applied mathematics embodied in materials and physical hardware. Frontier addendum (§8.4-§8.14): SOTA at the plateau. Once the floor is known and Value of Information is zero past it, the only remaining work is optimize energy and compute on that plateau: cheapest-sufficient Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model. Deeper latents, energy-based hybrids, world models, test-time compute, super learning, SSM hybrids, mixture of experts, transmission / gearing / cascade / memory-context / test-time methods, and the cross-field plateau moves in §8.14 are implementation options for plateau spend, not a narrative race among generators. They do not cancel VoI, grammar, energy, or certify floors. Mixture of Limits remains the navigation rule. §8.5.1 is a separate claim, not another plateau option: each embodiment class stops at its own object, and the convergence is hybrid interplay under this law. Dual-phase perception (§11.1) bounds the unstructured front door without retiring the last cascade stage for residual reasoning. The hardware-economics reading (§8.12) states that computers are hardware, software is applied engineering under constraints, and plateau spend still binds to floors on real devices. §8.13 organizes verified public reports by technique (transmission, gearing/MoE routing, cascade, memory/context, and test-time) as sources for plateau options. §8.14 races major AI/ML fields to the floor that binds each.

This paper's contribution is the study prose for that law as published on research.openie.dev, grounded in the cleanroom `mixture-of-limits` software reference (Apache-2.0 OR MIT). Companion studies already on this site supply the commit-record interface (Metered Commit Gates, Part I (Notational Intelligence)) and the economic stop after free digital inference (Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound in AI Demand). Mixture of Limits is the navigation rule those companions sit under: NI owns irreversible commit shape; Satiation owns task completion; Mixture of Limits owns *which gear closes* and *when refuse is success*.

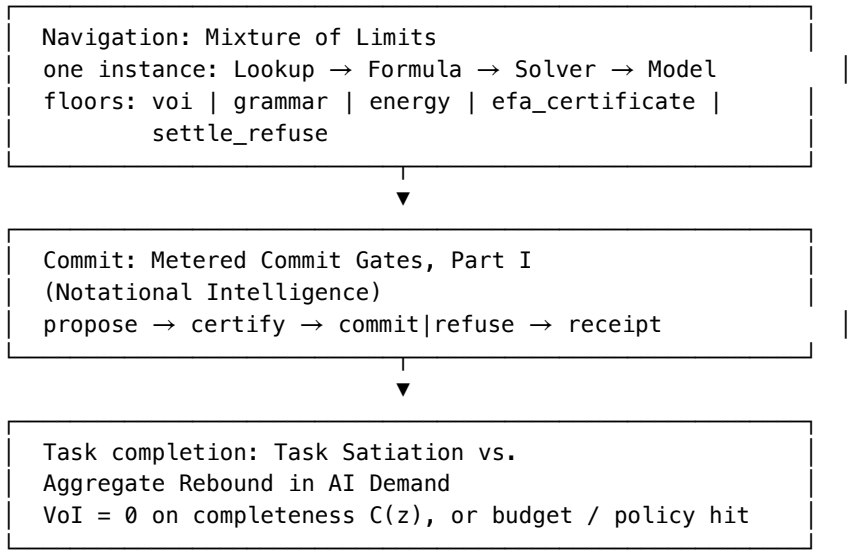
Three measurement facts constrain every later number. First, joules from catalog surrogates and OpCounter-style analytics are estimates, not board power. Second, Landauer annotations are estimates, distinct from RAPL/NVML/`measured_j`. Third, no FPGA board result claimed; package `measured_j` is set only when a Metered probe returns a reading.

II. Companion papers

Three studies on this catalog form one stack: Navigation, Commit, and task completion. They compose. They do not collapse into one paper. A fourth study, Metabolic Intelligence, owns the energy-budget envelope and actuators that make those floors bind at tag and campus scale.

Role	Study	Owns
Navigation	Mixture of Limits	Which gear closes: Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model. Floors include Value of Information (VoI), grammar coverage, energy estimate, Energy-First Architecture (EFA) / certificate refuse, and settle-refuse.
Commit	Metered Commit Gates, Part I (Notational Intelligence)	Irreversible close shape: propose → certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Notational Intelligence owns the commit record. Analytical joules here are estimates; package `measured_j` only when Metered.
Task completion	Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound in AI Demand	Stop when VoI is zero on a stated completeness predicate, or when budget / policy refuse fires. Free at the margin for digital inference is not free joules and not free actuation.
Energy budget / metabolic embodiment	Metabolic Intelligence	Budget envelope and actuators: binding classifiers, $J(m \mid q)$ obtain-router, OpenADR/MQTT campus service. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed.

Role	Study	Owns
A coding instance	The Reality Code Engine	Mixture of Limits applied to code: gears run cheapest first, a resolver is paid once per new case, and extraction keeps the least-joule fit among equivalent fits. Correctness is the gate; joules are the ranking. Its economics companion is The Promised Trillion Dollar AI-Coding Market.
Automation path	Spell Check is Global	An existence proof that some computer intelligence commoditizes to bundled zero price: spell check's marginal cost fell to about zero, and it complemented hardware and editors people already have. Access framing, not a census: the many (7B+), not the few who rent frontier datacenters (<500M).




```mermaid
flowchart TB
  NAV["Navigation<br/>Mixture of Limits<br/>Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model"]
  COM["Commit<br/>Metered Commit Gates, Part I (Notational Intelligence)<br/>propose → certify → commit|re
  ECO["Task completion<br/>Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound<br/>VoI = 0 or budget hit"]
  NAV --> COM --> ECO
```

Mixture of Limits owns *which gear closes* and *when refuse is success*. Notational Intelligence owns the irreversible commit shape. Satiation owns task completion. In Spell Check is Global the nonword gear is Lookup, then a short edit, on hardware that is available, accessible, and capable. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed; estimates ≠ `measured_j`. The shared thesis and its gate form are stated once, in Part I, Companion papers.

II. OpenIE map (no prior literacy assumed)

This study lives inside the OpenIE family of sites. Readers do not need those sites memorized; the map below states what each surface is and where Mixture of Limits sits.

Surface	URL	What it is	Relation to Mixture of Limits
Research (this hub)	research.openie.dev	Readable studies, PDFs, and living figures. This paper is `/papers/gates/#part-ii-the-cascade-mixture-of-limits`; companions are Notational Intelligence (`/papers/gates/`), Satiation (`/papers/satiation/`), Metabolic Intelligence (`/products/mei/`), and Spell Check is Global (`/papers/spellcheck/`).	Publishes the navigation-rule study prose and software reference measurement bounds.
Stack	stack.openie.dev	Teaching map of the family: information theory, game theory, and mechanism design as one substrate; directory of the eight periodic stacks.	Orientation layer. Mixture of Limits is not "another stack card"; it is the navigation rule that chooses cheapest-sufficient close across stack coordinates.
Compute	compute.openie.dev	Periodic Stack of Computation: 258 primitives / 33 families, thermodynamic floor every sibling inherits.	The primitive table Mixture of Limits navigates. Software reference verifies, against its specification, the full live catalog (258 Present / 258 live Lookup/Formula/Solver/Navigate gears) plus honest HW Gap cells; HW Gaps software reference sims ×8 (`physical_settle…photonic_mzi`) + Ferric/Stage C inventories are in proof with Gap cells retained. μ calib + silicon meters remain outside software reference proof. Empty HW cells → `primitive_gap`. estimates≠measured_j; `stage_c_measured=false` until meters.
Knowledge	knowledge.openie.dev	Working definition of a claim as seven axes ⟨valid time, transaction time, reference time, granularity, scope, certainty, provenance⟩.	Typed claims and cite/compose leaves (Z2 cite / Z1 compose in software reference) bind to this object shape. Mixture of Limits does not redefine knowledge; it refuses escalation when grammar and VoI say the claim coordinate is already covered.
Synthesis	synthesis.openie.dev	Periodic Stack of Digital Information Synthesis: AI as software; zones $Z_1/Z_2/Z_3$; cost surface $E(x) = \sum \theta(p) \cdot \mu(p, H)$.	Plateau spend and cascade order rhyme with synthesis zones (closed-form → constrained → unbounded). Mixture of Limits owns floors outside generation (VoI, grammar, energy estimate, certify, settle-refuse), so Z_3-style generation stays the last cascade stage.
Verify	proof.openie.dev	Periodic Stack of Verification: cheapest-sufficient solver under $E(x) \geq \theta(D) \cdot \mu(S, V)$.	Cousin energy law. Mixture of Limits uses the same spine form for path energy; Verify maps verified artifacts; Mixture of Limits maps which gear closes before commit.
Product	klere.ai	Klere: OpenIE product home. Metabolic Intelligence is designed for Klere (research owns the law/class; Klere owns product embodiment). Public site is thin access / energy-efficient AI framing (Oct 2026), not a shipped feature catalog.	MEI envelope and Mixture of Limits navigation feed Klere's product embodiment. Software reference DX remains `mol.yaml` / `mol run` until Klere packaging ships.

One paragraph. Stack teaches the family map. Compute names the permitted-act primitives. Knowledge defines the claim object those primitives carry. Synthesis places digital information synthesis on a cost surface and zone grammar. Verify prices verified artifacts under a related energy inequality. Research hosts the studies. Klere (klere.ai) is the product home (MEI designed for Klere; thin public site; no invented features). Mixture of Limits is the navigation rule across that family: Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model, with named floors that stop escalation when more bits stop buying outcomes. It is not a rebrand of Mixture-of-Experts, not a substitute for the Periodic Stack pages, and not a claim that software reference software measures board package joules.

Other names this paper uses without treating them as assumed literacy: MathGround denotes the OpenIE cascade / replay-class discipline that enforces Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model; WCA denotes capability / certify refuse adapters (live MCP path remains software reference roadmap); leapfrog / **`openie-path`** denotes ask-bridge adapters (stubs on the verified path). Living companions for this study: /living/mol/. FPGA commit figures for NI: /living/fpga-sim/.

Scope. Companion papers (Navigation / Commit / task completion) and the OpenIE map above name the catalog triad and stack / compute / knowledge / synthesis / verify / research before any later allusion. Section 2 states the law and Periodic Stack navigation. Section 3 states the cost model $E(x) \geq \theta(D) \cdot \mu(S, V)$. Section 4 describes the cascade and close/receipt bind. Section 5 bridges to Satiation without rewriting it. Section 6 maps prove↔claim. Section 7 sketches VoI, grammar, and settle-refuse mathematics. Section 8 places related work as a verified citation chain (historical→recent proof points) plus Tier A formula/mechanism systems, then teaches latent space, Logical Intelligence (energy-based model / large language model / latent hybrid), the hybrid-interplay convergence of embodiment-class limits (§8.5.1), World Labs (spatial world models), and SOTA at the plateau (§8.7): once VoI is zero past the floor, plateau spend is the only work: test-time compute, super learning, live SOTA methods (SSMs, MoE, RAG, speculative decode, ...), SSM hybrids / MoE / implementation efficiency (including Jamba-class, DeepSeek, GLM as options), hardware economics (including edge / neuromorphic software reference), plateau techniques for transmission / gearing / cascade / memory-context / test-time (§8.13), industry gap levers (Mixture-of-Depths, AWQ/GPTQ/FP8, vLLM/SGLang; §8.10.1), and the cross-field race to plateau floors table (§8.14: RLHF, diffusion, GNNs, multimodal, federated/continual, pruning/KD/NAS, Bayesian/conformal/causal/active, GraphRAG, agent memory, structured generation, CUDA Graphs). Section 9 contrasts Mixture of Limits with Mixture-of-Experts and situates model-to-model field systems. Section 10 opens toward AGI via limits. Section 11 states engineering gaps to close (dual-phase front-door perception, O(1) meta-routing, Primitive Distillation for open grammars, Tier 0/1/2 measurement realism, and a declarative DX roadmap) as plateau work under the same floors, not apologies.

II.2. Floors where more bits stop buying outcomes

Mixture of Limits asserts: for a task coordinate, there exist floors such that additional tokens, parameters, or joules do not purchase verifiable progress. Intelligence is therefore a navigation rule over a structured stack of primitives; not an invitation to dump residual capacity into a generative corridor.

A philosophy, not one cascade. The floor is the least spend that closes the task. Spend past it is waste: if Lookup, Formula, or Solver already covers the coordinate, opening a generator is waste. The plateau names the same point (threshold convergence): once VoI is zero past the floor, optimize energy/compute on the plateau. Mixture of Limits is that philosophy. It is not one fixed cascade or one selector. Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model is one instance. Any selector that stops where additional joules no longer purchase verifiable progress is another. The σ-law selector of the agency paper is one such instance, and its preregistered runs compare it with a fixed cascade.

Consequences:

1. Mathematical compression / formulas beat excess tokens when the grammar is covered.
2. Neural nets are a conditionally available residual leaf (off by default; never coercible to Deterministic), not the default substrate of CI.
3. Routing is cheapest-sufficient: escalate only on miss; refuse when escalation is unsafe or VoI-negative.
4. Proof / energy cost model: $E(x) \geq \theta(D) \cdot \mu(S, V)$ with labeled joule receipts; Landauer labeled as estimate.
5. Available devices / multi-fabric: after a cascade gear closes, pick the cheapest sufficient device class; not one accelerator by default.

Where the model sits. Model last is an order of trial. It is not a verdict on what models can do. Snell, Lee, Xu and

Kumar showed that a compute-optimal schedule of test-time compute beats a best-of-N baseline by more than 4x in efficiency, and that on some problems test-time compute can stand in for a larger model (arXiv:2408.03314). That result is about the schedule inside the model gear. Mixture of Limits prices that schedule in joules like any other gear. The model gear opens whenever the cheaper gears cannot close $C(z)$, and it opens first when they pass too rarely to pay for their failures. Proposition 9 of the agency track states that condition exactly.

Figure 2 draws the floor and the plateau for one task.

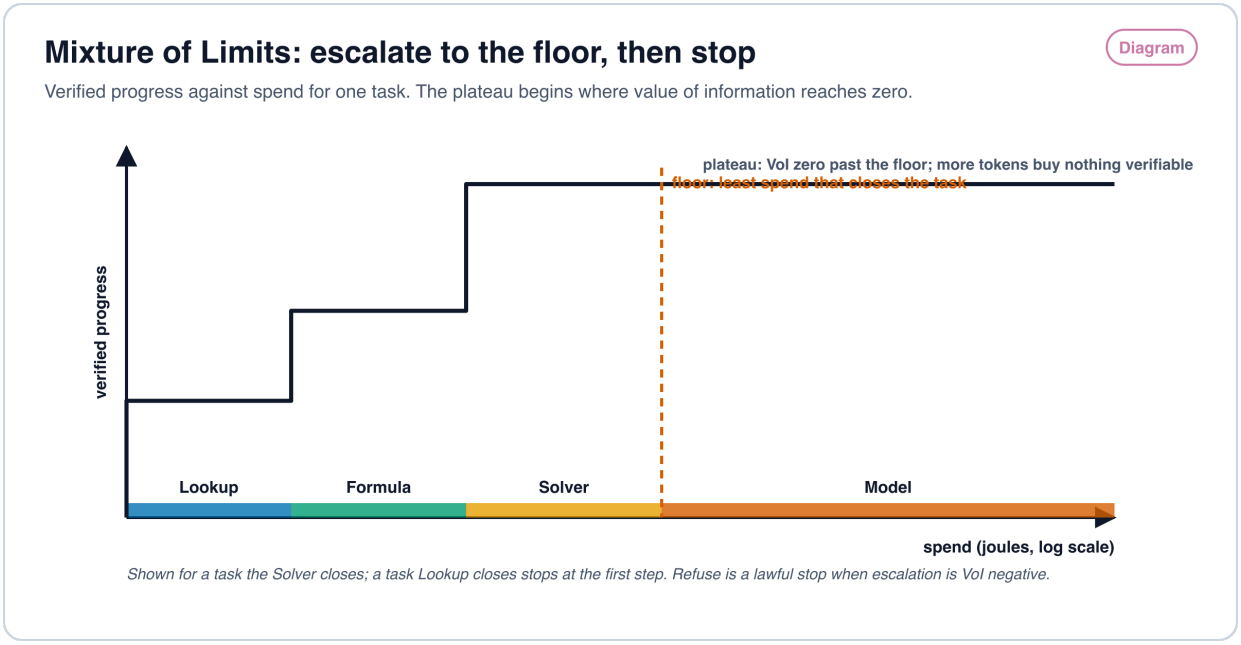


Figure 2. Mixture of Limits on one task. Diagram, not a measurement: verified progress rises in steps through the cascade until the floor, and spend past the floor buys no verified progress (Section II.8.7). A PNG copy is provided.

II. Named floors

Limit id	Kind	Meaning
`voi`	ValueOfInformation	Marginal bits worthless under budget. stop
`grammar`	GrammarCoverage	Covered by Lookup/Formula/Solver; or refuse unknown
`energy`	Energy	Joule budget floor; Landauer-aware estimates
`efa_certificate`	Certificate	Diverge / fail certify → refuse before commit
`settle_refuse`	SettleRefuse	Ternary / energy-landscape settle will not settle → refuse
`primitive_gap`	PrimitiveGap	Missing Periodic Stack primitive; surface the gap
`safety` / `wca_refuse`	Safety / WCA	Capability deny; WCA certify refuse
`information` / `latency`	Information / Latency	Sufficiency and soft wall-clock ceilings

II. Neural net demotion

The model gear is a conditionally available residual: off by default (`allow_model=false`), opened only when cheaper gears miss, and never coercible to Deterministic (`ModelGenerated` cannot be rewritten as `Deterministic`). It may propose residual content; it never bypasses certify-before-commit. Coin-cell / edge power is O(1) formula plus LUT refuse, not a tiny transformer.

II. Periodic Stack

Mixture of Limits navigates the OpenIE Periodic Stack of Computation at compute.openie.dev (258 primitives / 33 families). Sibling maps: stack.openie.dev (family directory), knowledge.openie.dev (seven-axis claim), synthesis.openie.dev (synthesis zones / cost surface). The software reference proves an in-tree live catalog navigator with

258 Present cells (all live Lookup/Formula/Solver/Navigate) + honest Gap markers and scale notes citing 258/33. HW Gaps software reference sims ×8 + Ferric/Stage C inventories are in software reference proof (Gap cells retained; `stage_c_measured=false`). μ calibration corpora and silicon meters remain outside software reference proof scope. Empty cells surface as `primitive_gap`.

II. The cascade lineage

Mixture of Limits is threshold convergence: spend until the next unit no longer buys verifiable progress, then stop. Its parts have a lineage. Anytime algorithms and their performance profiles trade computation for quality with an interruptible stop (Dean and Boddy 1988). Attentional cascades reject easy cases with cheap stages first (Viola and Jones 2001). Model cascading sends an input to a larger model only when a smaller one is unsure (Varshney and Baral 2022); speculative decoding lets a small model draft and a large one verify (Leviathan et al. 2023); Mixture-of-Depths allocates compute per token inside one model (Raposo et al. 2024). The plateau is measured: reasoning models spend tokens after the first correct answer that do not change it (Chen et al. 2024), and a survey of efficient reasoning collects the methods that stop earlier (Sui et al. 2025). Mixture of Limits takes the stop from these works, puts it on the task predicate $C(z)$ and prices it in joules. Proposition 9 of the agency paper is the condition under which the cheapest-first order is optimal.

II. Mixture of Limits is not MoE

MoE (generative corridor)	Mixture of Limits (navigation rule)
Experts live *inside* a model; gate selects parameters	Limits live *outside* generation; floors stop escalation
More experts → more capacity for the same generative act	More named floors → sharper refuse / cheaper close
Success = next-token likelihood	Success = closed grammar + certified commit + joule receipt
Model is the substrate	Model is a residual leaf: the last gear tried, opened when cheaper gears cannot close $C(z)$

Clean-room policy: Mixture of Limits is a rule plus a runtime, not a wrapper on MoE, and not a path-dependent fork of sibling OpenIE trees for the verified path.

II.3. Cost model: E(x) ≥ θ(D) · μ(S,V)

The energy / impedance cost model used throughout Mixture of Limits is:

$$E(x) \geq \theta(D) \cdot \mu(S, V)$$

where $E(x)$ is path energy for closing act x, $\theta(D)$ scales with decision / difficulty structure D, and $\mu(S, V)$ is an impedance factor for stack coordinate S and view V. Software reference receipts stamp catalog μ with `mu_source=catalog` and a `landauer_floor_ratio`. The product is an analytical / catalog estimate, not a package joule reading.

Status of the spine. θ and μ are catalog constants. So the inequality is a cost model with stated constants. It prices a gear before any joule is spent. It is not derived from physics. The physical floor under it is Landauer's, below. What ranks a closed act is the metered joules on its receipt, behind the gate $C(z)$ (Proposition 8 of the agency track).

Landauer (estimate only). For irreversible erasure of n bits at temperature T,

$$E_{\text{Landauer}}(n, T) = nk_B T \ln 2$$

Receipts may annotate `landauer_floor_J` from this formula. That annotation is estimate ≠ measured. Software reference closes keep `measured_j=None`. Optional OS meter features (RAPL / IOReport / powermetrics), when present and successful, may populate `measured_j` only under a labeled `MeasureSource`; failure or VM stays `unavailable`. Software reference prove criteria do not require those meters.

Historical rhyme. Kepler did not need every future observation once the three laws closed the grammar of planetary motion for the epoch. Newton did not need a larger ephemeris table to predict a new orbit once F=ma and inverse-square gravitation covered the coordinate. Shannon did not need infinite samples to bound channel capacity. Landauer did not need a particular chip to state a thermodynamic lower bound. Mixture of Limits spine is the same move for CI: bind a floor, close cheapest-sufficient, refuse when the floor says stop. This is an analogy, offered to teach. The evidence is the receipts and the propositions.

Constructive existence (software). Software reference `cargo run -p mol-cli -- prove` prints VERIFIED per criterion and exits 0 (~29 software reference criteria spanning deterministic close, formula/lookup without model, VoI refuse, settle commit+refuse, certificate refuse, capability default-deny, receipt labels, replay-class coercion deny, Periodic Stack subset navigation, μ catalog, transcript replay, Z2 cite / Z1 compose, agent mailbox, bitemporal memory, fabric routing, desktop headless shell, OS meter labels, WASM capsule, Agent Lane, multi-fabric receipts, ecosystem e2e certify; see PLAN.md in the Mixture of Limits workspace). That is constructive existence in software: an implementation exists and passes every stated criterion. It is not the proof of a theorem, and it is not a board energy measurement. Prove↔claim mapping is Leapfrog-owned (§6).

II.4. Cascade and close: Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model

MathGround / OpenIE cascade order (type-enforced replay classes; synthesis zones and compute primitives on synthesis.openie.dev and compute.openie.dev):

```
Lookup → Formula (closed-form) → Solver / settle → Model
```

Mixture of Limits tier	Role	Replay class (typical)
Lookup	LUT / allow-table / registry hit	`Deterministic`
Formula	Closed identity / unit convert / law instance	`Deterministic`
Solver	Sparse solve / ternary settle	`Deterministic` or compose under Solver
Model	Stochastic residual only	`ModelGenerated`

Invariant: `ModelGenerated` ↛ `Deterministic`. Typed answers refuse coercion.

Automation / close loop:

```
sense → classify grammar → cheapest sufficient → certify → commit|refuse → receipt
```

Mixture of Limits owns close. Refuse over escalate when unsafe or VoI-negative. Refuse is a lawful success and still emits a receipt.

II. co/0 bind sketch (namespaces)

Software reference receipt labels bind act namespaces in the spirit of OpenIE co/0 receipts (sketch, not a live leapfrog path-dep):

Namespace	Role
`claim.*`	Seeded / retrieved knowledge claims (Z2); unknown → refuse, no invent
`act.*`	Capability-gated acts; Mutate/External default-deny
`close.*`	Route + certify gate; commit or refuse
`receipt.*`	`estimated_j` labeled; `measured_j` only if Metered probe returned; no FPGA board result claimed

Rules stamped on every software reference close:

1. Certify-before-commit; no irreversible side effect without certificate pass.
2. **`ModelGenerated` ↛ `Deterministic`**; sealed replay markers.
3. **`measured_j`** only if Metered; otherwise `None` / unavailable.
4. Refuse = lawful success + receipt. VoI / settle_refuse / certificate / capability denies still close the ledger.

Multi-fabric software reference: after tier selection, route cheapest sufficient `DeviceKind` (Cpu always present; Gpu*/Wasm/ThermoSettle/… optional). Detection ≠ joules.

When the order is optimal. A fixed order from cheapest up is optimal in expected joules when each cheap gear passes often enough to pay for its failures. For a light gear L ahead of a heavy gear H that always passes, light first wins if and only if $q_L c_H > c_L$, where q_L is the light gear's pass probability and c is joules. For independent gears the optimal order sorts by pass probability per joule, p/c (Simon and Kadane 1975, DOI:10.1016/0004-3702(75)90002-8). Proposition 9 of the agency track proves both. When the condition fails, the cascade starts at the heavier gear. Under a binding joule budget, the joules of failed light attempts stay spent, and a selector that prices pass probability against joules can close tasks the fixed order cannot. Section 8.11 of the agency track reports a first kernel-reported comparison.

II.5. Stop bridge: Satiation

Mixture of Limits supplies the *machine* stop: VoI and grammar floors refuse excess generation once benefit is covered; commit/refuse receipts (NI) record the irreversible boundary. The economics companion Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound in AI Demand defines satiation as a stop on a written completeness predicate. Its reading of falling inference prices is in Satiation, Section 8.2.

Satiation owns task completion and its price tables; NI owns the commit record; Mixture of Limits owns navigation floors that make "done" and "unsafe" executable without opening the model leaf.

II.6. Prove ↔ claim map

The Mixture of Limits constructive prove is not a leaderboard stunt. It is an information-theoretic close rule rooted in physics: the same historical arc that took astronomy from excess epicycles to Kepler/Newton predictive floors, and that takes computation from Shannon → Landauer → complexity / VoI toward named energy floors. Global academia already holds those proof points; the bottleneck is applied math × materials (hardware) embodiment, not awareness of the slogans. This section only maps what `mol prove` actually stamps `VERIFIED` onto paper `claim.*` ids: embodiment of known floors, not invention of new physics.

A claim is implemented and verified against its specification when the in-tree harness prints `VERIFIED` for the named criterion and exits 0. That is software existence. It is not a theorem, and it is not independent replication. A claim is software reference only when PLAN §6 marks it OUT OF PROOF SCOPE, or when the criterion itself stamps software reference / fixture / feature-gated behavior rather than live silicon. Verified-path rows keep `measured_j=None` (or Metered only when a probe returns) and no FPGA board result claimed.

Measurement labels used below (OpenIE measurement grammar):

Label	Meaning
Unmetered	Software-ref / software reference path; `measured_j=None`; estimate may be labeled
Estimated	Catalog / Landauer / fuel / μ surrogate with explicit `EstimateKind` or `mu_source=catalog`
Metered	Optional live probe (`energy-meter`) returned numbers (not required for prove)

Default close path for all verified claims: Unmetered (+ Estimated where μ / Landauer / fuel appear). No FPGA board result claimed everywhere in the verified path.

II.6.1 Harness meta

Prove #	Criterion (PLAN)	Paper claim id	Status	Measurement
P0	`cargo test --workspace` green	`claim.mol.ci_workspace`	Verified against specification (CI / operator; not printed by `mol prove`)	-
P1	`cargo run -p mol-cli -- prove` exits 0	`claim.mol.prove_harness`	Verified against specification (prints `VERIFIED` per row below)	Unmetered

II.6.2 Verified claims (P2-P24)

Prove #	Criterion (PLAN)	Paper claim id	Claim (one sentence)	Software reference / scope note	Measurement
P2	Deterministic close (double-run)	`claim.mol.deterministic_close`	Same tasks yield the same commit/refuse + limit id.	-	Unmetered
P3	Formula/lookup close without model	`claim.mol.formula_lookup_no_model`	Lookup/Formula unit-convert closes COMMIT at Lookup or Formula; model never answered.	-	Unmetered / Estimated (Landauer floor on receipt)
P4	VoI refuse when `!allow_model`	`claim.mol.voi_refuse`	Free-form ask → REFUSE `voi`.	-	Unmetered
P5	Settle commit + settle refuse	`claim.mol.settle_ternary`	Ternary settle → COMMIT; `will not settle` → REFUSE `settle_refuse`.	Software-ref settle stub; no klere-vm / FPGA	Unmetered
P6	Certificate refuse on diverge	`claim.mol.efa_certificate_refuse`	Formula + diverge → REFUSE `efa_certificate`.	In-tree EFA-style cert; Ferric / live BMI loop software reference	Unmetered
P7	Capability default-deny mutate	`claim.mol.capability_default_deny`	`AdversarialGate::default().gate(Mutate)` → Refuse.	-	Unmetered
P8	Receipt labels	`claim.mol.receipt_honesty`	Software-ref: `measured_j=None`, no FPGA board result claimed, estimate labeled (`EstimateKind`).	Live RAPL/NVML default close OUT OF SCOPE	Unmetered / Estimated
P9	`ModelGenerated ↛ Deterministic`	`claim.mol.replay_no_synthesis`	`TypedAnswer::weaken_to` returns `ReplayCoercion`.	-	-
P10	Periodic Stack live catalog navigation	`claim.mol.stack_live_catalog`	Family + present + scale → COMMIT at Lookup; 258 live Lookup/Formula/Solver/Navigate gears; note cites 258/33.	μ calib + silicon HW OUT OF SCOPE; software reference (Navigate in proof)	Unmetered
P11	`primitive_gap` via registry probe	`claim.mol.primitive_gap`	Gap marker `physical_settle` + absent name → REFUSE `primitive_gap` (not string-only).	-	Unmetered
P12	μ / impedance catalog	`claim.mol.mu_catalog`	Receipts stamp `mu_source=catalog`, `mu`, `landauer_floor_ratio`; `E≈θ · μ` (catalog estimate, not RAPL/`measured_j`).	μ calib corpus OUT OF SCOPE	Estimated
P13	Receipt transcript replay	`claim.mol.receipt_replay`	JSONL/in-memory replay reproduces commit/refuse + limit id; model never answered.	-	Unmetered

Prove #	Criterion (PLAN)	Paper claim id	Claim (one sentence)	Software reference / scope note	Measurement
P14	Z2 retrieve+cite	`claim.mol.z2_retrieve_cite`	Seeded factual hit → COMMIT `RetrievedCited` + citation ids; unknown → REFUSE `claim_unknown` (no invent).	Seed corpus in-tree only	Unmetered
P15	Z1 compose/synthesis	`claim.mol.z1_compose`	≥2 cited claims → COMMIT `Composed` + `synthesis.composed_from`; missing → REFUSE `compose_missing`; never laundered as Deterministic/RetrievedCited alone.	-	Unmetered
P16	Agent mailbox loop	`claim.mol.agent_mailbox`	Goal/Message/Act → close → commit|refuse + receipt in transcript; demo hits formula/cite/compose COMMIT and voi/settle_refuse REFUSE; model cold; measurement flags hold.	-	Unmetered
P17	Bitemporal state + memory	`claim.mol.bitemporal_memory`	Writes only on Mixture of Limits close COMMIT; Mutate deny / free-form remember → REFUSE; recall → `RetrievedCited` + `memory:` cite; unknown → `memory_unknown`.	-	Unmetered
P18	Fabric routing + software reference inventory	`claim.mol.fabric_software`	Offline inventory valid (`source=software_ref`, Cpu always); Lookup/Formula→Cpu; Settle→ThermoSettle|Cpu; Model→Gpu* or REFUSE `fabric_unavailable`; detect ≠ measured joules.	Live wgpu presence optional / not required for prove	Unmetered
P19	Desktop shell headless	`claim.mol.desktop_headless`	Shell session ask/close → receipt view (zone/fabric/limit/estimated_j/`measured_j=None`); joule ledger; VoI refuse; GUI not required.	egui GUI optional	Unmetered / Estimated
P20	OS meter labels	`claim.mol.os_meter_honesty`	Feature off / VM / no permission → `measured_j=None`, empty components, `measure_source=unavailable`; fixtures stamp labeled sources; default close stays unmetered.	Live probe optional (`energy-meter`)	Unmetered (default) / Metered only when probe returns

Prove #	Criterion (PLAN)	Paper claim id	Claim (one sentence)	Software reference / scope note	Measurement
P21	WASM capsule certify	`claim.mol.wasm_capsule`	`add.wasm` under stub runtime; fuel → estimated_j only; FS/net grant / fuel exceed / host-share → REFUSE; close stamps capsule.	Optional `wasmtime` feature	Unmetered / Estimated (fuel)
P22	Agent Lane session path	`claim.mol.agent_lane`	Lane partitions; `host_invoke` without provenance refuses; keyword confirm insufficient; need `GrantReceipt`; allow stamps `AgentLaneReceipt`.	-	Unmetered
P23	Multi-fabric compute receipt	`claim.mol.fabric_compute_receipt`	Software reference inventory; `ComputeFabric` / `ScheduleDecision` / `ComputeStepReceipt` with `fabric_id`; cascade stamps `fabric:route`; CPU Formula COMMIT; Model residual may `fabric_unavailable`; `measured_j=None` on software reference path.	Ferric not path-dep'd	Unmetered
P23b	Live fabric soft	`claim.mol.fabric_live_soft`	Feature off stays software_ref; mock/live Metal can stamp `gpu_metal`; Formula stays Cpu; missing Gpu* fail-closed; prove does not require a GPU; `measured_j=None` unless Metered.	Soft / optional detect	Unmetered
P23c	wgpu / Metal tiny kernel	`claim.mol.kernel_vector_add`	One random WGSL vector-add; soft stub offline (same checksum); Gpu* stamps `kernel:vector_add` + `execution_proof`; optional overlapping meter may stamp package `measured_j` with `energy_honesty=measured` (field name); no rail-sum package joules.	Live Metal optional; fixture OK for prove	Unmetered (default) / Metered only if meter returns

Prove #	Criterion (PLAN)	Paper claim id	Claim (one sentence)	Software reference / scope note	Measurement
P24	Ecosystem e2e certify (one receipt)	`claim.mol.ecosystem_e2e`	Lane → fabric (Cpu software reference) → WASM → energy labels (estimated fuel; optional meter_sample) → host invoke only with `GrantReceipt` → commit|refuse on one receipt; refuse-without-grant → `grant_receipt_required`.	-	Unmetered / Estimated

II.6.3 Software reference only

These are PLAN §6 residuals. Citing them is allowed as roadmap / reference semantics. Treating them as measured results is not.

Software reference item	Why software reference	Related prove row (if any)
Live silicon RAPL / NVML as default close	Optional `energy-meter`; software reference prove stays `measured_j=None`	P8, P20
Live wgpu adapter presence	Feature `fabric-detect`; inventory software reference remains prove default	P18, P23b, P23c
Ferric / on-device EFA (BMI hardware loop)	Reference semantics only; not path-dep'd	P6, P18, P23*
klere-vm WASM / FPGA meter (real pJ)	Software-ref `StubKlereSettle`	P5
Live `openie-path` / leapfrog ask bridge	Adapter port	-
Live WCA MCP / `wca-lut-edge` in-proc certify	Adapter port	-
μ calib corpus + silicon HW (physical_settle / reversible / ising / adiabatic / ferric / quantum / analog / photonic Gap cells)	Live catalog (258 Present / 258 live gears) + Gap + tier μ catalog + Stage C/Ferric software reference inventories + HW Gaps software reference sims ×8 (`stage_c_measured=false`; Gap cells retained) are in proof; silicon meters OUT	P10, P12
Trained weights / candle / tract Model leaf	Model stays demoted stub	P3, P4, P16

II.6.4 Seeded knowledge claims (Z2 corpus; not the prove map)

In-tree `ClaimStore` seeds used by P14/P15 (retrieve/compose), distinct from the paper claim ids above:

- `claim:landauer.principle`
- `claim:mol.law`
- `claim:mol.proof_law`
- `claim:mol.cascade`
- `claim:stack.scale`
- `claim:honesty.no_fake_rapl`
- `claim:replay.retrieved_cited`
- `claim:openie.z2`

II.6.5 Measurement scope of the verified map

- Software reference prove path: `measured_j=None` (Unmetered); Metered only when a live probe returns.
- no FPGA board result claimed on the verified path.
- Software reference v0.1 prove is software constructive existence, not board / FPGA watt leadership.
- Software reference roadmap items (§6.3) stay roadmap; they are not escalated to verified claims.

II.7. Math sketches: VoI stop, grammar coverage, settle-refuse

II.7.1 VoI stop

Let B be a benefit functional for a decision, x the current information state, and c the cost (bits, latency, or estimated joules) of acquiring observation y. A simple stop rule:

$$\Delta(x, y) = \mathbb{E}[B \mid x, y] - \mathbb{E}[B \mid x] - \lambda\, c(y)$$

Refuse escalation when $\Delta(x, y) \leq 0$ (or $\leq \tau$ for a configured threshold). Software reference Mixture of Limits encodes this as floor `voi` with `allow_model=false` by default: free-form asks that would only open the model leaf refuse rather than spend. This is the Shannon/decision-theoretic cousin of Kepler stopping new naked-eye points once the law predicts within tolerance. Domain-calibrated Bayesian VoI tables remain a deployment parameter, not a software reference prove deliverable. Classical cousins: anytime algorithms allocate deliberation under a utility-of-computation schedule (Zilberstein, 1996); the information bottleneck prices compressed representations that keep task-relevant bits (Tishby, Pereira, and Bialek, 1999; Tishby and Zaslavsky, 2015, arXiv:1503.02406). Software reference Mixture of Limits encodes the stop as named floors rather than importing those libraries as prove deliverables.

II.7.2 Grammar coverage

Let G be the covered grammar (Lookup registry ∪ Formula identities ∪ Solver settle programs). A query q is covered if a deterministic derivation $q \vdash_G a$ exists with replay class not `ModelGenerated`. Cascade order tries Lookup, then Formula, then Solver. If covered, do not open the model. If uncovered and policy forbids model escalation, refuse (`grammar` / `voi` / `primitive_gap` as applicable). Historical analog: once Newton's grammar covers orbital mechanics for the force law at hand, one does not re-enumerate Brahe's table to answer a new initial-condition query.

II.7.3 Settle-refuse

Under Solver, a ternary / energy-landscape settle either reaches a certified fixed point (commit) or signals will-not-settle (refuse `settle_refuse`). Software reference implements this as real in-tree settle logic plus certificate diverge tags (`efa_certificate`). Thermodynamic-settle inspiration is conceptual: software reference v0.1 has no annealer drivers and no adiabatic wall joules. Landauer appears as a labeled estimate on receipts.

II.7.4 Bound sketch tying Shannon and Landauer

For n irreversible erasures on a path that closes a decision,

$$E_{\text{path}} \geq E_{\text{Landauer}}(n, T) = n k_B T \ln 2$$

and the Mixture of Limits catalog estimate further requires $E_{\text{est}}(x) \geq \theta(D) \cdot \mu(S, V)$. `measured_j` requires a Metered probe. Excess tokens that do not change B fail the VoI test even when joule budgets remain; the information floor binds first.

II.8. Related work: proof points, lineage, and Tier A

II.8.0 Academic proof points: top minds already named the floors

Mixture of Limits is an executable navigation rule over floors that information theorists, physicists, and decision theorists already stated as settled theory, and that formula-first science AI keeps rediscovering in modern form. Below is a historical → recent citation chain with DOIs verified for this draft (or marked TBD). These are global academic proof points that compression, floors, and formulas beat excess enumeration.

Information, complexity, and physical cost

Proof point	Who / when	What they already said	Cite (verified)
Bits under uncertainty	Shannon (1948)	Quantitative communication limits; entropy as missing information	10.1002/j.1538-7305.1948.tb01338.x (Part I); Part II 10.1002/j.1538-7305.1948.tb00917.x
Irreversible erasure costs heat	Landauer (1961)	Logical irreversibility ⇒ minimal heat ~kT per irreversible function	10.1147/rd.53.0183
Reversible computing	Bennett (1973)	Computation can be logically reversible; Landauer cost is about erasure, not "computing" per se	10.1147/rd.176.0525
Algorithmic complexity	Kolmogorov (1965/1968)	Quantity of information as shortest program length; compression as definition	Russian original *Probl. Peredachi Inf.* 1(1):3-11 (1965), no DOI; English transl. 10.1080/00207166808803030; IEEE note 10.1109/TIT.1968.1054210
Algorithmic probability / induction	Solomonoff (1964)	Prefer short programs; universal prior over computable regularities	Part I 10.1016/S0019-9958(64)90223-2
Algorithmic incompleteness	Chaitin (1977)	Algorithmic information bounds what finitely axiomatized theories can prove	10.1147/rd.214.0350
Probability as extended logic	Jaynes (2003 book; earlier papers)	Maximum-entropy / logic-of-science discipline against ad-hoc excess modeling	10.1017/CBO9780511790423
Textbook IT + decision links	Cover & Thomas	Canonical Elements of Information Theory (2nd ed.)	Wiley book DOI 10.1002/047174882X
Value of Information	Howard (1966)	Shannon bits ≠ decision value; VoI joins probability with economic consequence; stop when information is worthless for the decision	10.1109/TSSC.1966.300074
Physics of computation lectures	Feynman (pub. Hey/Allen eds.)	Physical limits of computing, reversible/thermo themes in lecture form	Anniversary ed. 10.1201/9781003358817; 1996 Addison-Wesley ISBN 0-201-48991-0

Historical mathematical physics (compression beats enumeration). See §8.1: Brahe→Kepler→Newton is the pre-IT proof that tables yield to laws. Imprint DOIs for critical editions of *Principia* remain TBD if a journal version requires them.

Recent formula / mechanism / certify systems (Tier A inventory), from `docs/adjacent-field-hunt.md` and `docs/appendix-mwm-ai-newton.md` (2026-09-30):

Proof point	Who	Mixture of Limits reading	Cite (verified)
AI Feynman	Udrescu & Tegmark	NN decomposes; closed form is the commit	10.1126/sciadv.aay2631
SINDy	Brunton / Proctor / Kutz	Sparse grammar; reject dense residual fits	10.1073/pnas.1517384113
PySR	Cranmer	Production symbolic regression	arXiv:2305.01582 (journal DOI TBD if distinct)
AI-Newton	Fang et al.	Concept library + general laws across experiments	arXiv:2504.01538
AlphaGeometry / AlphaProof	DeepMind	Propose → symbolic/Lean certify (hard floor)	Nature 10.1038/s41586-025-09833-y
LeanDojo / ReProver	Yang et al.	Retrieval-augmented Lean proving; tool interaction with proof state	arXiv: 2306.15626
Mechanistic World Models	Posner / Lei / Schölkopf	Mechanisms > predictive MoE modules	arXiv:2607.12474
AutoSINDy hybrid	(hunt 2026 note)	PySR → library → SINDy	arXiv:2605.09696

Raiffa-style decision analysis texts are the pedagogical cousins of Howard's VoI; a specific Raiffa imprint DOI is TBD.

II.8.0.1 The gap is embodiment: not awareness

Claim (addendum). Applied mathematics × materials science (physical hardware) is the bottleneck, not awareness of what should be done.

Evidence for the awareness side is the table above: Shannon priced bits; Howard priced VoI for decisions; Landauer/Bennett priced irreversible erasure; Kolmogorov/Solomonoff/Chaitin priced shortest programs and incompleteness; Feynman taught physical limits of computation; SINDy/PySR/AI Feynman/AI-Newton/AlphaGeometry/MWMs keep showing that formulas, sparsity, verification, and mechanisms beat unbounded enumeration and unguided MoE-style prediction.

What remains hard, and what Mixture of Limits companions (NI commit gate; coin-cell Formula+LUT; multi-fabric routing; Metered vs Estimated labels) point at, is embodying those floors in real stacks: materials and devices that make Lookup/Formula/Solver cheap, certificates enforceable before irreversible acts, and joule receipts that keep estimates separate from `measured_j`. Software reference `mol prove` shows the *law+runtime* exists in software. Materials and device embodiment remain open. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed; package energy only when Metered.

II.8.1 Historical lineage: compression beats enumeration

Tycho Brahe → Kepler. Brahe's program was high-fidelity enumeration. Kepler's three laws compressed those tables into predictive relations. Enumeration was necessary input; the law was the compressible object that stopped needing every future observation.

Kepler → Newton. Newton folded planetary regularities into invariants and closed forms (F=ma; universal gravitation). Predictive power migrated from case tables to formulas that travel. AI-Newton (Fang et al., arXiv:2504.01538) is a contemporary soft echo: concept libraries and general laws across many noisy mechanics experiments. NN as recommender residual, not substrate.

Invariants and closed forms. Symmetry → conservation (Noether tradition), Hamiltonian/Lagrangian reduction, and integrals of motion are the mathematical-physics statement of "formula wins when grammar is covered." The Mixture of Limits Formula gear is that tradition's CI leaf.

Information theory and physical cost. Shannon, Howard (VoI), Landauer, Bennett, Kolmogorov/Solomonoff/Chaitin, and Cover & Thomas form the IT/decision/thermodynamic chain in §8.0. Mixture of Limits binds them as named floors and labeled estimates. Software reference Landauer stamps are lower-bound estimates, not claims of near-bound silicon operation.

Notational intelligence. Lee's notational-intelligence claim is the companion frame for executable predicates; see Metered Commit Gates, Part I (Notational Intelligence).

II.8.2 Tier A detail: formula / mechanism / executable physics

Inventory dated 2026-09-30 in the Mixture of Limits workspace hunt docs. Capsule readings:

1. AI Feynman (+ 2.0): Physics-inspired symbolic regression; NN for symmetries/separability, then recursive formula recovery. Canonical *Formula* gear.
2. SINDy: Sparse identification of nonlinear dynamics; explicit grammar + sparsity floor.
3. PySR: Evolutionary symbolic regression; distill NNs → closed forms.
4. AI-Newton: Concept-driven law discovery across noisy mechanics experiments.
5. AlphaGeometry / AlphaProof: LM proposes; verifier is the hard floor (propose → certify → commit|refuse template).
6. Mechanistic World Models: Sister philosophy: reusable mechanisms; MoE as wrong module semantics for explanation.

Additional hunt rows (AtomAgents/SciAgents, KeplerAgent/NewtonBench, AI-Descartes, DreamCoder/COMET/NEO, Robot Scientist) sit as hybrid or mechanism-library cousins. Where a DOI was not verified beyond arXiv IDs, cite arXiv and mark journal DOI TBD.

Mixture of Limits reading of Tier A. Formula/mechanism discovery (A) plus physics-executable leaves (B in the hunt) beat token-escalation workflows (C). MoE-style mixtures are the wrong "Mixture of."

II.8.3 What Mixture of Limits adds

Tier A systems recover or verify formulas. Classical IT already priced bits, VoI, and erasure. Mixture of Limits names the navigation rule that decides *when* Lookup/Formula/Solver suffice, *when* to refuse, and *how* receipts label estimated vs measured joules, then implements a clean-room software reference close loop. Software reference constructive existence is software constructive existence under those floors, not a materials breakthrough or a new physics corpus. The proposed Universal Law of Agency research track places Mixture of Limits as the optimum operator: the cheapest sufficient gear is the argmin over joules.

II.8.4 Latent space: depth buys compression, not freedom from floors

A latent space is a compressed coordinate system for states that matter to a task: continuous vectors (dense embeddings), discrete codes (VQ / codebook indices), or hybrids. Depth in a latent buys what Shannon and Kolmogorov already price: a shorter description of structure that would otherwise be enumerated as raw observations, pixels, tokens, or traces. Autoencoders, VAEs, diffusion latents, and continuous reasoning traces are modern instances of that move. The representation can make Lookup hits cheaper, Formula edits local, and Solver landscapes smoother.

Representation is not law. A deeper latent does not erase the floors Mixture of Limits names:

1. Value of Information (VoI). Extra latent dimensions, longer continuous traces, or denser codebooks are more bits under a budget. When marginal latent bits do not change the decision benefit B, VoI says stop. Excess latent enumeration is the same failure mode as excess token enumeration, only in a different alphabet.
2. Grammar coverage. If Lookup, Formula, or Solver already covers the coordinate, opening a latent generator is waste. Covered grammar closes before Model. A latent that rediscovers a closed form is still Model residual when a Formula leaf was available.
3. Energy / Landauer. Encoding, decoding, denoising, and gradient edits on latents erase and rewrite information. Landauer prices irreversible erasure as a thermodynamic lower bound and appears on receipts as a labeled estimate. Catalog or OpCounter estimates for latent paths remain Estimated / Unmetered on the software reference path (`measured_j=None`; no FPGA board result claimed).
4. Certify-before-commit. A low-energy latent state is a proposal until a certificate, settle, or typed refuse closes the act. Software reference close still binds propose → certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Latent score ≠ irreversible commit.

Teach-first takeaway. Latent depth is a compression technology and a plateau option when Model is open. Mixture of Limits navigates whether that compression is cheapest-sufficient for the task, or whether refuse is the lawful success. See §8.7 (SOTA at the plateau) and §9: the question is whether a generator should run at all, then how little energy to spend on the plateau.

II.8.5 Logical Intelligence: energy-based reasoning with LLMs and latents

Logical Intelligence (logicalintelligence.com) is a company building energy-based reasoning systems for constraint-heavy and mission-critical settings. Public materials (company blog and product pages, January 2026) teach a hybrid stack rather than a single chatbot:

- Kona is their core energy-based model (EBM) for reasoning (sometimes called an energy-based reasoning model, EBRM). An EBM assigns a scalar energy to a candidate state: low energy means more consistent with constraints and objectives; high energy means something is broken. Per their technical blog (Bodnia and Hanin, 21 Jan 2026), Kona is non-autoregressive at the *trace* level, globally scored over partial and complete traces, and reasons in a continuous latent space with dense vector tokens so local gradient-style edits can reduce constraint violations without regenerating an entire discrete prefix.
- Aleph is their orchestration / agentic layer that coordinates Kona, LLMs, and other tools. Public positioning: LLMs handle natural-language interface and candidate generation; the EBM layer evaluates and repairs under constraints. Aleph is also described as delivering verified / formal-reasoning workflows today (benchmark claims such as PutnamBench appear on their site; treat score numbers as author-reported unless independently reproduced here).
- Product framing on the Kona page: Kona is not marketed as a chatbot. Language models express and explore; Kona is positioned to evaluate what is valid or permissible before irreversible action in high-stakes domains

(company examples include energy, manufacturing, semiconductor verification, robotics). Kona 1.0 was announced for partner pilots (company and press materials, Jan 2026). Leadership publicly listed includes founder and CEO Eve Bodnia and Yann LeCun as founding chair of a technical research board (company site / press).

Classical EBM backdrop (established ML architecture). Energy-based models treat inference as finding low-energy configurations under a learned energy function. That framing is older than any one product; LeCun and others have long argued that reasoning can be cast as optimization over an energy landscape. Logical Intelligence's public thesis is that discrete, locally scored, autoregressive LLM traces scale poorly for long-horizon constraint satisfaction, and that continuous, globally scored EBM traces address that gap when paired with LLMs for interface.

Mixture of Limits reading (cascade map, not a product endorsement).

Logical Intelligence public piece	Cascade rhyme	Floor that still binds
Continuous latent trace + energy score	Soft rhyme with Solver / settle: optimize / repair under constraints	`settle_refuse`, VoI, energy estimate; low energy $\neq$ board joules
LLM for language / candidates	Model residual for expression and proposal	The last cascade stage; `ModelGenerated` $\nrightarrow$ `Deterministic`
Aleph orchestration among tools	Cheapest-sufficient routing among gears	Grammar coverage first; refuse when escalation is VoI-negative or unsafe
Constraint / proof-oriented close	Certify-before-commit spirit	Certificate / typed refuse before irreversible act

Verified here: the public architecture story and the cascade map: energy-based settle can rhyme with Solver; LLM residual stays the last cascade stage; latents do not erase VoI or Landauer floors. Author-reported latency and Sudoku figures stay field results (not software reference `measured_j`). Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed. Unverified internal training details, unpublished energy-function forms, and AGI-completion claims remain TBD / out of scope.

II.8.5.1 Embodiment classes: the convergence is hybrid interplay

§8.5 already separates the objects inside one public stack. The energy-based settle returns a low-energy configuration. The scalar over a trace, as §8.5 cites, is constraint energy. It is not a measured joule. The language model beside it returns candidates. Neither object is the commit. Close remains propose, then certify, then commit or refuse, then a receipt (§4). The same separation is the limit of each embodiment class. It is not a feature of one name.

A decision model stops at a typed probability. The return is a yes or no, a choice, or a score, each with a probability. Whatever route, escalation, or deferral follows is outside that return. The model does not commit. A probability is not an act.

A bounded ask stops at a typed value, or at not-sure. The ask writes no text and takes no action. Not-sure is a refuse object, not a generated answer.

A statechart stops at a legal transition. An event changes state only when that state allows it. An illegal event does not transition. The object returned is the next legal state, or no transition. A library transition is not an external commit.

A visual statechart editor stops at the chart a person can audit. The editor's object is the chart. The chart is the door: what the chart does not allow does not pass. The editor does not commit the act behind the door.

An energy-based settle, already placed in §8.5, stops at a low-energy configuration. Constraint energy is not `measured_j`. A low-energy configuration is not an irreversible act.

None of these classes is the whole intelligence. The convergence is hybrid interplay. The chart is the door. The decision model may fill a proposal. The bounded ask may return a typed value or not-sure. The energy settle may score a configuration. Something outside the model still commits or refuses. Mixture of Limits is the navigation rule of that interplay: Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model last. Refuse is success. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. Correctness is the gate, and among systems that pass it, joules alone order them. Constraint energy remains a score on a configuration. It is not that metric.

A shared request shape is not shared authority. Two typed answers still do not commit. These stops are not plateau knobs inside one generator (§8.7). Stacking classes does not produce a commit. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed. Nothing in the class map is a measurement of this study.

II. Class map

The class map places each public instance under the object that instance returns. Rows are ordered by class. A project that returns two objects appears twice, once for each object. The map is not a ranking.

Class	Object returned	Instance
Decision model	Typed probability	Jev
Decision model	Typed probability	Clef
Decision model	Typed probability	d1
Decision model	Typed probability	Solar Decide
Decision model	Typed probability	pplx-decider
Decision model	Typed probability	Kev
Decision model	Typed probability	Laya
Decision model	Typed probability	Bespoke Nimble
Decision model	Typed probability	OpenThai-SystemOne
Decision model	Typed probability	Decider
Decision model	Typed probability	OpenJev
Decision model	Typed probability	Mica
Decision model	Typed probability	Winnow
Decision model	Typed probability	CLM
Decision model	Typed probability	Julia
Decision model	Typed probability	NanoJev
Decision model	Typed probability	open-jev DeBERTa
Decision model	Typed probability	fastText
Decision model	Typed probability	Cloud Natural Language
Bounded ask	Typed value, or not-sure	ThinkThen
Bounded ask	Typed value, or not-sure	GLiNER2.5-Decide
Statechart	Legal transition	XState
Statechart	Legal transition	Qt State Machine
Statechart	Legal transition	Qt SCXML
Statechart	Legal transition	Boost.Statechart
Statechart	Legal transition	Boost.MSM
Statechart	Legal transition	Boost.SML
Statechart	Legal transition	Akka FSM
Statechart	Legal transition	Spring Statemachine
Statechart	Legal transition	Apache Commons SCXML
Statechart	Legal transition	transitions
Statechart	Legal transition	Sismic
Statechart	Legal transition	Stateless
Statechart	Legal transition	QP/C
Statechart	Legal transition	AASM
Statechart	Legal transition	SCION
Statechart	Legal transition	javascript-state-machine
Statechart	Legal transition	state_machines
Statechart	Legal transition	HFSM2
Statechart	Legal transition	uSCXML
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	Stately
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	itemis CREATE
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	QM
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	Engineering Rhapsody
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	Enterprise Architect
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	Papyrus
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	StarUML
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	Visual Paradigm
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	IAR Visual State
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	sketch.systems
Visual statechart editor	Auditable chart	Qt Creator
Energy-based settle	Low-energy configuration	Kona
Energy-based settle	Low-energy configuration	Simulated Bifurcation Machine
Energy-based settle	Low-energy configuration	Fixstars Amplify AE
Energy-based settle	Low-energy configuration	CMOS annealing

II.8.6 World Labs: spatial intelligence and world models

World Labs (worldlabs.ai) is a frontier research and product company focused on spatial intelligence: models that perceive, generate, reason about, and interact with virtual and physical worlds across space and time. Co-founders publicly include Fei-Fei Li, Justin Johnson, Ben Mildenhall, and Christoph Lassner (company About page).

Teach the products and architecture first (public sources).

- Marble is their first product: generative 3D world models that create spatially coherent, persistent 3D worlds from images, video, text, and 3D layouts (company About).
- Atlas (company blog, 1 Sep 2026) is described as an omni world model pretrained to operate on text, images, video, and 3D. Architecture: a multimodal autoregressive diffusion transformer. Inputs are grounded in 3D to form a shared spatial context; the model generates what comes next while aiming for 3D consistency with what it has seen, and imagining what lies beyond. Public capability claims include camera-controlled video generation, sparse-view spatial reconstruction (including explicit 3D such as point clouds / Gaussian splats), space-time simulation for Real-to-Sim robotics workflows, and image / 360 generation. Atlas is positioned to power future Marble versions and is in early access with select partners. Author-reported benchmarks on camera-conditioned generation and 3D reconstruction appear on the Atlas post; cite the architecture and task list here, not those numbers as OpenIE measurements.

Fei-Fei's public spatial-intelligence framing (including the "from words to worlds" thesis) states that world models must handle semantic, physical, geometric, and dynamic complexity beyond today's LLM text corridor. That is a generator-class ambition: better world generators and simulators.

Mixture of Limits reading: even projected-superior world models hit floors.

1. Grammar coverage. Faithful reconstruction from enough views is not the same as a closed predictive law for a task. When a Formula or Lookup already answers the coordinate, generating a world is excess. Imagination that fills unseen regions is generative residual, not Deterministic commit.
2. Certify-before-commit. A spatially consistent video or splat is a proposal about geometry and appearance. Irreversible acts (robot motion, financial or safety-critical side effects) still require certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Software reference ReplayClass typing still applies: generative world output does not launder into Deterministic without a certificate path.
3. VoI and energy. Longer videos, denser 3D contexts, more denoising steps, and Real-to-Sim rollouts spend bits and joules. VoI stops when extra world detail does not change the decision benefit. Landauer bounds irreversible erasure as a labeled estimate; Atlas / Marble training or inference joules are field / author-reported, not software reference `measured_j`. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed.
4. Materials embodiment. High-fidelity world models intensify the applied-math × materials bottleneck: sensors, fabrics, and meters that make cheapest-sufficient close real at the edge, without laundering estimates as board watts.

World Labs systems optimize which world generator / simulator runs and how well it tracks space. Mixture of Limits asks whether that generator should run for the stated benefit, and which named floor closes first. Cross-link: §9 Mixture of Limits is not MoE table (outside-generation floors vs inside-generator capacity).

II.8.7 SOTA at the plateau: VoI zero past the floor

Plateau thesis. Once the floor is known and Value of Information is zero past it, additional tokens, parameters, latent depth, or thinking steps do not purchase verifiable progress on the task coordinate. The only remaining work is optimize energy and compute on that plateau: cheapest-sufficient Lookup → Formula → Solver/settle → Model, with refuse as lawful success when escalation is VoI-negative or unsafe.

Latent compression, EBM settle hybrids (Logical Intelligence), spatial world models (World Labs), test-time compute, super learning, SSM hybrids, mixture of experts, speculative decode, RAG, transmission / gearing / cascade / memory-context methods, and the cross-field plateau moves of §8.14 can each be projected as superior *inside* a generative or hybrid corridor for their stated jobs. Superiority on the plateau does not cancel Shannon pricing of bits, Howard pricing of VoI, Landauer pricing of irreversible erasure, or certify-before-commit. Those methods are implementation options for plateau spend: how to spend less energy or move fewer bits once Model is the residual leaf. They are not history lessons and not a narrative race among brands. The industry race is a race to the plateau floors.

Mixture of Limits is the navigation rule that names the floors, finds the plateau, and binds the cascade. Software reference `mol prove` remains constructive existence in software. Software reference paths for Logical Intelligence, World Labs, or OpenIE do not stamp board package `measured_j`.

§8.5.1 is not an entry in that plateau list. A typed probability, a typed value or not-sure, a legal transition, a low-energy configuration, and an auditable chart are different objects. Hybrid interplay is how Mixture of Limits navigates them.

It does not turn any of them into the commit, and it does not turn constraint energy into `measured_j`.

II.8.8 Test-time compute as plateau spend

Teach first. Test-time inference (also called test-time compute) means spending additional computation *after* training, when answering a query: longer chain-of-thought (CoT) traces, search over candidate solutions, majority vote across samples, verifier-guided selection, or process reward scoring of intermediate steps. OpenAI's o1 / o3-style systems popularized sequential scaling of reasoning traces at inference (OpenAI, "Learning to reason with LLMs," 2024). Related process supervision trains reward models on step-level labels rather than only final answers (Lightman et al., "Let's Verify Step by Step," arXiv:2305.20050; ICLR 2024). Parallel strategies sample many short traces and aggregate; sequential strategies extend one long trace. Surveys of inference-time scaling for complex tasks document both families and their dependence on verifier quality (e.g. arXiv:2504.00294).

Extra thinking tokens are treated as a new scaling axis parallel to training tokens and parameters. That axis is real as *engineering*: longer verified search can raise accuracy on hard problems when the verifier is good and the budget is spent on the right difficulty band. Empirical work on o1-like models also shows diminishing returns, overthinking, and cases where longer CoTs degrade accuracy or where parallel majority-style methods scale better than unbounded sequential length (e.g. ACL 2025 findings on o1-like test-time scaling; related overthinking analyses).

Mixture of Limits reading. Extra inference tokens are still bits under a budget.

1. Value of Information (VoI). Another thinking step is another observation about an internal search state. When the marginal step does not change the decision benefit B, VoI says stop. Majority vote that re-samples without changing B fails the same test.
2. Grammar coverage. If Lookup, Formula, or Solver already covers the coordinate, opening a long CoT generator is waste. Covered grammar closes before Model.
3. Energy / Landauer. Every additional sampled token and every verifier forward pass erases and rewrites information. Landauer prices irreversible erasure as a thermodynamic lower bound and appears on receipts as a labeled estimate. Catalog or OpCounter estimates for test-time paths remain Estimated / Unmetered on the software reference path (`measured_j=None`; no FPGA board result claimed).
4. Certify-before-commit. A process-reward score or majority winner is a proposal until certify → commit|refuse → receipt. Software reference ReplayClass typing still applies: a long reasoning trace does not launder into `Deterministic` without a certificate path.

Teach-first takeaway. Test-time compute is a plateau spend knob inside the generative corridor. Mixture of Limits navigates whether that budget should open at all, then how little thinking to spend once VoI is zero past the floor. More thinking steps are not free of VoI, grammar, energy, or certify floors.

II.8.9 Super learning as plateau ensemble spend

Teach first (academic term). Super learning (also called the super learner) is a cross-validated ensemble / stacking method from targeted learning: fit a library of candidate algorithms, collect out-of-fold predictions, then learn a meta-learner that combines them to minimize cross-validated risk (van der Laan, Polley, and Hubbard, 2007; Polley and van der Laan, "Super Learner In Prediction," U.C. Berkeley Biostatistics Working Paper 266). It is related to stacking as introduced by Wolpert (1992) and adapted by Breiman (1996). A discrete super learner selects the single best candidate by cross-validated risk; an ensemble super learner learns weights (often non-negative and summing to one) over candidates. The oracle results for cross-validation selectors underwrite asymptotic optimality *relative to the library*, not freedom from information or energy floors.

Label the industry narrative separately. Public "superintelligence" scaling talk (systems that broadly outperform humans across domains) is a *product and aspiration narrative*, not the van der Laan estimator. Academic super learning / super learner names the cross-validated stack; it is not a product brand and is not marketing AGI.

Mixture of Limits reading. Ensembles and stacks are still Model-class residual when they generate; when they combine deterministic candidates they still face VoI and certify limits.

1. VoI. Another base learner or another fold is another observation. When the meta-learner cannot change B, stop.
2. Grammar. If Formula or Lookup covers the coordinate, stacking neural candidates is excess enumeration under a different name.

3. Energy labels. Training and evaluating a library multiplies forward passes. Estimates remain estimates; software reference ensembles keep `measured_j=None`; no FPGA board result claimed.
4. Certify. A stacked prediction is still a proposal until a certificate or typed refuse closes the act. Oracle optimality inside a library does not coerce `ModelGenerated` to `Deterministic`.

Teach-first takeaway. Super learning is cross-validated ensemble selection, a plateau option for combining residual leaves. Mixture of Limits maps it onto floors: better combination on the plateau does not retire VoI, grammar, energy, or certify.

II.8.10 Live SOTA methods for plateau energy/compute (2025 to 2026)

Each row is a verified implementation option for plateau spend: teach the technique once with a cite, then one Mixture of Limits floor sentence. This is not an uncited acronym dump and not a race table. Author-reported speedups and benchmark scores are field results, distinct from OpenIE software reference measurements.

Approach	What it is (teach once)	Verified cite	Floor that still binds
Speculative decoding	A small drafter proposes several tokens; the large target model verifies them in parallel, preserving the target distribution while cutting serial decode steps	Leviathan, Kalman, and Matias, "Fast Inference from Transformers via Speculative Decoding," ICML 2023 (PMLR); Li et al., EAGLE, ICML 2024 (arXiv:2401.15077); see also §9 HCSpec / CAS-Spec	Speeds generation; does not refuse generation when VoI or grammar says stop
Mixture-of-Depths (MoD)	Per-layer top-k routing so only a budgeted subset of tokens enter attention/MLP at each depth; residual skip for the rest (static compute graph, dynamic token compute)	Raposo et al., "Mixture-of-Depths: Dynamically allocating compute in transformer-based language models," arXiv:2404.02258 (2024)	Adaptive depth *inside* the generator; not Lookup→Formula→Solver refuse outside generation
Weight / activation quantization	Post-training low-bit weights (and sometimes activations): GPTQ (second-order PTQ), AWQ (activation-aware weight scaling), FP8 / INT8 / INT4 serving formats	Frantar et al., GPTQ, arXiv:2210.17323; Lin et al., AWQ, MLSys 2024 (arXiv:2306.00978); Micikevicius et al., FP8 formats (NVIDIA, 2022)	Cheaper plateau bits per weight; does not invent VoI stop or certify-before-commit
Inference engines (KV systems)	Serving runtimes that page and reuse KV cache: vLLM / PagedAttention; SGLang / RadixAttention for structured LM programs and prefix reuse	Kwon et al., "Efficient Memory Management for Large Language Model Serving with PagedAttention," arXiv:2309.06180 (vLLM); Zheng et al., SGLang, arXiv:2312.07104	Systems efficiency on the plateau; still serves generators; floors decide whether to open decode
Mixture of experts (MoE)	Sparse gating routes each token to a few expert feed-forward modules so total parameters grow faster than active compute	Shazeer et al., "Outrageously Large Neural Networks," ICLR 2017 (arXiv:1701.06538); Lepikhin et al., GShard, 2020 (arXiv:2006.16668); Fedus et al., Switch Transformers, JMLR 2022	Capacity *inside* the generative corridor; Mixture of Limits floors live *outside* generation (§2, §9)
State-space models (SSMs)	Sequence models with a compact recurrent state and near-linear scaling in context (selective SSM / Mamba) as an alternative or complement to attention	Gu and Dao, "Mamba: Linear-Time Sequence Modeling with Selective State Spaces," arXiv:2312.00752 (2023); Gu, Goel, and Ré, S4, ICLR 2022	Efficient sequence leaf; still the last cascade stage when used as generator; VoI and certify unchanged
Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG)	Retrieve documents from an external index, then condition the generator on those passages so knowledge need not live only in weights	Lewis et al., "Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive NLP Tasks," NeurIPS 2020 (arXiv:2005.11401)	Retrieval can rhyme with Lookup when the hit is certified; uncertified retrieved text remains proposal, not Deterministic commit
Reasoning models / CoT scaling	Models trained or prompted to emit long intermediate reasoning (o1/o3-style, DeepSeek-R1, QwQ, and cousins)	OpenAI o1 public writeup (2024); DeepSeek-AI et al., DeepSeek-R1 technical report (2025); §8.8	Extra reasoning tokens still hit VoI and energy floors; longer is not always better

Approach	What it is (teach once)	Verified cite	Floor that still binds
Diffusion language models	Discrete or continuous diffusion denoising over tokens or latents rather than purely left-to-right next-token prediction (e.g. score-entropy discrete diffusion)	Lou, Meng, and Ermon, "Discrete Diffusion Modeling by Estimating the Ratios of the Data Distribution" (SEDD), ICML 2024 (PMLR v235)	Denoising steps spend bits and joules; Landauer remains a labeled estimate only; certify before commit
Linear attention / retention variants	Attention alternatives with linear or chunkwise cost for long context (e.g. Retentive Network / RetNet multi-scale retention)	Sun et al., "Retentive Network: A Successor to Transformer for Large Language Models," arXiv:2307.08621 (2023)	Cheaper long context is algorithmic efficiency; floors still stop when VoI or grammar is covered

Teach-first takeaway. Every live SOTA method above optimizes *how* a generator runs or *which* parameters activate on the plateau. Mixture of Limits asks whether the generator should run for the stated benefit, which named floor closes first, and, once VoI is zero past that floor, how to spend least energy/compute on the plateau (Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model).

II.8.10.1 Adaptive depth, precision, and serving as plateau levers

Three complementary plateau levers sit beside MoE and speculative decode:

1. Mixture-of-Depths (Raposo et al., arXiv:2404.02258) learns which tokens need full block compute and which may residual-skip under a fixed FLOP budget. That is generator-internal cheapest-sufficient *depth*, a rhyme with Mixture of Limits cascade, not a substitute for floors outside generation.
2. Quantization (GPTQ, AWQ, FP8/INT families) moves fewer bits per weight and raises arithmetic intensity on memory-bound decode. Author-reported speedups and perplexity deltas are field results; software reference receipts keep Landauer as a labeled estimate and `measured_j=None` unless Metered.
3. Inference engines (vLLM PagedAttention; SGLang RadixAttention) refuse waste of fragmented KV and repeated prefix compute. That is transmission / memory economics at the serving layer (§8.13), still under the last cascade stage when the cascade opens the generator.

Floor bind. Adaptive depth, lower precision, and better KV paging optimize plateau spend. They do not retire VoI, grammar coverage, certificate, or settle-refuse. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed.

II.8.11 SSM hybrids, MoE, and implementation efficiency on the plateau

Plateau options (verified methods, not a brand race). Once Model is the residual leaf and VoI is zero past the floor, SOTA at the plateau means spend less energy and move fewer bits for the same certified benefit. The following are implementation options:

- State-space models (SSMs) / Mamba. Selective state-space sequence models with linear-time scaling in context (Gu and Dao, 2023; Gu, Goel, and Ré, S4, ICLR 2022). Plateau use: cheaper long-context sequence leaf under the last cascade stage.
- SSM + attention + MoE hybrids (Jamba-class). Interleaved Transformer attention and Mamba layers, plus mixture-of-experts on some MLPs, aimed at high throughput and a smaller key-value cache on long contexts (Lieber et al., "Jamba: A Hybrid Transformer-Mamba Language Model," arXiv:2403.19887; Jamba-1.5, arXiv:2408.12570). Plateau use: cut memory and raise throughput for long generative contexts. Author-reported benchmark and throughput numbers are field results, not software reference `measured_j`.
- Fine-grained MoE + systems co-design (DeepSeek-class). DeepSeekMoE (Dai et al., ACL 2024) and DeepSeek-V3 (DeepSeek-AI, arXiv:2412.19437) combine fine-grained MoE, multi-head latent attention, and systems co-design (including reported FP8 mixed-precision training and pipeline overlap). DeepSeek-R1 applies large-scale reinforcement learning for reasoning traces on that efficient base. Plateau use: lower active compute and training/inference cost per benefit. Treat GPU-hour and benchmark figures as author-reported, not software reference meters.
- MoE reasoning / agentic releases (GLM-class). GLM-4.5 and related Zhipu / Z.ai releases (arXiv:2508.06471) use large total parameter counts with smaller active counts per token, plus agentic / reasoning post-training. Plateau use: active-parameter efficiency on available silicon. Scores and active-parameter claims are field/author-reported.

Related plateau levers (quantization, speculative decoding, training-systems overlap) appear again in §8.10 and §8.13. Vendor ranking is out of scope.

Mixture of Limits reading.

1. SSM hybrids and MoE routing are legitimate plateau efficiency leaves. They remain generators. Floors still bind.
2. Implementation efficiency (algorithms, precision, routing, RL post-training) lowers device-dollar and joule cost on the plateau. That is applied engineering, not a repeal of Shannon, Howard, or Landauer.
3. No architecture announcement retires VoI, grammar coverage, labeled energy estimates, or certify-before-commit. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed; Jamba / DeepSeek / GLM joules remain field / author-reported.

Teach-first takeaway. SOTA at the plateau is optimize energy/compute with cheapest-sufficient cascade. SSM hybrids, MoE, and systems co-design are how field stacks spend less once the floor is known, not a narrative about which brand won.

II.8.12 Hardware: plateau spend on real devices

State as the study's claim (David Charlot / OpenIE framing), grounded in the sections above.

1. Computers are hardware. Every program runs on materials and devices: gates, memory, interconnects, power delivery, cooling. There is no software that escapes physics.
2. Software is written for hardware. Instruction sets, memory hierarchies, batch sizes, and quantization schemes exist because of devices. Software is human applied engineering under constraints. It is not a separate realm detached from devices, yield, and joules.
3. Plateau efficiency margins remain. Inefficient deployment on the newest hardware leaves room. Optimized algorithms, MoE routing, training-systems co-design, and inference tricks on older or cheaper accelerators extract more work per device on the plateau. DeepSeek / GLM-class implementation efficiency (§8.11) and speculative decoding / quantization stacks (§8.10) are instances. Treat vendor scoreboards as field reports, not OpenIE meters.
4. Mixture of Limits reading. Plateau options (SSM hybrids, mixture of experts, test-time compute, diffusion language models, linear attention, retrieval-augmented generation, world models, energy-based hybrids) do not retire floors. The bottleneck remains applied mathematics embodied in materials and devices, plus labeled joule accounting. Algorithmic efficiency is real and is exactly why floors matter: once VoI is zero past the floor, cheaper implementations are the remaining work, and they still stop when VoI, grammar, or energy says stop. Estimates (`estimated_j`, Landauer as labeled estimate) are not board package energy. Software reference path: `measured_j=None`; no FPGA board result claimed.

Edge / TinyML floors (verified cites). Coin-cell and MCU closes are not tiny transformers by default. MCUNet co-designs TinyNAS + TinyEngine for ImageNet-class inference on microcontrollers (Lin et al., NeurIPS 2020, arXiv:2007.10319). T-MAC accelerates low-bit LLM matmul on edge CPUs via table lookup without dequantization (Wei et al., arXiv:2407.00088). Mixture of Limits reading: Formula+LUT refuse under device SRAM/Flash is the lawful edge close; a quantized residual Model leaf is still the last cascade stage.

Neuromorphic / thermodynamic materials options (field / software reference). Loihi-2 neuromorphic mapping of a MatMul-free LLM reports author-estimated throughput and mJ/token vs edge-GPU transformers (Abreu et al., arXiv:2503.18002). These are field silicon results, not software reference `measured_j`. Digital thermodynamic-computer proposals for generative sampling (e.g. CN101, arXiv:2608.00754) and company thermodynamic platforms rhyme conceptually with software reference `ThermoSettle` DeviceKind; package joules stay software reference until Metered. Bennett reversible computing remains settled theory (§8.0); product reversible ASICs are out of software reference prove scope.

Bridge. §8.0.1 already stated that awareness of floors is not the gap; embodiment is. §8.12 adds the hardware corollary: plateau spend extracts more work per device, and Mixture of Limits is the navigation rule that binds that spend to floors when more work buys nothing. The market reading is in Task Satiation, Section 8.3. §8.13 surveys public transmission / gearing / cascade / memory-context / test-time techniques as plateau options. They are still generators until refuse is law.

II.8.12.1 Hardware-paired navigation (2025 to 2026 peers)

Mixture of Limits is not a software-only order. Navigation is Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model on hardware that is available, accessible, and capable (Metabolic Intelligence states the three tests). Hooker's hardware lottery remains an established result: ideas look like progress when they fit installed chips and kernels (Hooker, 2021; [doi:10.1145/3467017](https://doi.org/10.1145/3467017)).

Recent field work strengthens the pairing without replacing the navigation rule. Huang et al. (arXiv:2507.19142, Jul 2025), A3D-MoE, co-design MoE routing with 3D heterogeneous integration, score-aware HBM access, and attention-MoE fusion; author-reported energy cuts of about 2× to 4× are their architecture result, not OpenIE `measured_j`. Chung, Wu, Ma, and Chowdhury (arXiv:2601.22076, 2026), Where Do the Joules Go?, measure 1,858 inference configurations on H100/B200 and map energy to latent factors across algorithm, software, and hardware layers. Task type alone can swing LLM energy per response by about 25×. That is plateau diagnosis of spend on available fabric. It is not Lookup → Formula → Solver refuse.

Cross-links. Notational Intelligence owns certify-before-commit on the irreversible branch. Satiation owns the economic stop when completeness holds or scarce joules bind. Metabolic Intelligence owns the envelope and fabric interface tax. Software reference path: estimates ≠ board package energy; no FPGA board result claimed.

II.8.13 Plateau techniques: transmission, gearing, cascade, memory/context, test-time

Thesis of this section (SOTA at the plateau). Public research programs optimize transmission (how bits move through attention, KV cache, and interconnect), gearing / MoE routing (which expert / path / attention mode fires), cascade (early-exit prefill, self-decoder then cross-decoder; Lookup→Formula→Solver→Model as OpenIE order), memory/context (long-horizon KV, conditional memory, hybrid attention windows), and test-time (reasoning budgets, multi-token prediction, speculative decode) under hardware and economic constraints. That is plateau spend: algorithmic efficiency on available silicon once Model is open. These programs approach Mixture of Limits ideas (cheapest sufficient compute, refuse waste of HBM / SSD / prefill FLOPs) without naming the law. Unbounded parameter counts and optimization still dominate until memory/context and refuse are first-class. Hardware economics (§8.12) applies: author-reported FLOPs, cache bytes, and API prices are field / author-reported, not OpenIE software reference `measured_j`. Estimates ≠ board package joules. Labs are cited as sources for plateau options by method.

Teach the shared primitives before the technique sections:

Primitive	Meaning in this survey	Floor bind
YOCO (You Only Cache Once)	Decoder-decoder layout: a self-decoder builds shared global KV once; a cross-decoder reuses it via cross-attention; prefill can early-exit after the self-decoder (Sun et al., NeurIPS 2024; arXiv:2405.05254)	Cuts KV memory and prefill work; still a generator architecture; VoI / grammar / certify floors remain
HySparse2	Hybrid sparse attention with two-level KV sharing: outer KV Bridging (YOCO-style self-/cross-decoder, full-attention layers only) plus inner KV Reuse (sparse layers reuse full-attention KV and token-level top-k); prefill exits after the self-decoder (Wei, Gao, …, Luo / Xiaomi LLM-Core; arXiv:2609.26368)	Compresses long-context transmission cost; does not invent a refuse floor outside generation
CSA2 / CED	DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash: Causal Encoder-Decoder (CED, YOCO-inspired) plus Compressed Sparse Attention 2 (Full / Reindex / Reuse modes, hierarchical sparse indexer, FP4 main KV)	Extreme KV and prefill compression for agents; still MoE generation
MoE routing	Gate selects a small active expert set per token (DeepSeekMoE, Qwen MoE, Kimi, Sarvam, Solar, …)	Gearing inside the generative corridor: cheaper than dense, not Mixture of Limits floors
MTP / speculative path	Multi-token prediction or draft modules densify training and accelerate decode	Test-time / decode gearing; energy and VoI floors still bind
Prefix-cache reuse	A session that keeps its prompt prefix reuses cached KV instead of recomputing prefill; a session that breaks reuse recomputes it. The price reading is in Task Satiation, Section 8.5	Cheapest-sufficient transmission; a broken prefix is escalated generative work, not a certified refuse

II.8.13.1 Transmission: attention, KV cache, and interconnect cost YOCO → CED / CSA2 (DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash). YOCO showed that caching global KV once and early-exiting prefill after a self-decoder cuts memory and latency by orders of magnitude on long contexts (Sun et al., 2024; arXiv:2405.05254). DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash pushes that lineage into agent workloads: a multimodal MoE with 552B backbone parameters, up to 1M context, Causal Encoder-Decoder (CED) activating 8B parameters per token in prefill and 16B in decode, Compressed Sparse Attention 2 (CSA2) with Full / Reindex / Reuse modes, FP4 main KV, SWA Bounded Replay, Engram conditional memory, and DSpark speculative decoding (DeepSeek-AI, arXiv:2609.19969; weights at huggingface.co/deepseek-ai/DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash). Author-reported global KV footprint is 890 bytes/token (~1/4 of V4-Flash); persistent KV with SWA Bounded Replay ~1/8 of V4-Flash. That is transmission law under HBM/SSD constraints, not a board joule claim.

HySparse2 (Xiaomi LLM-Core). HySparse2 (Wei, Gao, ..., Cao, Luo / Xiaomi LLM-Core, arXiv:2609.26368) teaches two-level KV sharing for long-horizon agents: KV Bridging (YOCO-style) so prefill can exit after the self-decoder, plus KV Reuse with token-level sparse selection and a forced local window (no separate SWA branch in sparse layers). On matched 80B-A3B MoE ablations, author-reported 1M-token prefill FLOPs drop ~2.92× vs HySparse and ~5.02× vs Hybrid SWA; KV cache ~2.69 GB vs 6.72 / 12.09 GB. Transmission compression under device memory. It is still a generator stack.

Prefix-cache reuse. Reusing a cached prompt prefix is cheapest-sufficient transmission: the KV for the prefix is read, not recomputed. When reuse breaks, prefill is recomputed, and that spend is still generative corridor work, not a certified refuse. The API price gap between cache-hit and cache-miss input is economics and is in Task Satiation, Section 8.5.

Interconnect locality (Huawei LocMoE / PanGu-Σ). LocMoE reduces MoE communication overhead on Ascend clusters (IJCAI 2024; arXiv:2401.13920). PanGu-Σ targets sparse trillion-scale sparse heterogeneous compute (arXiv:2303.10845). Floor bind: routing locality as transmission cost on available accelerators: hardware economics, not software reference joules.

II.8.13.2 Gearing / MoE routing: which expert or path fires DeepSeekMoE / V3. DeepSeek-V3 is a Mixture-of-Experts (MoE) language model with 671B total parameters and 37B activated per token, using Multi-head Latent Attention (MLA), DeepSeekMoE routing, auxiliary-loss-free load balancing, and a Multi-Token Prediction (MTP) training objective that can also support speculative decoding (DeepSeek-AI, arXiv:2412.19437; earlier DeepSeekMoE at ACL 2024). That is gearing: only a sparse expert path runs per token. It approaches cheapest-sufficient *inside* generation.

Xiaomi MiMo (hybrid attention + MoE). Spelling: Xiaomi (not "Xiami"). Public LLM line: MiMo. MiMo-7B is a dense reasoning model pretrained on ~25T tokens with MTP and RL post-training (Xiaomi LLM-Core, arXiv:2505.07608). MiMo-V2-Flash is a 309B-total / 15B-active MoE with hybrid Sliding-Window Attention (SWA) and global attention (5:1, 128-token window), MTP reused as speculative draft, native context extended to 256K (arXiv:2601.02780). Public reporting attributes MiMo V3's intended architecture to HySparse2 under Xiaomi MiMo lead Fuli Luo (team materials / TechNode 2026-09-24; HySparse2 paper authorship). Treat V3 product status as field announcement until a full V3 technical report ships; the routing / cascade / transmission claims bound to the HySparse2 paper. Floor bind: Xiaomi compresses long-context transmission and prefill cascade under device memory (cheapest-sufficient, adjacent to Mixture of Limits) while remaining MoE/hybrid-generator first.

Qwen / Alibaba. Qwen3 MoE uses fine-grained expert segmentation (e.g. 128 experts, 8 active; no shared experts in the Qwen3 MoE design) plus a unified thinking / non-thinking mode and thinking-budget control (Qwen Team, arXiv:2505.09388). Qwen3-Next further sparsifies (public Alibaba materials: hybrid attention, highly sparse MoE, MTP). Floor bind: gearing + test-time budget, still generative; budget is not VoI refuse outside the model.

GLM / Zhipu. Already in §8.11: GLM-4.5 MoE reasoning / agentic releases (arXiv:2508.06471). Floor bind: active-parameter efficiency on silicon; floors outside generation remain Mixture of Limits law.

Moonshot / Kimi. Kimi K2 is a ~1.04T-total / ~32B-active MoE with MLA-class attention and MuonClip training (MoonshotAI, arXiv:2507.20534). Floor bind: extreme sparse gearing; agentic length still hits energy/VoI.

Sarvam. Sarvam-30B is a public MoE (≈30B total / ≈2.4B active; 128 sparse experts + shared expert; top-6 routing; GQA) aimed at multilingual / Indic-language reasoning with efficient deployment (Sarvam model card / docs; Hugging Face `sarvamai/sarvam-30b` config). Floor bind: expert gearing for multilingual benefit under smaller active FLOPs.

Other sourced MoE / efficiency lines (routing-relevant only). - Baichuan. Baichuan 2 public report is dense 7B/13B training systems work (arXiv:2309.10305). Include it only as efficiency-under-hardware, not as MoE routing. Floor bind: systems gearing ≠ Mixture of Limits cascade. - ByteDance Seed. Public Seed / Doubao lines emphasize long-context and agent products. Where MoE or sparse attention is documented, bind as generative gearing under §8.12 economics. - SB Intuitions (SoftBank group). Sarashina2-8×70B is a Japanese MoE upcycled from Sarashina2-70B (8 experts, top-2 active; public SB Intuitions release 2024). Floor bind: sparse gearing under language-local silicon economics. - Upstage. Solar Open / Solar Open 2 public MoE lines (e.g. ~100B-class with ~12B active; later ~250B / ~15B active with hundreds of routed experts; arXiv:2601.07022 and Upstage blogs). Floor bind: MoE gearing on constrained GPU budgets. - Krutrim. Public Krutrim LLM technical report describes a dense multilingual foundational model (arXiv:2502.09642). It is not an MoE routing paper. - AI4Bharat. Strong open Indic datasets and benchmarks (e.g. IndicXTREME / related suites) that other systems evaluate against. They are infrastructure for grammar coverage of Indic languages, not a MoE router itself.

II.8.13.3 Cascade: early-exit prefill and staged decode paths Cascade here means staged work: finish a cheaper stage, then optionally open a costlier one: self-decoder then cross-decoder; prefill then decode; or OpenIE Lookup→Formula→Solver→Model.

- YOCO / CED early-exit. Prefill can exit after the self-decoder once global KV is built (Sun et al., 2024; DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash CED). That is a generator-internal cascade that refuses *waste of prefill FLOPs*, not a VoI refuse outside generation.
- HySparse2 prefill exit. Same YOCO-style exit after KV Bridging; author-reported 1M-token prefill FLOPs compressions above (§8.13.1).
- CED active-parameter schedule. DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash activates 8B per token in prefill and 16B in decode: a cascade of capacity with stage, still MoE generation.
- OpenIE contrast. Mixture of Limits cascade is Lookup → Formula → Solver/settle → Model with typed refuse. Field cascades above densify or sparsify *generation*; they do not certify commit|refuse before irreversible effect.

II.8.13.4 Memory / context: long-horizon KV and conditional memory

- DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash. 1M context; FP4 main KV; 890 bytes/token global KV; SWA Bounded Replay; Engram conditional memory (arXiv:2609.19969). Memory/context is becoming first-class; settle-refuse and VoI outside generation are not.
- Xiaomi MiMo / HySparse2. MiMo-V2-Flash native context to 256K with hybrid SWA/global attention; HySparse2 author-reported KV cache ~2.69 GB at 1M tokens on the matched MoE ablation (vs 6.72 / 12.09 GB baselines).
- NAVER HyperCLOVA. HyperCLOVA X THINK technical materials emphasize reasoning / long context (arXiv:2506.22403). Include them as a context / test-time path, not as MoE gearing unless a MoE card is cited.
- Floor bind. Compressing KV and extending context refuses waste of HBM/SSD under silicon constraints (adjacent to Mixture of Limits on transmission), while unbounded MoE capacity and optimization still dominate until refuse is law.

II.8.13.5 Test-time: reasoning budgets and speculative paths DeepSeek-R1 (test-time reasoning path). DeepSeek-R1 incentivizes reasoning via large-scale reinforcement learning (RL), with R1-Zero showing emergent reflection/verification behaviors and R1 adding cold-start data plus multi-stage training; public report arXiv:2501.12948, with a Nature paper (Guo et al., 2025, DOI 10.1038/s41586-025-09422-z). R1 dynamically allocates more reasoning tokens to harder problems (a test-time cascade) while still overthinking on easy items. Mixture of Limits reading: longer chains are not free of VoI or energy floors (§8.8).

MTP / speculative decode. DeepSeek-V3 MTP and DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash DSpark; MiMo MTP reused as speculative draft; Qwen3-Next MTP. All are decode gearing inside the generative corridor.

Qwen thinking budget. Unified thinking / non-thinking mode with thinking-budget control (arXiv:2505.09388): a test-time spend knob, not VoI refuse outside the model.

HyperCLOVA X THINK. Reasoning / long-context materials (arXiv:2506.22403): a test-time / context path as above.

Floor bind (DeepSeek aggregate). DeepSeek repeatedly refuses *waste of KV / prefill / active parameters*, yet still scales unbounded MoE capacity and optimization. Memory/context is becoming first-class; settle-refuse and VoI outside

generation are not.

Section close. Across these sources, the convergent plateau move is: move fewer bits (YOCO / CED / HySparse2 / FP4 KV), fire fewer experts (MoE), and spend test-time tokens where difficulty rises (R1 / thinking budgets). These are SOTA energy/compute options on available silicon. That converges toward Mixture of Limits floors (stop waste; cheapest sufficient Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model) without stating VoI, grammar, certificate, or settle-refuse as law. Unbounded params + optimization still dominate until memory/context *and* refuse are first-class. Hardware economics (§8.12) is the correct reading of API cache pricing and author-reported KV bytes: field reports, not `measured_j`.

II.8.14 Race to the plateau floors across AI/ML fields

Thesis. The industry narrative frames AI progress as unbounded scale: more parameters, more tokens, more experts. Mixture of Limits reframes that race: it is a race to the true plateaued floors. Across every major AI/ML field below, the plateau move is real engineering (cheaper bits, fewer steps, better uncertainty, better routing). The floor that binds is still VoI, grammar coverage, labeled energy, certificate, or settle-refuse. Once VoI is zero past that floor, optimize energy/compute there (Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model) rather than escalate generation.

Depth over encyclopedia: one verified cite per row; author-reported speedups and scores are field results, not software reference `measured_j`. Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed.

Field	Plateau move	Floor that binds	Cite
RL / RLHF / process reward	Preference reward models + PPO (or process reward on steps) reshape the generative policy toward preferred traces	Reward shaping is still proposal until certify; extra RL / CoT tokens hit VoI and energy once B is covered (§8.8)	Ouyang et al., InstructGPT / RLHF, NeurIPS 2022, arXiv:2203.02155; Lightman et al., process supervision, arXiv:2305.20050
Diffusion (image/video) + distillation	Latent diffusion + step distillation cut denoising compute while preserving sample quality	Denoising steps spend bits/joules; Landauer stays a labeled estimate; certify before commit of generated media	Rombach et al., Latent Diffusion, CVPR 2022; Salimans & Ho, Progressive Distillation, ICLR 2022, arXiv:2202.00512; Blattmann et al., Stable Video Diffusion, arXiv:2311.15127
Graph neural nets	Message-passing GCNs / cousins compress relational structure into local updates	Graph message passes remain Model-class when generative; structure that is Lookup/Formula-covered closes before GNN	Kipf & Welling, GCN, ICLR 2017, arXiv:1609.02907
Multimodal fusion	Contrastive image-text alignment (CLIP-class) shares a joint embedding for zero-shot transfer	Aligned latents do not invent VoI stop; multimodal generation still the last cascade stage under certify	Radford et al., CLIP, ICML 2021 (PMLR v139)
Federated learning	FedAvg aggregates client updates without centralizing raw data; communication rounds become the scarce resource	Comm rounds are plateau cost; VoI still prices whether another round changes B; energy labels stay Estimated unless Metered	McMahan et al., FedAvg, AISTATS 2017 (PMLR v54)
Continual learning	Elastic Weight Consolidation (and cousins) protect important weights against catastrophic forgetting across tasks	Retaining old tasks is plateau memory economics; does not retire grammar coverage or settle-refuse on the new coordinate	Kirkpatrick et al., EWC, *PNAS* 2017. DOI: 10.1073/pnas.1611835114
Pruning / sparsity (beyond MoD)	Lottery-ticket iterative magnitude pruning finds sparse trainable subnetworks that match dense accuracy	Sparse generators still generate; floors outside generation decide whether to open decode (§8.10 MoD for token-depth sparsity)	Frankle & Carbin, Lottery Ticket, ICLR 2019, arXiv:1803.03635
Knowledge distillation	Teacher→student soft-target transfer compresses ensemble or large-model behavior into a cheaper deployable student	Distilled student is cheaper plateau leaf; VoI/grammar still stop escalation when covered	Hinton, Vinyals & Dean, Distilling the Knowledge in a Neural Network, arXiv:1503.02531 (2015)
NAS / hardware-aware NAS	Search (RL or supernet) for architectures; Once-for-All specializes one trained net to device latency without retraining	Architecture search optimizes plateau spend on silicon; does not name refuse outside generation	Zoph & Le, NAS with RL, ICLR 2017, arXiv:1611.01578; Cai et al., Once-for-All, ICLR 2020, arXiv:1908.09791

Field	Plateau move	Floor that binds	Cite
Bayesian deep learning / uncertainty	MC dropout (and variational cousins) approximate posterior predictive uncertainty at test time	Uncertainty scores are proposals for refuse thresholds, not automatic Mixture of Limits receipts until typed certify	Gal & Ghahramani, Dropout as Bayesian Approximation, ICML 2016 (PMLR v48), arXiv:1506.02142
Conformal prediction	Distribution-free prediction sets with finite-sample coverage under exchangeability; abstention when the set is too large	Closest formal cousin to typed refuse: coverage-calibrated abstain rhymes with settle-refuse / VoI stop	Angelopoulos & Bates, Conformal Prediction: A Gentle Introduction, arXiv:2107.07511; Vovk, Gammerman & Shafer, *Algorithmic Learning in a Random World* (2nd ed., 2022)
Causal ML	Structural causal models / do-calculus separate intervention from association	Causal identification is Formula/Solver grammar when the graph is known; associative generators stay the last cascade stage	Pearl, *Causality* (2nd ed.); Pearl, Causal inference in statistics: An overview, *Stat. Surv.* 2009
Active learning (VoI cousin)	Query the label that most reduces expected risk / uncertainty under a labeling budget	Settles-class active selection is Howard VoI operationalized for labels; stop when marginal label VoI $\leq$ cost	Settles, Active Learning Literature Survey, U. Wisconsin TR 1648 (2009); Howard (1966) VoI (§7.1)
Compression / distillation cascades	Progressive or multi-stage distill (diffusion steps; teacher→student chains) compound plateau compression	Cascaded distill remains generative efficiency; OpenIE cascade is Lookup→Formula→Solver→Model with typed refuse	Salimans & Ho (2022); Hinton et al. (2015); §8.13.3 field early-exit cascades
CUDA Graphs / kernel fusion	Capture static GPU work as a replayable graph; fuse kernels to cut launch and memory traffic	Systems plateau spend on the device; still serves generators; floors decide whether work runs	NVIDIA CUDA Programming Guide (CUDA Graphs); PyTorch CUDA Graphs / `torch.compile` reduce-overhead notes
Agent memory systems	OS-inspired paging of agent context (main vs external memory; MemGPT-class) under fixed context windows	Memory hierarchy is transmission/context economics (§8.13.4); unbounded agent loops still hit VoI/energy; certify before irreversible tool effects	Packer et al., MemGPT, arXiv:2310.08560 (2023)
RAG variants (GraphRAG)	Build entity/community graph summaries; map-reduce over communities for global corpus questions	Graph index can rhyme with Lookup when certified; uncertified community text remains proposal (§8.10 RAG row)	Edge et al., GraphRAG, arXiv:2404.16130 (2024)
Structured generation (beyond GCD/CRANE)	FSM / regex / CFG-guided decoding (Outlines-class) masks illegal tokens at sample time	Constrains tokens; Mixture of Limits constrains commit (§9 GCD/CRANE). Grammar coverage can close at Formula without an LLM	Willard & Louf, Efficient Guided Generation for LLMs (Outlines), arXiv:2307.09702 (2023)

Teach-first takeaway. Every row races toward a cheaper or safer plateau. None retires Mixture of Limits floors. The true race across AI/ML is to find the floor, then optimize energy/compute on it, not to pretend scale has no stop.

Deliberate gaps (not missing awareness). Exhaustive RL algorithm taxonomies, product-only video systems without public methods papers, vendor CUDA Graph marketing slides without a public programming-model cite, and geography-as-organizing-axis surveys stay out: depth on floors beats name-dumps. Formal verification / LeanDojo-class theorem proving already sits in the industry-gap reference block as a Solver cousin, not repeated here.

II.9. Mixture of Limits is not MoE, and the model-to-model SOTA table

II.9.0 Spine (history + mathematics; SOTA at the plateau)

Mixture of Limits is an information-theoretic approach rooted in physics: formula/law discovery in the Newton-Kepler lineage, not excess generation. Academia already has Shannon → Landauer → complexity/VoI → symbolic and energy floors; Mixture of Limits embodies those floors in a commit|refuse cascade. The remaining bottleneck is applied math × materials (hardware), not an awareness gap. The industry race is a race to the plateau floors, not unbounded scale. The table below situates field systems so readers see what they optimize (which neural generator runs). For latent depth, Logical Intelligence EBM hybrids, World Labs world models, and SOTA at the plateau (§8.7: test-time, super learning, live SOTA methods, SSM/MoE/implementation efficiency, hardware economics,

transmission/gearing/cascade/memory-context/test-time techniques, and the cross-field floors table in §8.14), see §8.4-§8.14: once VoI is zero past the floor, those methods are plateau spend options under Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model. Mixture of Limits asks whether a generator should run at all, then how little energy to spend on the plateau, converging to VoI/floors the way physics converged to predictive laws.

II.9.1 Law contrast (not a rebrand)

Mixture of Experts (MoE) places experts inside a generative corridor: a gate selects parameters; success is next-token likelihood; capacity grows by adding experts to the same act. Mixture of Limits places named floors outside generation: Lookup → Formula → Solver/settle → Model; success is closed grammar + certified commit|refuse + joule receipt; the model is a demoted residual leaf, cold by default (`allow_model=false`).

Axis	MoE / model↔model field	Mixture of Limits
Where the mixture lives	Inside the model (experts, draft/target pairs, strong/weak LLMs)	Outside generation (named floors + cascade gears)
Routing object	Which model (or draft head) answers	Which tier closes: Lookup / Formula / Solver / Model
Refuse	Rare; usually escalate to a larger model	First-class: VoI, grammar, settle, certificate, primitive_gap, fabric_unavailable, …
Energy labels	Often latency/cost proxies; some papers meter GPU energy for LLM serving	Receipts: `estimated_j` labeled; software reference `measured_j=None`; no FPGA board result claimed
Success metric	Tokens/s, cost@quality, speculative speedup	Certified commit + typed ReplayClass + receipt

RouteLLM, GreenServ, and HCSpec optimize which neural generator runs (cost, Wh, or decode speedup inside the generative corridor). Mixture of Limits asks whether a generator should run at all.

Cascades and metareasoning. The cascade is a classical form. Viola and Jones ran a cascade of boosted classifiers: cheap stages reject most inputs, and only hard inputs reach costly stages (CVPR 2001, DOI:10.1109/CVPR.2001.990517). Russell and Wefald priced each computation by its expected value to the decision, net of its cost, and stopped when no computation had positive net value (*Artificial Intelligence* 49, 1991, DOI:10.1016/0004-3702(91)90015-C). Horvitz set the same trade for reasoning under bounded resources (UAI 1987, arXiv:1304.2759). FrugalGPT cascades language models and stops when a learned scorer accepts the answer (Chen, Zaharia and Zou 2023, arXiv:2305.05176). Mixture of Limits is this lineage with three changes. The stages include non-neural gears, lookup, formula and solver, ahead of any model. The stop test is the completeness predicate $C(z)$, not a learned score. The cost is metered joules on a receipt, not dollars or latency. The order is optimal under the condition above and not otherwise.

Baselines. A cascade claim is tested on a cost-quality frontier: joules per task against closure rate, on one typed task set. The arms are always-large model, always-small model, a learned router in the style of RouteLLM, a FrugalGPT-style scored cascade, the σ-law selector (itself a Mixture of Limits instance), and an oracle that knows the cheapest sufficient gear for each task. The fixed Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model cascade claims the frontier only where its curve lies below every arm.

II.9.2 Field SOTA (all model↔model routing / speculation / constrained generation)

Every row below is model↔model: routers choose among LLMs; speculative methods draft-then-verify with draft/target models; constrained decoding still samples from an LLM under a grammar. None implements Lookup→Formula→Solver→Model with refuse-to-commit as the close rule.

Measurement labels: Metered | Estimated | Unmetered; use a paper's own method section for its label. Field joules stay field results. Software reference prove path: Unmetered (software-ref); no FPGA board result claimed.

System	Title (verified)	ID	Class	What it routes / accelerates	Energy / cost as reported by authors	Vs Mixture of Limits
RouteLLM	*RouteLLM: Learning to Route LLMs with Preference Data* (arXiv); ICLR 2025 venue title uses *from Preference Data*	arXiv:2406.18665 · ICLR 2025	Preference router (strong↔weak LLM)	Query → strong or weak LLM	Cost / quality (API $); not Mixture of Limits Landauer receipts	Model↔model; no Lookup/Formula floor; no typed refuse-to-commit
PEARL (routing)	*PEARL: Performance and energy aware routing for LLMs*	DOI:10.1016/j.future.2025.108218 · FGCS 176:108218	Energy-aware multi-LLM router	Query → LLM under energy cap (EMM predicts energy)	Authors report energy-aware routing (GPU/infra); not imported as Mixture of Limits `measured_j`	Still picks a model; Mixture of Limits may refuse before any model
GreenServ	*GreenServ: Energy-Efficient Context-Aware Dynamic Routing for Multi-Model LLM Inference*	arXiv:2601.17551 · ICPE 2026	Contextual bandit multi-LLM router	Query features → LLM; accuracy vs measured GPU energy (Zeus)	Metered (authors' GPU Wh via Zeus) on their LLM pool (field result, not Mixture of Limits board synth)	Model pool routing; Mixture of Limits cascade is non-neural first
VoltanaLLM	*VoltanaLLM: Energy-Efficient and SLO-Aware Disaggregated LLM Serving via Adaptive Frequency Control and State-Space Routing*	arXiv:2509.04827	P/D-disagg serving + frequency + state-space route	Prefill/decode instances + GPU frequency under TTFT/ITL SLOs	Metered (authors; pyNVML on A100/GH200) up to ~36.3% E2E GPU energy vs max-freq baseline (field serving result)	Routes instances of the same generative stack; Mixture of Limits may never open decode
HCSpec	*HCSpec: Two-Tier Horizontal Cascade Speculative Decoding for High-Efficiency Large Language Model Inference*	DOI:10.18653/v1/2026.acl-long.353 · ACL 2026	Speculative decoding (draft↔target)	Position-specialized draft cascade → target verify	Latency speedup (vs EAGLE-3 / AR); energy not Mixture of Limits claim	Speeds generation; does not refuse generation on floors
CAS-Spec	*CAS-Spec: Cascade Adaptive Self-Speculative Decoding for On-the-Fly Lossless Inference Acceleration of LLMs*	arXiv:2510.26843 · NeurIPS 2025	Self-speculative cascade (DSIA drafts)	Draft stages from target (sparsity/quant) + DyTC	Latency speedup ~1.1×-2.3× AR (authors); lossless tokens	Model-internal draft hierarchy ≠ Mixture of Limits floors
GCD	*Grammar-Constrained Decoding for Structured NLP Tasks without Finetuning*	arXiv:2305.13971 · DOI:10.18653/v1/2023.emnlp-main.674 · EMNLP 2023	Grammar-constrained LLM decoding	Mask logits to CFG	Unmetered / quality metrics	Constrains tokens; Mixture of Limits constrains commit
CRANE	*CRANE: Reasoning with constrained LLM generation*	arXiv:2502.09061 · ICML 2025 (PMLR v267)	Reasoning-augmented constrained decoding	Alternate unconstrained reason ↔ constrained answer	Accuracy on GSM-symbolic / FOLIO; not Mixture of Limits joules	Still LLM generation under grammar; Mixture of Limits can close at Formula without an LLM

System	Title (verified)	ID	Class	What it routes / accelerates	Energy / cost as reported by authors	Vs Mixture of Limits
Constitutional AI	*Constitutional AI: Harmlessness from AI Feedback*	arXiv:2212.08073	Principle-trained refuse / RLAIF	Critique→revise under a written constitution; RL from AI feedback	Alignment quality / human prefs; not Mixture of Limits joules	Trained textual refuse inside the generator; Mixture of Limits typed certify-before-commit + receipted floors outside generation
Toolformer / ReAct	Toolformer (NeurIPS 2023); *ReAct: Synergizing Reasoning and Acting in Language Models*	Toolformer arXiv:2302.04761 · ReAct arXiv:2210.03629	Tool-use / agent loop	LM decides when to call APIs / act↔observe	Task accuracy; not Mixture of Limits Landauer receipts	Agent routing among tools still opens a model; Mixture of Limits may close at Lookup/Formula before any tool or model

Name collision (do not conflate): ICLR 2025 also has *PEARL: Parallel Speculative Decoding with Adaptive Draft Length* (arXiv:2408.11850); speculative, not the FGCS energy router. §9's PEARL row is the routing paper (DOI 10.1016/j.future.2025.108218). Speculative PEARL sits in the same model↔model bucket as HCSpec/CAS-Spec if cited later.

II.9.3 What Mixture of Limits claims instead

From PLAN prove (see §6):

1. Cascade order is law, not a heuristic over LLMs: Lookup → Formula → Solver/settle → Model.
2. Refuse-to-commit is typed and receipted (`voi`, `settle_refuse`, `efa_certificate`, `primitive_gap`, `fabric_unavailable`, `claim_unknown`, ...).
3. Receipt labels on the verified path: `measured_j=None` (Unmetered), estimates labeled (Estimated), no FPGA board result claimed.
4. ReplayClass cannot strengthen: `ModelGenerated` ↛ `Deterministic`.
5. Software reference multi-fabric routing chooses `DeviceKind` after tier close; still not "pick GPT-4 vs Mixtral."

II.9.4 Measurement bounds

Software reference / paper-results bound	Allowed
Software reference prove path `measured_j`	Software reference prove with `measured_j=None` (Metered only when a probe returns)
Board synth flag without meter + synth log	No FPGA board result claimed
GreenServ / VoltanaLLM Wh as software reference board energy	Cite them as field model-to-model SOTA with their own Metered labels
Tokens/J horse race vs HCSpec	Refuse-before-tokens as the navigation win

Field SOTA above remains model↔model. Mixture of Limits contribution is not a better router among generators: it is the navigation rule that embodies known information/energy floors, with a prove harness that keeps Model last and refuse first-class.

II.10. Toward AGI via limits: open questions and companions

If AGI-grade reliability means closing tasks with certificates, receipts, and known floors, not maximizing tokens under an unlimited generative prior, then the historical method already points the way. Kepler and Newton pursued limits: the shortest predictive law that covered the grammar. Shannon priced bits; Howard priced VoI; Landauer and Bennett priced irreversible erasure; Kolmogorov, Solomonoff, and Chaitin priced compression and incompleteness. Recent

formula/mechanism systems (AI Feynman, SINDy, PySR, AI-Newton, AlphaGeometry, MWMs) keep proving the same pattern in modern form.

The missing piece is not the idea. Shannon, Howard, Landauer, Bennett, Kolmogorov, Solomonoff, and Chaitin state the floors as settled theory. The bottleneck Mixture of Limits asserts is applied mathematics embodied in materials and physical hardware: devices, fabrics, and meters that make cheapest-sufficient close real at the edge, without laundering estimates as board watts, and without treating MoE capacity as a substitute for grammar coverage.

Mixture of Limits says CI should navigate those floors explicitly: Lookup and Formula first, Solver when settle is the right physics, Model last, refuse when VoI or safety says stop. Software reference prove shows the navigation rule is constructive in software. Companions on this site (NI commit record; Satiation task completion) supply interfaces and economic stops. Software reference path keeps no FPGA board result claimed and `measured_j=None` unless Metered.

Open questions

- Calibrated μ corpora and silicon HW meters (live catalog 258 Present / 258 live gears + HW Gaps software reference sims ×8 + Ferric/Stage C inventories are in software reference proof; Gap cells retained; estimates≠measured_j; `stage_c_measured=false` until meters).
- Live WCA MCP / System One pre-gate and leapfrog `openie-path` ask (adapters remain stubs on the verified path).
- Materials / device paths that make Formula+LUT coin-cell closes dominate generative spend, with Metered probes when package joules are claimed.
- When a Metered `measured_j` path is published beside software reference estimates without laundering estimate as board watts.
- How VoI thresholds should be set per domain without smuggling engagement metrics as completeness (see Satiation).
- Whether mechanism libraries (MWM cousins; AI-Newton concept base) should be imported as typed Lookup entries without breaking clean-room prove.
- How to bind third-party EBM settle scores (e.g. Logical Intelligence-style energies) and world-model proposals (e.g. World Labs Atlas/Marble) into certify-before-commit without laundering generative output as Deterministic.
- How to price test-time compute budgets under VoI so adaptive thinking stops when marginal CoT tokens do not change B, without treating longer traces as automatic progress.
- Whether academic super-learner libraries should be imported as typed Solver/ensemble leaves under certify, without equating them to industry superintelligence narratives.
- How to document plateau-efficiency options (DeepSeek / GLM-class MoE and systems co-design; speculative decoding; SSM hybrids; AWQ/GPTQ/FP8; vLLM/SGLang; Mixture-of-Depths) as Estimated field results beside software reference receipts, keeping author GPU-hours distinct from Mixture of Limits `measured_j`.
- How typed certify-before-commit should bind Constitutional AI / RLAIF textual refuse and tool-use agent loops (Toolformer / ReAct) without laundering model-emitted refuse as a Mixture of Limits receipt.
- Whether neuromorphic (Loihi-class) and thermodynamic-compute field stacks should appear as optional `DeviceKind` under multi-fabric routing once Metered probes exist, without escalating author mJ/token estimates to software reference `measured_j`.
- Pause-token / self-paced adaptive compute (theory cousins of Mixture-of-Depths) stay software reference until a typed floor maps them; do not invent `measured_j`.
- How to import conformal abstention and Bayesian uncertainty scores as typed refuse thresholds without laundering model-emitted confidence as a Mixture of Limits receipt.
- Whether GraphRAG community summaries and MemGPT-class agent memory pages should bind as Lookup when certified, or remain proposal until certify-before-commit.
- How active-learning VoI budgets (Settles/Howard) should share threshold machinery with test-time CoT VoI (§8.8) without smuggling engagement metrics as completeness.
- How dual-phase perception (§11.1) should bound Phase-1 transducer energy so typed AST emission stays cheaper than opening the last cascade stage on unstructured input.
- How VoI / grammar meta-checks (§11.2) stay O(1) Bloom/trie/EBNF relative to the smallest allowed inference leaf.
- How Primitive Distillation (§11.3) certifies the last cascade stage proposals into new Lookup/Formula entries without laundering uncertified proposals as Deterministic.

- When Tier-2 shunt meters (§11.4) publish package `measured_j` beside Tier-0 analytical and Tier-1 OS telemetry without mixing estimate classes on a receipt.
- How the claim regime, the test-system label, the multi-indicator specification, the metrology programme, the technical report, and the facility reporting duty in §11.4.1 stay off the receipt until a Metered probe returns a joule for the run.

Companions on this site

- Metered Commit Gates, Part I (Notational Intelligence); commit/refuse record; analytical energy; measurement bounds.
- Task Satiation vs. Aggregate Rebound in AI Demand; task completion after free digital inference.
- Metabolic Intelligence; energy-budget embodiment from tag to campus.
- Living figures: /living/mol/ (companions; analytical OpCounter ≠ board power; package `measured_j` only when Metered).

Closing sentence. Pursuit of limits (compression into predictive law, priced information, thermodynamic accounting) is the through-line from Kepler and Newton to Shannon, Howard, Landauer, and Kolmogorov. Mixture of Limits is that through-line stated as a navigation rule for computer intelligence; embodying it in materials remains the hard problem. Section 11 names the next engineering gaps on that embodiment path. The industry race is a race to the plateau floors, not unbounded scale. Once the floor is known and VoI is zero past it, SOTA at the plateau (§8.4-§8.14) means optimize energy/compute with cheapest-sufficient Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model. Latents, EBM hybrids, world models, test-time, ensembles, SSM/MoE efficiency, transmission/gearing/cascade/memory-context techniques, and the cross-field plateau moves of §8.14 are the options. They do not retire the floors. Computers are hardware; software is applied engineering under constraints; labeled joule accounting binds.

II.11. Closing the engineering gaps: dual-phase roadmap

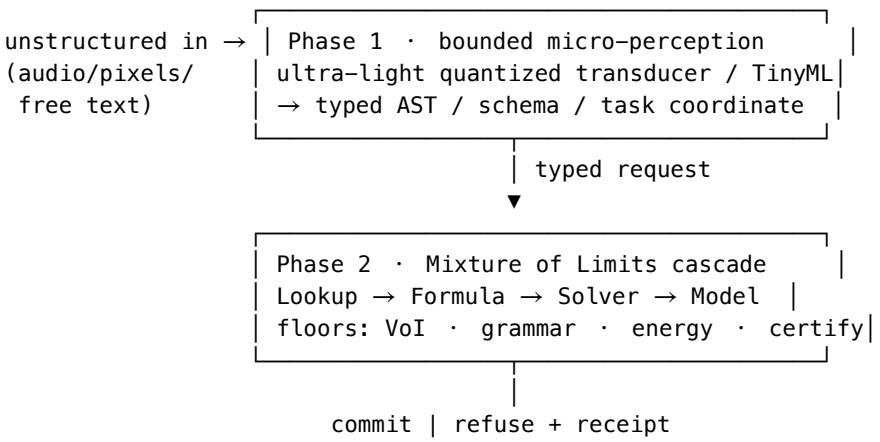
Shannon, Landauer, Howard, and formula-first science already name the floors. Software reference `mol prove` shows constructive existence in software. What remains is engineering: close the gaps that keep Mixture of Limits from owning unstructured front doors, cheap meta-routing, open-ended domains, honest meters, and a usable developer surface, without inventing package joules or demoting the cascade.

This section states those gaps as plateau work under named floors. Each item is a gap to close, not a hedge on the law. Estimates remain estimates. No FPGA board result claimed. Only Metered paths populate `measured_j`.

II.11.1 Front-door perception paradox: dual-phase stack

Gap. Mixture of Limits cascade assumes a typed task coordinate: Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model. Real front doors arrive unstructured: speech waveforms, pixels, free text. Without a front gear, the system either refuses everything outside grammar or opens the last cascade stage as the parser. Both fail the plateau: refuse wastes covered work; parser-as-model burns residual capacity before floors are checked.

Close. Dual-phase Mixture of Limits:



Phase 1 is a bounded front gear: fixed vocabulary or schema emitters in the TinyML / quantized-transducer class (MCUNet-class MCU inference; Tiny Transducer-class speech ASR). Clean-room ships a rule AST transducer path (`phase1.enabled` / `mol phase1`) that emits typed ticket/physics/settle asks; unrecognized input refuses parser-as-model. It does not replace Formula. It does not become the substrate. The last cascade stage remains the residual reasoning leaf inside Phase 2 when grammar and VoI say escalate, not the front-door parser by default.

Plateau reading. Perception spend is plateau spend on the front gear. Once the AST is typed, VoI past the grammar floor is still zero for covered coordinates. Dual-phase does not demote Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model; it feeds that cascade.

II.11.2 Meta-compute routing overhead

Gap. VoI checks, grammar coverage, and settle-refuse must gate escalation. If those checks cost more than a small inference leaf, the router loses to always-call-model on wall-clock and joules (as estimates). Meta-compute that is heavier than the thing it refuses is not a floor. It is waste on the plateau.

Close. Keep routing strictly cheaper than the smallest allowed inference:

Check	Target cost class	Mechanism sketch
Grammar hit / miss	O(1) or O(token) streaming	Trie / Aho-Corasick over typed AST terminals; Bloom filter for negative Lookup
Schema / EBNF accept	linear in input, no model	Deterministic EBNF / PEG parse; reject → refuse or escalate
VoI stop	O(1) threshold table	Precomputed Δ B vs catalog cost; no forward pass
Settle-ready	O(state) local	Ternary / certificate probe before Solver open

```
request AST
     │
     ▼
[Bloom / trie Lookup?] ──hit──> Lookup close
     │ miss
     ▼
[EBNF / Formula grammar?] ──cover──> Formula / Solver
     │ uncovered
     ▼
[VoI > 0 AND allow_model?] ──yes──> the last cascade stage → certify
     │ no
     ▼
   refuse + receipt
```

Rule: if a proposed meta-check needs a neural forward pass, it is not a Mixture of Limits floor check. It is another leaf and must be budgeted as such.

II.11.3 Static Periodic Stack vs open-ended domains

Gap. Software reference navigates a Periodic Stack subset (Present/Gap cells; scale notes cite 258 primitives / 33 families). Open-ended domains arrive with undefined grammar. A static stack either silently under-covers or pretends coverage.

Close. Two disciplined exits when grammar is undefined:

1. Refuse or escalate with an explicit `primitive_gap` / grammar-miss receipt. Refuse is success when VoI or safety says stop. Escalation opens the last cascade stage only under budget and `allow_model`.
2. Primitive Distillation Loop when a residual is worth keeping:

```
the last cascade stage proposal
       │
       ▼
certify (typed check / proof / settle)
```

```
       | pass
       ▼
AST compile → new Lookup row or Formula identity
       |
       ▼
Periodic Stack Present cell (replay class Deterministic)
```

Uncertified proposals never become Lookup. Distilled entries carry provenance: source receipt, certify method, replay class. This is plateau embodiment of formula-first science: the model proposes; the stack keeps only what certifies.

II.11.4 Measurement realism: Tier 0 / Tier 1 / Tier 2

Gap. Readers collapse Landauer annotations, OpCounter analytics, OS telemetry, and board shunt readings into one "joules" number. Mixture of Limits forbids that collapse.

Close. Three labeled tiers; only Tier 2 Metered populates package `measured_j`:

Tier	Source	Receipt fields	What it is not
0 Analytical	Catalog μ, OpCounter, Landauer $nk_BT\ln 2$	`estimated_j`, `landauer_floor_J`, `mu_source=catalog`	Board package energy
1 OS telemetry	RAPL, NVML, IOReport, powermetrics	Labeled `MeasureSource`; may set `measured_j` only when Metered probe succeeds	Shunt-grade package truth; VM/unavailable stays unset
2 Shunt / package meter	Inline current shunt, certified bench meter	`measured_j` under Metered; the board-result flag only if synth+meter path is actually claimed	Software reference default (software reference keeps no FPGA board result claimed)

```
Tier 0  estimated_j / Landauer estimate
Tier 1  OS telemetry (RAPL/NVML/⋯) ⟶ measured_j only if Metered label
Tier 2  shunt / package meter     ⟶ measured_j (Metered)
```

Measurement facts (unchanged). Software reference path: no FPGA board result claimed; `measured_j=None` unless a Metered probe returns. Estimates ≠ board joules. Never invent `measured_j` from prove criteria, catalog ratios, or field author GPU-hours.

II.11.4.1 Public documents, by what they measure

Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. Correctness is the gate, and among systems that pass it, joules alone order them. An estimator, a label, a specification, a programme, a technical report, or a facility reporting duty is not a joule on a commit. Mixture of Limits leaves `measured_j` unset until a Metered probe returns. The documents below are ordered by what each page says the document measures or claims. The critique is the common mechanism: estimator versus a meter. Estimates are not measured joules.

Claim regime. AFNOR SPEC 2314, *Référentiel général pour l'IA frugale*, AFNOR, June 2024. The shop record is 100 pages, with free consultation authorized by AFNOR. The specification states that it was drawn from January 2024 to June 2024, from successive contributions of more than one hundred members of the participating organizations. The ministry press release of 28 June 2024 states 150 contributors and calls the référentiel a first at international level, of voluntary application. The AFNOR news page of 12 July 2024 states a working group of about forty actors and 31 practice sheets. The text contains practice sheets BP 01 through BP 31. Section 4 states what to specify when communicating on the frugal character of an AI service. Annex 1 compares tools that may be used and says the list is not exhaustive. In the column headed measurement of consumption it names CodeCarbon and CarbonTracker, lists direct measurement as an advantage, and lists as a limit that direct measurement is not always possible and that the tools make choices that are not always explicit, for example the emission factor. Practice sheet BP 21 says to record the estimate supplied by those tools (printed there as Code Carbon, Green Algorithms, Carbon Tracker, and MLCO2Impact), then the real consumption of the training. Practice sheet BP 23 is an a priori estimate of model consumption and names CodeCarbon, TensorFlox Profiler, and nvidia-smi as tools that can be used to estimate and to measure. The specification does not require a meter on the commit.

Measured-on-a-test-system label. Umweltzeichen Blauer Engel for ressourcen- und energieeffiziente Softwareprodukte (DE-UZ 215), Umweltbundesamt, edition January 2020, version 6 (July 2026), published by RAL gGmbH. The criteria define the Messsystem as the hardware system on which the product is installed and the measurements are run, including the operating system and its configuration. They also call that system the system under test. For a personal computer or a server, electrical energy demand is determined by integrating electrical power, in watts, over the duration, in seconds, of the standard usage scenario or the long-term test, or by a meter that records electrical work, in watt-seconds, directly. Scenario-test energy is reported net of the electrical baseline, in watt-hours. That is a measurement on a stated test system for a stated usage scenario. It is not the energy of a Mixture of Limits commit.

Estimator variant in the research report beside that label. SoftAWERE, Umweltbundesamt TEXTE 71/2026, completion date May 2023. The report defines two methods. SoftAWERE-Light does without measurements and computes an estimate of energy use and environmental impact from mathematical formulas. The report assigns that variant to cloud and virtualized environments where a physical measurement, or a measurement through server interfaces, is not possible. The full SoftAWERE method does without physical measuring devices and uses existing interfaces of the server manufacturer and the operating system. The indicator Operational Primary Energy Consumption is an estimated server energy use over one hour taken from manufacturer data. The report marks that indicator as no measurement. The report also states that energy from unit tests and integration tests is not a consumer environmental label and does not replace the Blue Angel, because those tests have little to do with later use. A formula estimate is not a measured joule. An interface reading is not the shunt tier.

Multi-indicator specification. ESPECIFICACION UNE 0086:2025, *Medición del consumo energético, huella de carbono, consumo del agua y rendimiento de sistemas de Inteligencia Artificial*, UNE, edition 8 October 2025, corrected 29 July 2026. The UNE catalog page states that the download is free and is sponsored by the Secretaría de Estado de Digitalización e Inteligencia Artificial. The UNE notice of 10 October 2025 states a working group of over 40 members, including certification bodies, and states that the specification defines indicators of direct energy and water consumption during training and inference. The secretariat press of 9 October 2025 states 35 expert entities in its summary line and more than 40 members in the body. That press states a detailed guide for quantifying environmental impact across the life cycle, especially training and implementation, locally and in the cloud. On the pages that state the requirement, the energy number is an indicator of direct energy consumption during training and inference, inside a specification that also covers carbon, water, and performance. Those pages do not name the instrument.

Metrology programme. 《人工智能计量体系和能力建设指引（2026 版）》, 市场监管总局 and 国家发展改革委, notice of 28 May 2026. The notice states a goal that AI technical performance be measurable, comparable, and traceable. It sets out six parts: foundational support, general technology, core technology, metrology technical specifications, a metrology services industry, and intelligence applied to metrology. It calls for metrology standard devices covering algorithm models, compute efficiency, and data quality, and for work in 14 fields. The notice is a programme for building that capability. It does not require a joule reading of a run. Traceability on this page is a stated goal for technical performance. It is not a reading tied to a measurement standard on a commit.

Technical report. PD CEN/CLC/TR 18145:2025, *Environmentally sustainable Artificial Intelligence*, BSI publication 28 February 2025. A CEN-CENELEC gap analysis dated 18 December 2025 lists the same report, work item JT021010, as published in the JTC 21 column. The published scope describes environmental sustainability issues for those developing or using AI, creates an inventory of impacts and techniques, and states that methods of measuring the environmental sustainability impacts of AI are also quantified. It states that the document is intended to help develop new standards. It states that it is aligned with ISO/IEC TR 20226, whose title on that page is Green and Sustainable AI. A technical report is not a harmonised standard. CEN and CENELEC, in a decision posted 23 October 2025, state that key standards developed under CEN-CLC/JTC 21, requested under standardization request M/593 and amendment M/613, are to be available by Q4 2026. That page does not name TR 18145 among those drafts. It does not say those drafts are already harmonised standards.

Facility reporting duty. The Agency for Natural Resources and Energy (資源エネルギー庁), explainer of 20 May 2026, states that new measures under the 省エネ·非化石転換法 took effect in April 2026. From the fiscal year 2026 submission, the periodic report adds data-centre electricity use, PUE, エネルギー消費原単位, and future targets. The page defines PUE as the data centre facility's total energy consumption divided by the IT equipment's energy consumption. The same page sets a benchmark of PUE at or below 1.4 by fiscal year 2030 for designated data-centre operators, and a PUE at or below 1.3 for data centres newly built from fiscal year 2029, assessed from the fiscal year after two years of operation. PUE is facility overhead. It is not the energy of a computation.

II.11.4.2 Research that treats energy as the condition

Public standards have no firm requirement to be energy first and energy bound. Mixture of Limits treats energy to run as the foundation. The Klere energy processing unit is the hardware that can hold a run to that bound. A standard that leaves the meter optional does not. The works below treat energy, power, or a physical bound as a condition of the computation. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. Correctness is the gate, and among systems that pass it, joules alone order them. A number below is that paper's bound or that paper's measurement. It is not package `measured_j`.

Speed bound from energy. Margolus and Levitin (1998) bound the minimum time for an isolated system to reach an orthogonal state by the average energy above the ground state, $\tau_\perp \geq h/(4E)$. Their abstract states that adding one joule of energy cannot raise the processing rate by more than about 3×10^{33} operations per second. Class: physical bound.

Work bound on measurement and erasure. Sagawa and Ueda (2009) derive lower bounds on the work of a measurement and on the work of erasure. The sum is bounded below by the mutual information I gained in the measurement, $W_{\text{meas}} + W_{\text{eras}} \geq k_{\text{B}}TI$. For a symmetric memory the erasure bound matches Landauer. For an asymmetric memory the erasure bound can lie below that match. Class: thermodynamic bound.

Dissipation of nonpredictive memory. Still, Sivak, Bell, and Crooks (2012) set the instantaneous nonpredictive information equal to the average work dissipated when the driving signal changes, in units of $k_{\text{B}}T$. A system built to keep memory, and built to operate at minimum dissipation, has to be predictive. Class: thermodynamic bound.

Measured erasure. Bérut, Arakelyan, Petrosyan, Ciliberto, Dillenschneider, and Lutz (2012) erase one bit stored in a colloidal particle in a modulated double-well trap. They report that the mean dissipated heat saturates at the Landauer bound in the limit of long erasure cycles. Class: measured approach to a thermodynamic bound. That heat is their measurement.

Jun, Gavrilov, and Bechhoefer (2014) erase one bit with a colloidal particle in a feedback trap. Work is computed from the trajectory and the imposed potential. The full-erasure protocol's asymptotic work is compatible with the Landauer bound. The same cycle without phase-space compression is compatible with zero work. Class: measured work of erasure, with a reversible control. That work is their measurement.

Heat of a Turing-machine realization. Kolchinsky and Wolpert (2020) assign a heat function to a physical realization of a Turing machine. For the coin-flipping realization of a universal machine, heat on an input is proportional to the excess length of that input over the shortest program for the same output, up to an additive constant. The minimum heat required to produce any chosen output is bounded by a constant. The expected heat on the coin-flipping input distribution is infinite. Class: thermodynamic bound on a computation. The heat function is not package `measured_j`.

Energy as the training objective. You, Chung, and Chowdhury (2023) define energy-to-accuracy as average GPU power times time-to-accuracy. GPU power is read with NVML, and the GPU power limit is a training knob. An exploratory run stops when its cost exceeds twice the lowest cost observed so far. The paper reports energy reductions of 15.3% to 75.8% against maximum batch size and maximum power limit, on the GPUs named in the evaluation. Class: energy as the objective of training, with a stop. Those reductions are their NVML measurements.

Energy schedule under a time bound. Chung, Gu, Jang, Meng, Bansal, and Chowdhury (2024) define energy bloat as the energy in a large-model training iteration that can be removed without lengthening the critical path. Perseus profiles the time and energy of each forward and backward computation and sets GPU frequency through NVML. The energy-optimal iteration time is the minimum of the minimum-energy iteration time and the straggler iteration time. The paper reports per-iteration energy reductions of up to 30%, with negligible or no slowdown. Class: energy schedule of a training iteration. Those reductions are their measurements.

II.11.4.3 Neuromorphic substrates and measured-run energy

Mixture of Limits treats energy to run as the foundation. The works below state energy or power of a computation as a physical quantity on a named platform, or they stop under an energy or accuracy-energy bound. They are ordered by method class, not by region. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. Correctness is the gate, and among systems that pass it, joules alone order them. A number below is that paper's own measurement or that paper's own bound. It is not package `measured_j`. Estimates are not `measured_j`.

Physical quantity of a neuromorphic substrate. Merolla, Arthur, Alvarez-Icaza, Cassidy, Sawada, Akopyan, Jackson, Imam, Guo, Nakamura, Brezzo, Vo, Esser, Appuswamy, Taba, Amir, Flickner, Risk, Manohar, and Modha (2014)

build TrueNorth: 4096 neurosynaptic cores, 1 million programmable spiking neurons, and 256 million configurable synapses. With 400-by-240 video at 30 frames per second, the chip consumes 63 mW. Class: physical quantity of a neuromorphic substrate. That 63 mW is their measurement.

Frenkel, Lefebvre, Legat, and Bol (2018) build ODIN, a 256-neuron 64k-synapse online-learning digital spiking processor in 28 nm FDSOI. At 0.55 V they report a global energy per synaptic operation of 12.7 pJ at the maximum synaptic-operation rate. With rank-order coding on a single-layer MNIST network after on-chip SDSP learning, they report 15 nJ per inference at 84.5% accuracy. Class: physical quantity of a neuromorphic substrate, and measured energy of a run. Those energies are their measurements.

Measured energy of a run on a named neuromorphic platform. Esser, Merolla, Arthur, Cassidy, Appuswamy, Andreopoulos, Berg, McKinstry, Melano, Barch, di Nolfo, Datta, Amir, Taba, Flickner, and Modha (2016) map deep convolutional networks onto TrueNorth. Across eight vision and speech datasets, single-chip networks run at 1200 to 2600 frames per second and use between 25 and 275 mW. Class: measured energy of a run. Those powers and throughputs are their measurements.

Göltz, Kriener, Baumbach, Billaudelle, Breitwieser, Cramer, Dold, Kungl, Senn, Schemmel, Meier, and Petrovici (2021) train hierarchical time-to-first-spike networks of leaky integrate-and-fire neurons and emulate them on BrainScaleS-2. On downsampled MNIST they report 8.4 μJ per classification at 96.9% test accuracy, with chip power measured at 175 mW during runtime. Class: measured energy of a run. That 8.4 μJ is their measurement.

Blouw, Choo, Hunsberger, and Eliasmith (2019) benchmark a keyword spotter on Loihi against CPU, GPU, Jetson TX1, and Movidius. On Loihi they report 0.00027 joules per inference at 296 inferences per second, with idle 0.029 W and running 0.110 W. Classification accuracy on their test set matches the TensorFlow reference. Class: measured energy of a run. Those joules are their measurements.

Gobieski, Lucia, and Beckmann (2019) run deep neural network inference on an intermittent energy-harvesting MSP430 with Sonic and Tails. From their prototype they take inference energy of about 198 mJ for a tiled baseline and about 26 mJ for Tails. Loop continuation keeps each loop iteration idempotent, so a run continues after a power failure. Tails calibrates its tile size to the energy buffer and halves the tile when a tile does not finish before power fails. Class: measured energy of a run under an energy buffer, with a stop and retry at that buffer. Those millijoules are their prototype figures.

Measured energy of inference on named GPUs. Samsi, Zhao, McDonald, Li, Michaleas, Jones, Bergeron, Kepner, Tiwari, and Gadepally (2023) measure LLaMA inference energy on named NVIDIA V100 and A100 GPUs with nvidia-smi and DCGM. They report energy per second, per decoded token, and per response for LLaMA 7B, 13B, and 65B on Alpaca and GSM8K, including multi-node sharding up to 32 GPUs. For LLaMA 65B they report about 3 to 4 joules per output token. Class: measured energy of a run. Those joules are their measurements.

Luccioni, Jernite, and Strubell (2024) measure energy and carbon for 1,000 inferences across 88 models, 10 tasks, and 30 datasets on NVIDIA A100 GPUs with CodeCarbon. Mean energy per 1,000 queries ranges from 0.002 kWh for text classification to 2.907 kWh for image generation. Multi-purpose generative models emit orders of magnitude more carbon than task-specific models on the same discriminative tasks. Class: task energy read with Code Carbon. Those kilowatt-hours are their measurements.

Energy bound with a stop. Yang, Zhu, and Liu (2019) train deep networks under a quantitative energy budget. The budget is an optimization constraint. Weighted sparse projection and layer input masking enforce it during training. The trained model is designed to meet the budget while maximizing accuracy. Their energy model follows a systolic-array estimate. Class: energy bound on training. That budget is their estimation model. It is not package `measured_j`.

II.11.4.4 Computing in the physics: analog, in-memory, and frequency-domain substrates

Mixture of Limits treats energy to run as the foundation. The works below compute with the physics of a device: conductance in a memory array, light through an optical path, the phase of coupled oscillators, the decay of a dynamic memristor. They are ordered by method class, not by region. Each paper reports in its own unit, and the class line names how that number was made. An efficiency ratio stays in with its method named. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. No number below is package `measured_j`. Estimates are not `measured_j`.

Analog in-memory computing on phase-change memory. Ambrogio, Narayanan, Tsai, Shelby, Boybat, di Nolfo, Sidler,

Giordano, Bodini, Farinha, Killeen, Cheng, Jaoudi, and Burr (2018) train fully connected networks of up to 204,900 synapses in mixed hardware and software, with long-term weights in phase-change memory and near-linear updates on volatile capacitors. They reach software-equivalent accuracy on MNIST, MNIST-backrand, CIFAR-10, and CIFAR-100, and calculate 28,065 billion operations per second per watt for their implementation. Class: efficiency ratio in operations per second per watt, calculated for the implementation. That figure is their calculation.

Ambrogio, Narayanan, Okazaki, and 21 coauthors (2023) build an analog-AI chip of 35 million phase-change memory devices across 34 tiles that performs matrix-vector multiplication in place. They report up to 12.4 tera-operations per second per watt chip-sustained, software-equivalent accuracy on a keyword-spotting network, and near-software-equivalent accuracy on the MLPerf RNNT, with more than 45 million weights on more than 140 million devices across five chips. Class: efficiency ratio in TOPS per watt, chip-sustained. That ratio is their figure.

Le Gallo, Khaddam-Aljameh, Stanisavljevic, and 27 coauthors (2023) build a 64-core analog in-memory compute chip in 14 nm CMOS with backend-integrated phase-change memory, digital activation functions, and an on-chip network. For 8-bit matrix-vector multiplication they report a maximum of 16.1 or 63.1 tera-operations per second at 2.48 or 9.76 tera-operations per second per watt, in the four-phase or one-phase read mode, with near-software-equivalent accuracy on ResNet and LSTM networks. Class: efficiency ratio in TOPS per watt, on chip. Those ratios are their figures.

Resistive and memristor crossbars. Wan, Kubendran, Schaefer, Eryilmaz, Zhang, Wu, Deiss, Raina, Qian, Gao, Joshi, Wu, Wong, and Cauwenberghs (2022) build NeuRRAM, a compute-in-memory chip that runs inference inside resistive RAM. They report 1.6-times to 2.3-times lower energy-delay product than prior RRAM compute-in-memory chips across bit precisions, 99.0% on MNIST, 85.7% on CIFAR-10, and a measured 121 fJ per neuron, or 0.95 fJ per weight, for each noise-injection step of probabilistic sampling. Class: energy-delay product and energy per step, measured on chip. Their expected gain of at least 535 times in energy-delay product from 130 nm to 7 nm is projected from a circuit model.

Yao, Wu, Gao, Tang, Zhang, Zhang, Yang, and Qian (2020) implement a five-layer convolutional network fully in memristor crossbars, eight arrays of 2,048 cells, with hybrid training that absorbs device variation. They report more than 96% accuracy on MNIST and an energy efficiency more than two orders of magnitude greater than state-of-the-art graphics-processing units. Class: efficiency ratio against GPUs. That ratio is their comparison.

Photonic and optical computing. Shen, Harris, Skirlo, Prabhu, Baehr-Jones, Hochberg, Sun, Zhao, Larochelle, Englund, and Soljačić (2017) propose a fully optical neural network and demonstrate its core on a programmable nanophotonic processor of 56 Mach-Zehnder interferometers in a silicon photonic circuit, applied to vowel recognition. Their preprint states a promised gain of at least two orders of magnitude in speed and three orders of magnitude in power efficiency over the state of the art. Class: power-efficiency ratio projected from an architecture model. The demonstration is on chip. The ratio is their projection.

Wang, Ma, Wright, Onodera, Richard, and McMahon (2022) compute optical dot products with up to 505,521 scalar multiplications in one pass of light and run a four-layer MNIST network. They report about 99% accuracy at about 3.1 detected photons per multiplication, and about 90% at about 0.66 photons, about 2.5×10^{-19} J of optical energy per multiplication. At 99% the detected optical energy per inference is about 107 fJ, and about 230 fJ counting the modulator loss. Class: optical energy measured at the detector. It excludes the electronics, and the authors say so.

Chen, Nazhamaiti, Xu, Meng, Zhou, Li, Fan, Wei, Wu, Qiao, Fang, and Dai (2023) build ACCEL, an all-analog chip in which a diffractive optical encoder feeds photocurrents straight into an analog electronic computing chip, with no analog-to-digital converter. They report a systemic energy efficiency of 74.8 peta-operations per second per watt, 4.6 peta-operations per second, 72 ns latency per frame, and 85.5% on Fashion-MNIST. Class: systemic efficiency ratio in operations per second per watt. That ratio is their figure.

Feldmann, Youngblood, Karpov, Gehring, Li, Stappers, Le Gallo, Fu, Lukashchuk, Raja, Liu, Wright, Sebastian, Kippenberg, Pernice, and Bhaskaran (2021) build an integrated photonic tensor core that performs parallel convolutions with phase-change-material memory arrays and soliton microcomb light sources. They report operation at trillions of multiply-accumulate operations per second and a bandwidth exceeding 14 gigahertz. Class: throughput in operations per second, no energy figure given.

Frequency-domain and oscillator computing. Miscuglio, Hu, Li, George, Capanna, Dalir, Bardet, Gupta, and Sorger (2020) compute convolutions as pixelwise multiplications in the Fourier domain. Lenses perform the real-to-Fourier transforms passively at zero static power, and an amplitude mask on about 10^6 display channels multiplies. They

report matrices of about 1000×1000 in a single time step, 100 μs latency, throughput of peta-operations per second, and 98% on MNIST in a hybrid optical-electronic network. Class: throughput and latency, with zero static power for the transform. The paper gives no energy per operation.

Moy, Ahmed, Chiu, Moy, Sapatnekar, and Kim (2022) build a 1,968-node King's graph array of coupled ring oscillators that settles to the ground state of an Ising problem through phase. They report up to 95% accuracy on randomly generated combinatorial optimization problems, a measured average power of 0.042 W, and fewer than 50 oscillation cycles to resolve. Class: power measured on chip, with settling time in oscillation cycles. That power is their measurement.

Romera, Talatchian, Tsunegi, Abreu Araujo, Cros, Bortolotti, Trastoy, Yakushiji, Fukushima, Kubota, Yuasa, Ernoult, Vodenicarevic, Hirtzlin, Locatelli, Querlioz, and Grollier (2018) train a hardware network of four coupled spin-torque nano-oscillators to recognize seven spoken vowels by tuning their frequencies, with classes read from their synchronization. Their preprint reports recognition rates up to 89% on training data and 88% on testing data, and a cross-validated 84.3% on the testing set. Class: recognition rate on a physical oscillator, no energy figure given.

Torrejon, Riou, Abreu Araujo, Tsunegi, Khalsa, Querlioz, Bortolotti, Cros, Yakushiji, Fukushima, Kubota, Yuasa, Stiles, and Grollier (2017) use a single nanoscale spintronic oscillator, a magnetic tunnel junction, to recognize spoken digits. Their preprint reports recognition rates up to 99.6% with cochlear filtering. Class: recognition rate on a physical oscillator, no energy figure given.

Reservoir computing on a physical substrate. Zhong, Tang, Li, Liang, Liu, Li, Xi, Yao, Hao, Gao, Qian, and Wu (2022) build a fully analog reservoir computer: dynamic memristors form the reservoir and non-volatile memristors form the readout. They report real-time spatiotemporal processing with three orders of magnitude lower power consumption than digital hardware, 96.6% on arrhythmia detection, and 97.9% on dynamic gesture recognition. Class: power ratio against digital hardware. That ratio is their comparison.

II.11.4.5 The transform is free: passive, reversible, and frequency-space computing

Mixture of Limits treats energy to run as the foundation, and physics says where that energy goes. A passive, linear, reversible transform dissipates no energy in the transform itself. A lens performs a Fourier transform as light crosses it. A diffractive layer, a metasurface, and a conservative or adiabatic gate map inputs to outputs the same way. Energy use goes to zero as computation moves into frequency space. What remains sits at three places: the source that makes the signal, the detector that reads it, and the bit that is erased. The erased bit is the Landauer line already cited, at least $k_B T \ln 2$ per bit. Energy to run is the only true metric of computer intelligence. All other factors collapse to zero. The works below are ordered by method class, not by region. Each class line names how a number was made, or says that the paper gives no energy figure. No work below reports a measured zero, and none sets package `measured_j`. Estimates are not `measured_j`.

Conservative and reversible logic. Fredkin and Toffoli (1982) define conservative logic, a model of computation that keeps the reversibility of the dynamical laws and conserves additive quantities, energy among them. They show that it is ideally possible to build sequential circuits with zero internal power dissipation, and they give a model in which elastic collisions of identical balls compute. Class: dissipation bound in an ideal model, no measured energy.

Bennett (1982) reviews the thermodynamics of computation. Ballistic models compute at finite speed with zero energy dissipation in principle, Brownian models dissipate an energy that approaches zero only at zero speed, the enzymatic apparatus of DNA replication, transcription, and translation dissipates 20 to 100 kT per step, and each merge of computation paths needs a driving force of $kT \ln 2$. The irreversible step is erasure, not measurement. Class: dissipation bound and review, with the paper's own kT figures.

Landauer (1988) states that reversible computers can dissipate arbitrarily small amounts of energy per step if the computation runs slowly enough. In communication and measurement, only the steps that discard information have a lower limit on energy, and those steps can be avoided in transmission. Class: dissipation bound, no energy figure given.

Adiabatic and superconducting reversible circuits. Takeuchi, Yamanashi, and Yoshikawa (2013) couple a 5 GHz superconducting resonator to an adiabatic quantum-flux-parametron gate and read the gate's dissipation from the resonator's insertion loss. They report a bit energy of about 10 zJ at 5 GHz. Class: measured dissipation on chip, read through a resonator.

Takeuchi, Yamanashi, and Yoshikawa (2014) build a reversible logic gate from adiabatic quantum-flux-parametron

devices and demonstrate its logical and physical reversibility at 4.2 K. Their circuit simulation gives about 1×10^{-21} J per cycle for the gate and buffers, 69 gates in all, at a rise and fall time of 10,000 ps, and a bit energy of about 2×10^{-23} J per cycle per gate, the same order as $k_B T \ln 2 \approx 4.0 \times 10^{-23}$ J at 4.2 K. Class: reversibility demonstrated on chip, dissipation simulated from a circuit model.

Herr (2025) builds reversible gates in the adiabatic quantum flux parametron by copying the inputs of standard gates and disposing of the copies with a terminate gate that dissipates only $kT \ln 2$. For a chip of 10^9 devices with realistic fabrication spread, the preprint projects total dissipation of about 7 times the Landauer limit. Class: dissipation projected from a device model.

Frank, Brocato, Tierney, Missert, and Hsia (2020) describe S2LAL, a CMOS logic family that is fully static and fully adiabatic apart from leakage, with one tick of latency per stage and a minimum clock period of 8 ticks on an 8-phase trapezoidal power clock. The preprint argues that in a process built to minimize leakage it should exceed every known semiconductor logic family in energy efficiency. Class: adiabatic circuit design, no energy figure given.

Passive optical and wave transforms. Goodman (2017) is the textbook source. A thin lens acts as a phase transformation, a lens Fourier-transforms the field (Chapter 6), and coherent analog optical information processing is built on that property (Chapter 10). Class: passive transform, textbook physics, no energy figure given.

Lin, Rivenson, Yardimci, Veli, Luo, Jarrahi, and Ozcan (2018) design passive diffractive layers with deep learning and 3D-print them as an all-optical diffractive deep neural network. At a terahertz spectrum the layers classify handwritten digits and fashion products and perform the function of an imaging lens. Class: passive transform, no energy figure given.

Silva, Monticone, Castaldi, Galdi, Alù, and Engheta (2014) design metamaterial blocks that perform spatial differentiation, integration, or convolution on the profile of a wave as it propagates through them. The blocks are thinner than lens-based optical processors by several orders of magnitude. Class: passive transform, no energy figure given.

Mohammadi Estakhri, Edwards, and Engheta (2019) inverse-design a metastructure that solves integral equations with monochromatic electromagnetic fields: the input wave is the function and the output field is the solution. They demonstrate it at microwave frequencies. Class: passive transform, no energy figure given.

The energy floor at the source, the detector, and the wire. Miller (2017) reviews optoelectronic devices for low-energy processing and interconnect, including sub-femtojoule devices in waveguide, lasers, modulators, LEDs, and integrated photodetectors that reduce or remove receiver circuit energy. The review sets a target of interconnects from about 1 cm to about 10 m at about 10 fJ per bit. Class: device energy floor and target, review.

Hamerly, Bernstein, Sludds, Soljačić, and Englund (2019) propose a photonic accelerator in which the multiplication happens in coherent photoelectric detection. Their preprint reports sub-aJ energies per multiply-and-accumulate and a standard quantum limit, set by photodetector shot noise, as low as 50 zJ per multiply-and-accumulate, below the Landauer limit for digital irreversible computation. Class: detector shot-noise floor projected from a device model.

II.11.5 Developer experience roadmap (not shipped product)

Gap. Software reference `mol prove` is clean-room software existence: implemented and verified against its specification. Operators still need a declarative surface, local develop loop, and an honest benchmark story versus MoE routers, without claiming a shipped product that does not exist.

Close. Roadmap only (not claimed shipped):

Declarative **`mol.yaml`** sketch

```yaml
# Roadmap sketch — not a shipped product claim
version: 0.1
task:
  id: unit.convert.si.length
  grammar: formula.si_units
cascade:
  allow_model: false
  floors: [voi, grammar, energy, efa_certificate]
phase1:
```

```
  enabled: false   # typed input assumed; enable for unstructured front doors
measurement:
  tier: 0          # 0 analytical | 1 os_telemetry | 2 shunt
  board_synth_claimed: false
```

CLI loop (shipped in clean-room): `mol prove` (PLAN + product A1 to A14) → `mol run --chore mol.yaml` → `mol bench` (J/query versus always-model / MoE-sim; Estimated|Metered only) → `mol arena` (typed decision / ticket-close / risk head-on versus frontier_sim + system_one_leaf; metrics correct_close, refuse-when-C=1, estimated_j, latency) → `mol phase1` → `mol distill` (Primitive Distillation v1) → `mol dev` (catalog/Stage C/PUBLISH status). Watch/receipt-diff UI polish remains residual. Package joules stay Estimated unless Metered.

Product path. Mixture of Limits as a valued product surface (problem, vs Laya System One, `mol.yaml`, acceptance A1 to A14, dual-phase → live in-crate NI certify → satiation architecture, distillation v1, durable episodes, Tier-1/2 meter honesty, Arena head-on) lives under the clean-room tree at `product/` (optional drafting mirror `mixture-of-limits-product`). Canonical code + docs: `openIE-dev/mixture-of-limits` (`mol prove` embeds A1 to A14; `mol run` / `mol bench` / `mol arena` / `mol phase1` / `mol distill`). Software reference constructive existence remains `mol prove`; package joules stay Estimated unless Metered. Compete head-on: correct_close, refuse-when-C=1, estimated_j, latency. Floors win when they exist; the last cascade stage when needed; peers age; each stands alone; frontier is expensive/out of road (see `product/COMPETITIVE.md`, `product/ARENA.md`).

Benchmark framing. Compare joules-per-query, correct close, refuse-when-C=1, and certify rate of Mixture of Limits cascade against MoE / frontier always-model and System One leaf stubs on the same typed task set (`mol arena`). Report Tier 0/1/2 explicitly. Software reference constructive existence is not a board energy score; never invent `measured_j`.

II.11.6 Roadmap summary

Gap	Close	Ships when
Unstructured front door	Dual-phase: TinyML/transducer → typed AST → cascade	Phase-1 gear + schema emitters under prove
Expensive meta-routing	O(1) Bloom/trie/EBNF/VoI tables	Software reference criteria for router cost ≪ leaf cost
Undefined grammar	Refuse/`primitive_gap` or Primitive Distillation	Certify→AST compile→Lookup/Formula path
Joules collapsed	Tier 0 / 1 / 2 labels; Metered-only `measured_j`	Receipt schema + optional shunt path
DX / MoE / Arena comparison	`mol.yaml`, `mol prove` A1 to A14, `mol bench`, `mol arena`, `mol distill`, `mol phase1`, `mol dev` status	Shipped in `openIE-dev/mixture-of-limits` `product/`; watch/receipt-diff UI polish residual

Mixture of Limits stays the navigation rule. Dual-phase, cheap meta-compute, distillation, measurement tiers, and DX are how the law gets embodied on the plateau: Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model, with perception as a bounded front gear and the last cascade stage still last.

The documents in §11.4.1 do not set `measured_j`. The works in §11.4.2, §11.4.3, §11.4.4, and §11.4.5 do not set it either.

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Kepler's laws / Newton's *Principia* / Brahe's observational program are treated as historical common knowledge in §8.1; imprint DOIs for critical editions TBD if a journal version requires them. Raiffa decision-analysis imprint DOI TBD. Press-wire details for Logical Intelligence beyond the company blog (exact pilot lists, internal AGI claims) are company-reported. Author-reported GPU-hours, throughput, KV bytes/token, prefill FLOPs, API cache prices, and benchmark scores for Jamba, DeepSeek (including V4.1-Flash), GLM, Xiaomi MiMo / HySparse2, Qwen, Kimi, Sarvam, Solar, speculative decoding, and test-time scaling papers are field / author-reported, not software reference `measured_j`. Hacker News cache-break anecdotes are operator reports, not OpenIE meters.

II. Appendix A. Measurement bounds

- Software reference prove path: no FPGA board result claimed; `measured_j=None` unless a Metered probe returns
- Landauer = labeled thermodynamic lower-bound estimate on receipts
- Analytical / catalog `estimated_j` ≠ board power
- Software reference `mol prove` ~29 VERIFIED = constructive existence in software
- Clean-room Mixture of Limits: law+runtime, not an MoE wrapper
- Bottleneck: materials/applied-math embodiment. Settled IT/physics already name the floors
- §8.4-§8.14 map latents / Logical Intelligence / World Labs / SOTA at the plateau (test-time / super learning / live SOTA methods including MoD / quantization / inference engines / SSM-MoE-implementation efficiency / hardware economics / edge-neuromorphic software reference / transmission-gearing-cascade-memory-context-test-time / race to plateau floors across AI/ML fields) as plateau spend options under Mixture of Limits floors; the industry race is to those floors, not unbounded scale; §9 contrasts Constitutional AI and tool-use agents with typed certify-before-commit; field product joules, API prices, and author-reported KV bytes stay field; estimates ≠ board package energy
- §11 closes engineering gaps as plateau work: dual-phase micro-perception (§11.1; rule AST path shipped), O(1) meta-routing (§11.2), Primitive Distillation v1 (§11.3; `mol distill`), Tier 0/1/2 measurement realism (§11.4; only Metered populates `measured_j`; Tier-2 shunt HAL stub honesty), DX `mol.yaml` / `mol prove` A1 to A14 / `mol bench` / `mol arena` / `mol phase1` / `mol distill` (§11.5), shipped in clean-room `product/`; `mol dev` UI polish residual. Software reference in proof: Ferric inventory, Stage C inventory, HW Gaps sims ×8 (`physical_settle…photonic_mzi`; Gap cells retained). Out of software reference: Ferric robot EFA meters, live WCA MCP network (HTTP|MCP certify env-gated in-tree), FPGA Stage C package meters (`stage_c_measured=false`)
- Dual-phase does not demote Lookup → Formula → Solver → Model; Phase 1 emits typed AST/schema; the last cascade stage remains residual leaf in Phase 2

II. Appendix B. Reproducibility pointers

```
# On a machine with the mixture-of-limits workspace:
cargo test --workspace
cargo run -p mol-cli -- prove   # expect VERIFIED lines, exit 0
```

Site preview for this study (research-openie-web):

```
# From the research-openie-web checkout root:
pnpm install
pnpm dev
# open /papers/gates/#part-ii-the-cascade-mixture-of-limits , /about/gates/ , /living/mol/
```

PDF regeneration (optional; needs pandoc + weasyprint): `./scripts/generate-pdfs.sh` after `mol` is added to the script's `gen_one` list.